



BLAIR ACADEMY EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

2026-2027

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INTRODUCTORY STATEMENT

This *Employee Handbook* is designed to acquaint you with Blair Academy (“Blair” or the “School”). A thorough familiarity with its contents can be helpful in many matters that relate to your employment with the School. You are expected to take time to read the *Employee Handbook* carefully and save it for future reference.

One of the School’s objectives is to provide a work environment that is professional and supportive. The information in this *Employee Handbook* is deliberately presented in an informal manner and, as such, is only a summary of and general guide to the School’s policies and practices. Because no two employment situations are ever exactly alike, the policies described in the *Employee Handbook* must have some flexibility. Therefore, the School may modify implementation of the policies summarized here when it determines that particular circumstances warrant individualized consideration.

Additionally, due to the nature of the residential school environment and the different roles that employees hold, certain policies may apply differently to employees based on their employment classification and job duties. Employees’ supervisors will advise them if there are different expectations or requirements for their position under certain policies than what is included in this *Employee Handbook*.

The policies and practices contained within this *Employee Handbook* supersede any policies or practices or employee handbooks previously issued by the School, excluding “summary plan descriptions.” Separate “summary plan descriptions” may exist that describe the benefits offered by the School in greater detail than they are described in this *Employee Handbook*. If there is any inconsistency between the descriptions contained in this *Employee Handbook* and the School’s formal insurance plans or contracts, such plans or contracts control.

In addition, with the exception of the “at-will” employment policy, the School may interpret, revise, supplement or rescind any policies or portions of the *Employee Handbook* from time to time as it deems appropriate. In such an event, the School will attempt to provide you with advance notice of such changes.

This *Employee Handbook* is not a contract, and the policies, practices and benefits summarized in this *Employee Handbook* have been adopted voluntarily by the School and do not create any contractual rights, promises or obligations of any kind with respect to the terms or conditions of employment. While the School values you and looks forward to continuing a mutually satisfactory employment relationship, it should still be recognized that, unless otherwise set forth in an express, written employment contract between the Head of School and you, neither you nor the School have entered into any contract of employment, express or implied, and that the employment relationship between the School and you remains “at-will.” That is, either you or the School may terminate the relationship at any time, with or without notice, for any lawful reason.

I. GENERAL EMPLOYMENT POLICIES

EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY POLICY

Blair Academy provides equal employment opportunities to all employees and qualified applicants for employment (and prohibits discrimination and harassment of any type) without regard to race, color, religion, age, sex, pregnancy, breastfeeding, national origin, nationality, ancestry, disability status, genetic information or refusal to submit to or provide the results from any genetic test, atypical hereditary cellular or blood trait, protected veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, marital status, domestic partnership/civil union status, military service, veteran status, or any other status protected by applicable federal, state or local laws, as may be amended.

This policy applies to all terms and conditions of employment, including recruiting, hiring, placement, promotion, termination, layoff, recall, transfer, leaves of absence, compensation and training.

All employees and applicants for employment are required to meet the bona fide occupational requirements of their job or the job sought and must be able to perform essential functions of that position with or without a reasonable accommodation. All employment decisions at the School are based on merit, qualifications and skills.

Bring any questions or concerns regarding this Equal Employment Opportunity Policy to the Director of Human Resources Operations.

EMPLOYMENT-AT-WILL

Blair Academy is an at-will employer. This means that, regardless of any provision in this Employee Handbook, either you or Blair Academy may terminate the employment relationship at any time, for any reason, with or without notice, for any lawful reason. Nothing in this *Employee Handbook* or in any document or statement, written or oral, shall limit the right to terminate employment-at-will. No officer, employee or representative of Blair Academy is authorized to enter into an agreement—expressed or implied—with any employee for employment other than at-will, with the exception of the Head of School.

IMMIGRATION REFORM & CONTROL ACT

In compliance with the federal Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986 (IRCA), as amended, Blair Academy is committed to employing only individuals who are authorized to work in the United States.

Each new employee, as a condition of employment, must complete the Employment Eligibility Verification Form I-9 and present documentation establishing identity and employment eligibility within three business days of beginning employment with Blair. If a new employee fails to provide information and documentation to confirm their identity and employment eligibility, the employee will be subject to immediate discharge.

If an employee is authorized to work in this country for a limited period, the employee will be required to submit updated documentation showing renewed employment eligibility prior to expiration of that period to remain employed by the School.

REFERENCES & EDUCATION VERIFICATION

To ensure that individuals who join Blair Academy are well-qualified and have a strong potential to be productive and successful, it is the School's policy to check employment references and, if necessary, verify education and degrees. These checks enable the School to verify the information that individuals provide during the hiring process.

BACKGROUND CHECK POLICY & DISCLOSING ARREST

Blair Academy is committed to protecting the security, safety, health and welfare of employees, students and others, and safeguarding School resources. Therefore, the School requires that all employees (including faculty, adjunct faculty, staff, nurses, coaches, drivers and contract employees working with students) and any faculty partner who is living in the dorm, conducting dorm duty, tutoring students, or has the potential to have direct and unmonitored contact with students go through a criminal background check. Faculty children over the age of 18 living in School housing on a permanent basis must also undergo a criminal background check. Blair Academy will cover the cost for conducting these checks via the Federal Bureau of Investigation and/or the New Jersey State Police and/or a third-party vendor.

In addition, as required by N.J. law P.L. 2018, c.5, all employees must complete a sexual misconduct/child abuse disclosure release form for all current and former employers within the last 20 years who were school entities or where the applicant was employed in a position that involved direct contact with children.

Employees are required to notify the Head of School in writing within 24 hours if they are arrested or indicted for any crime or offense while employed by Blair Academy. This requirement applies to all criminal matters and quasi-criminal matters, and specifically includes any citations, criminal or otherwise, for driving under the influence or driving while intoxicated. Additionally, the employee must report the outcome of the criminal or quasi-criminal case no later than seven days after it is rendered. Failure to comply with these reporting requirements may result in disciplinary action, including, but not limited to, termination of employment.

MOTOR VEHICLE RECORD CHECK

To support the safety of our students, employees and community, the School requires a Motor Vehicle Record (MVR) check for all faculty and staff who will operate School-owned vehicles for Blair business, including transport of students or colleagues. This includes employees holding commercial driver and standard driver licenses.

MVR checks will be conducted as part of the pre-employment process and repeated annually for all applicable employees. Any findings that may impact an employee's ability to drive a Blair-owned vehicle will be reviewed in accordance with School policies and New Jersey state regulations.

Failure to meet the School's driving standards may result in reassignment of duties or other employment actions as deemed necessary.

CATEGORIES OF EMPLOYMENT

Benefit eligibility and certain personnel policies apply to employees based on their employment classification. In other words, benefit eligibility and personnel policies may differ depending on whether an employee is classified as a full-time, part-time, seasonal or temporary employee.

- FULL-TIME EMPLOYEES are not in temporary status and regularly work at least 30 hours per work week or a minimum of 1,560 hours per year.
- PART-TIME EMPLOYEES are not in temporary status and regularly work less than 30 hours per work week.
- SEASONAL EMPLOYEES are full-time or part-time employees who are hired to perform a job for a specified time, during a specified season.
- TEMPORARY EMPLOYEES are full-time or part-time employees who are hired to work for a limited period of time, generally no longer than three months.

Blair Academy also classifies each employee as exempt or non-exempt, in accordance with applicable law.

- EXEMPT EMPLOYEES primarily perform work that is exempt from and not subject to the overtime provisions of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA). Exempt employees are generally paid on a salaried basis and are not eligible for overtime pay.
- NON-EXEMPT EMPLOYEES primarily perform work that is subject to the overtime provisions of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA). Non-exempt employees are paid for hours worked and are eligible for overtime pay for all hours worked over 40 hours in a work week.

In addition to the preceding, employees are also categorized as “essential” and “non-essential.”

- ESSENTIAL EMPLOYEES have assigned duties and responsibilities that are critical to the daily operation of the School and that must be accomplished on School premises, regardless of a School and/or office closing. Employees are essential to the safety and health of students, employees and guests.
- NON-ESSENTIAL EMPLOYEES have assigned duties and responsibilities that are critical to the daily operation of the School, but they do not need to be accomplished when the School and/or offices are closed.

Upon hire and/or transfer, your supervisor will notify you of your employment classification.

PERSONAL DATA CHANGES

Personal data maintained by Blair Academy must be accurate and current at all times. Therefore, it is the employee’s responsibility to promptly notify the School of any changes in personal data, including legal name, mailing address, home/mobile telephone number, number and names of dependents, individuals to be contacted in the event of an emergency, educational accomplishments, changes of beneficiaries, tax exemptions, work authorization status, and any other status change. If you have any personal data changes, please provide the information to the Director of Human Resources Operations as soon as possible.

EMPLOYMENT INFORMATION

Generally, information about an employee is not released to individuals outside the School without the employee's prior written authorization. If an employee wants the School to provide information for a mortgage or other credit application, the employee should authorize the School in writing to release the information. Unless an employee provides such authorization, the School will only provide routine information in response to outside inquiries.

This policy does not prevent the School from using employee information in connection with the School's operating needs or from releasing such information to government agencies and others in appropriate circumstances, as determined by the School.

EMPLOYMENT REFERENCE POLICY

Only the Director of Human Resources Operations, Chief Financial & Operations Officer, Associate Head of School, Chief Advancement Officer, Dean of Faculty Life and Head of School are authorized to provide or authorize other supervisors at the School to provide official employment references on behalf of Blair Academy. All reference requests by former School employees must be directed to the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Unless there is a release signed by the individual seeking a reference on file with the Director of Human Resources Operations, the School will generally provide only routine information (i.e., the dates of employment and position held) in response to outside inquiries. This policy does not prevent Blair from releasing more detailed information about a current or former employee to government agencies, prospective employers and others in appropriate circumstances, as determined appropriate by the School, regardless of whether or not the current or former employee has a signed release on file with Blair's Human Resources Department.

If a current employee is asked to provide a personal reference for a former employee, the current employee is required to notify the Director of Human Resources Operations about the request. Any personal reference must include a disclaimer stating that the reference is personal and is not an official reference from the School. Personal references may not be provided on the School's letterhead, through School email or in any other manner that suggests that the employee is speaking on behalf of the School.

Employees are permitted to provide personal references for current Blair employees without notifying the Director of Human Resources Operations unless the employee being asked to provide the personal reference supervises or manages (or formally supervised or managed), in any respect, the work of the employee requesting the reference. Where a supervisor or former supervisor is requested to provide a personal reference by a current employee who is or was a subordinate, the supervisor must notify the Director of Human Resources Operations of the reference request and provide a draft of the reference for the Director of Human Resources Operations to review prior to providing any such personal reference to the employee.

NEW EMPLOYEE ORIENTATION

Upon joining Blair Academy, employees will be provided with a copy of this *Employee Handbook* and/or granted access to an electronic version of this *Handbook* on our website portal (www.blair.edu/faculty-staff/business-office). Employees will also be asked to complete all personnel, payroll and benefit information.

Your supervisor is responsible for the operation of your department. In addition to the information provided in this *Employee Handbook*, supervisors are a good source of information about Blair and your job.

PERFORMANCE REVIEWS

Your performance is important to Blair Academy. Therefore, you are encouraged to discuss your job performance and goals with your supervisor on an informal, day-to-day basis. Once each year, Blair Academy will conduct a formal performance evaluation to review your job progress and help you to set new performance plans or goals. Copies of our formal performance evaluations are maintained in your personnel file. If you have questions about faculty evaluations, please reach out to the Dean of Faculty Life; if you have questions about staff evaluations, contact the Director of Human Resources Operations.

CODE OF ETHICS

The School's reputation for integrity is its most valuable asset and is directly related to the conduct of its officers and employees. Therefore, employees are required to act in the best interests of the School and to avoid activities, commitments, ownership interests, and other arrangements that may or will compromise their primary duty of loyalty and fidelity to Blair Academy.

Employees are required to ensure that their activities, commitments and ownership interests outside the School do not create any actual or perceived conflict of interest. Employees must never permit their personal interests to conflict, or even appear to conflict, with the interests of Blair Academy, its parents and students, or anyone else doing business with the School. Employees must never use their positions with the School or any of its constituents for private gain, to advance personal interests, or to obtain favors or benefits for themselves, members of their families, friends, individuals, corporations or business entities.

Employees of the School must conduct their personal affairs in such a fashion that their duties and responsibilities to Blair Academy are not jeopardized and/or legal questions do not arise with respect to their association or work with Blair. An employee may accept a position as a board member of an organization, public, private, for-profit or not-for-profit, only after consultation with the Chief Financial & Operations Officer and/or Head of School. The School discourages outside employment during the academic year and expects that any other job will not conflict in time or content with an employee's position at the School.

Conduct which may be perceived by others to be a conflict is also prohibited. If you have any questions concerning any actions by you or other employees that might be perceived as a conflict, discuss this conduct with the Head of School. Violations of this conflict-of-interest policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

PROHIBITION OF GIFTS & GRATUITIES

To avoid even the appearance of impropriety, no gifts, gratuities, tips, personal cash payments, favors, loans, tickets, meals, transportation, services or special privileges exceeding (or valued at more than) \$300 may be solicited or received in connection with your position at Blair Academy. Cash is never an acceptable gift from any of Blair's constituencies and employees should be mindful that this policy also applies to vendors and others not directly connected to the Blair community. Should you have questions, reach out to the Dean of Faculty Life, the Director of Human Resources

Operations or the Head of School. *(For more guidance specifically relating to gifts from members of the Blair community, please refer to page 104).*

WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY

Blair Academy is committed to maintaining its reputation for honesty, fairness, respect, responsibility, integrity, trust and sound judgment. To that end, the School has established policies that require employees of the School to observe the spirit and letter of all applicable laws and regulations, and to conduct themselves in accordance with the highest standards of conduct and personal integrity.

This policy is intended to establish a reporting procedure and ensure that employees of Blair Academy are encouraged to report any ethical, illegal or dishonest activity or concerns, or other misconduct involving the School's financial or business affairs without fear of reprisal or retaliation.

Such activity may involve another employee or outside persons or firms doing business with Blair. Examples of illegal or dishonest activities are violations of federal, state or local laws, billing for services not performed, fraudulent financial reporting, or other misconduct involving the School's financial or business affairs.

Employee Reporting Process

It is the responsibility of all employees to comply with Blair Academy's policies and to report any violations or suspected violations of the School's policy in accordance with this policy. Employees are also required to comply with applicable federal and state law and to report violations or suspected violations of applicable law, including but not limited to the Occupational Safety and Health Act, federal and state environmental laws, federal securities laws, and the Affordable Care Act, in accordance with this policy.

Before an employee discloses a violation outside the School, the employee is encouraged to provide notice to the School in accordance with this policy to allow the School the reasonable opportunity, when appropriate, to take corrective action. Blair Academy expects all employees to report any suspected criminal activity, regardless of the identity or position of the employee involved.

If an employee has knowledge of or concern about such illegal or dishonest activity or misconduct, the employee is encouraged to promptly provide written notice and/or communicate with any of the following:

- Head of School or
- Chief Financial & Operations Officer

Any complaint involving a Blair administrator or Business Office personnel should be reported directly to the Head of School.

Any complaint involving the Head of School should be reported to the Chair of the Board of Trustees, the Secretary of the Board or the School's legal counsel. Contact information is as follows:

Mrs. Maria G. Vinci Savettiere, Esq., Chair of the Board
351 Mt. Harmony Rd.

Bernardsville, NJ 07924
(973) 479-9149 (cell phone)
(973) 631-5000 (office phone)

Ms. Anne Cramer, Secretary of the Board
131 Packard Rd.
Jericho, VT 05465
(802) 233-7603 (cell phone)
(802) 899-4745 (home phone)

Mr. Richard Wenner, General Counsel
Lavery, Selvaggi, Abromitis & Cohen, P.C.
1001 Route 517
Hackettstown, NJ 07840
(908) 852-2600 (office phone)

Complaints and concerns may be verbal or written and no particular format is necessary. However, all complaints and concerns should include as much information as possible to permit a thorough and complete evaluation of a complaint or concern. This includes material evidence, names of persons able to corroborate the facts giving rise to the charge, if possible, and how to contact the complainant to assure anonymity, if anonymity is desired. The recipient of such a complaint is responsible for ensuring that all information regarding the complaint is properly recorded and, thus, becomes the formal record of the complaint. A copy of the written complaint will be provided to the complainant for confirmation of accuracy.

While the School encourages the reporting individual to reveal their name to facilitate investigation, concerns reported anonymously will be investigated to the fullest extent practicable under the circumstances. Upon receipt of a complaint, Blair Academy will promptly conduct a thorough investigation in such a way as to maintain the confidentiality of the individuals involved to the extent practicable under the circumstances.

Role of the Head of School

All complaints received under this policy will be promptly submitted to the Head of School, who is responsible for overseeing the investigation and coordinating corrective actions. The Head of School will determine the level of investigation the complaint warrants and who the appropriate party is to perform the investigation. The Head of School (or the Head's designee) is responsible for determining if the facts support or do not support the complaint. The Head of School will make the ultimate decision and may provide a written explanation of the investigation findings to the employee who made the complaint.

The Head of School may consult with Blair's general counsel regarding complaints received under this policy and receive assistance in either the investigation of the claim or in determining the response to the findings. The Head of School is required to report to the Chair of the Blair Academy Board of Trustees regarding the School's compliance with this policy.

For violations involving the Head of School, the Chair of the Blair Academy Board of Trustees will fill the role of the Head of School and perform the responsibilities identified in the preceding paragraphs and report such complaints to the Executive Committee of the Board of Trustees.

A person who believes that their report of illegal or dishonest activities or other misconduct involving the School's business or financial affairs is not receiving appropriate attention by the Head of School may contact the Chair or Secretary of the Board of Trustees directly.

Employee Responsibility

An employee (whistleblower) who makes a complaint or charge must exercise sound judgment and act without malice to avoid baseless allegations or frivolous complaints. The whistleblower is not responsible for investigating the activity, or for determining fault or corrective measures, but must be acting in good faith and have reasonable grounds for believing the information indicates a violation. Employees found to have knowingly made false accusations may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employee Protection

Whistleblower protections are provided in two important areas—confidentiality and against adverse action in the form of retaliation.

Insofar as is reasonably practicable under the circumstances, the confidentiality of the whistleblower will be maintained. However, after consultation with legal counsel, the Head of School or the Chair of the Board of Trustees may determine that the whistleblower's identity must be disclosed to conduct a thorough investigation or to comply with applicable laws.

Blair Academy will not take adverse action against a whistleblower who in good faith makes a report in accordance with this policy. This includes, but is not limited to, protection from any adverse employment action such as termination, compensation decreases, poor work assignments and threats of physical harm. It is a violation of this policy for anyone, whether acting alone or on behalf of Blair Academy, to retaliate against any individual who makes a good faith report in accordance with this policy. Any whistleblower who believes they are being retaliated against should contact the Head of School, or, in the case of perceived retaliation by the Head of School, the Chair or Secretary of the Board of Trustees. An employee who retaliates against someone who has reported a violation in good faith may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Any employee, however, who knowingly files a false or materially misleading report of illegal or dishonest activities or other misconduct involving the School's business or financial affairs may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Questions

Employees with questions regarding this policy should contact the Head of School.

FRAUDULENT OR CRIMINAL ACTS

Any employee with a reasonable basis for believing fraudulent or criminal acts have occurred by an individual associated with Blair Academy is encouraged to immediately report such concerns to the Head of School and should not confront the individuals who may be investigated. Employees should not initiate investigations on their own because such actions can compromise any ensuing investigations by the School or local law enforcement.

In those instances where the Head of School's investigation indicates the probability of criminal activity, the investigation will be turned over to the appropriate law enforcement agency. All

employees are expected to cooperate fully with those performing an investigation pursuant to this policy.

Employees found to have participated in fraudulent or other criminal acts may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, and may be subject to criminal prosecution where appropriate.

PROTECTING SCHOOL'S CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

Blair Academy possesses certain confidential, proprietary and business-sensitive information that has been and may be revealed to employees during employment with the School. The protection of confidential business information and trade secrets is vital to the interests and success of the School. All employees must take all appropriate steps to ensure that the confidentiality of such information is maintained. Proprietary, confidential and sensitive business information regarding the School, its students, prospective students and families, employees, prospective employees, volunteers, other educational institutions, suppliers, vendors and anyone else doing business with the School must be treated with sensitivity and discretion and only be disseminated on a need-to-know basis.

Protecting Blair Academy's information is the responsibility of every employee, and we all share a common interest in making sure it is not improperly or accidentally disclosed. The School expects that, as a condition of employment, employees will keep all confidential and proprietary information strictly confidential. All confidential and proprietary information is the property of the School, and employees are obligated to maintain the confidentiality of this information even after separation of employment with the School regardless of the reason for termination. During employment with the School and thereafter, employees may not, directly or indirectly, use or disclose to anyone, or authorize disclosure or use of, any information revealed to or learned by the employee during their employment with the School, unless such use or disclosure is both consistent with the School's obligations and for the sole purpose of carrying out the School's duties.

Confidential information includes all information that has or could have commercial business value or other utility in the School's business, or the unauthorized disclosure of which could be detrimental to the School's interests, whether or not such information is specifically identified as confidential information by the School. Examples of confidential information include any and all information concerning: (a) Blair Academy's business plans, strategic plans, forecasts, budgets, sales, projections and costs; (b) the names, contact information, financial information, salary/payroll data, performance evaluations and other personally identifying information of the School's current and prospective students, family members, alumni, parents, donors, Trustees and other constituents; (c) marketing activities, plans, promotions, operations and research and development; (d) business operations, internal structures and financial affairs; (e) systems and procedures; (f) tuition structure, payments and financial aid; and (g) contracts with other parties.

If you are asked a question concerning confidential information, do not disclose any information without discussing the details with your supervisor or the Head of School or Chief Financial & Operations Officer first. Employees may not duplicate, copy or store confidential information without such authorization and seeking personal benefit or allowing others to benefit from confidential information obtained through their employment is strictly prohibited; anyone who improperly use or disclose confidential business and proprietary information may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment and legal action, regardless of whether the employee actually benefits from the disclosed information. Employees are prohibited

from sharing constituent contact information and other data with vendors without the express permission of the Head of School.

Some individuals employed by the School are supplied with access to various accounts that contain financial and/or personal data for the completion of their job responsibilities. Users of the School's information systems are required to follow the procedures outlined below:

1. All transactions, processed by a user ID and password, are the responsibility of the person to whom the user ID was assigned. The user's ID and password must remain confidential and must not be shared with anyone other than the individual's supervisor, the Chief Financial & Operations Officer or the Head of School.
2. Access to any School account or record may only be granted by the employee whose account is being accessed (if applicable), a supervisor, the Chief Financial and Operations Officer or the Head of School.
3. Passwords should be changed periodically or as soon as there is reason to believe a password may have been compromised or revealed inadvertently.

All telephone calls regarding a current or former employee's position/compensation with Blair must be forwarded to the Director of Human Resources Operations, Chief Financial & Operations Officer or the Head of School.

Employees acknowledge their responsibility to comply with confidentiality policies and any future updates issued by the School.

FAMILY/COMMUNITY RELATIONS

Our School's reputation is built on providing meaningful, one-of-a-kind educational opportunities and maintaining excellent relationships with students, parents, alumni, donors, friends and members of the local community. Maintaining this reputation requires the active participation of every employee.

The opinions and attitudes that constituents have toward Blair Academy moving forward may be determined by the actions of our employees. It is sometimes easy to take a constituent for granted, but if we do, we run the risk of losing the support of not only that person, but also their associates, friends and family.

Each employee must be sensitive to the importance of providing courteous treatment in all working relationships. This, of course, is not limited to colleagues on Blair's faculty and staff, but pertains equally to students, local residents, current and prospective families, graduates of all class years, donors, friends and all visitors to campus.

MEDIA RELATIONS POLICY

All general media inquiries related to School matters, including employees and the School's students, should be directed to the Communications Office or Head of School's Office. Even in non-crisis situations, individual faculty and staff members should not speak to members of the press or engage in any public commentary (including social media, websites and blogs) without prior approval from the Chief of Staff to the Head of School or Head of School, who will track and determine how to handle such inquiries. The only exceptions to this policy include issues relating to a legitimate labor dispute or concerted activity protected by the National Labor Relations Act ("NLRA").

Should the media contact you, please politely explain that you are not a spokesperson for the School and refer them as instructed above. If you choose to respond to inquiries or contacts initiated by the media regarding a labor dispute or concerted activity protected by the NLRA, you are required to make clear that you are speaking for yourself only and not on behalf of the School.

Whether you intend to or not, as a Blair employee, you can be perceived as representing the official position of the School in the public expression of your thoughts and opinions, regardless of where you share them. Employees are expected to be cognizant of this reality and take care in what they publicly share. Any and all public response referencing your title or role at Blair must be reviewed and approved by the Communications Office, in consultation with the Head of School's Office.

Employees are also expected to exercise good judgment in any outside activities that may draw attention to the School. If an employee writes letters to newspaper editors, government representatives, public agencies or other authorities over matters of personal concern, those communications should not be prepared on the School's stationery. Nothing herein is intended to curtail employees' rights to engage in protected concerted activity under Section 7 of the NLRA.

Media access to Blair programs, teams or facilities

Credentialed and uncredentialed media outlets regularly request interviews with Blair students and employees, as well as access to the School's programs, teams and facilities.

No such request should be granted without the knowledge and approval of the Communications or Head of School Offices. Before granting such access, any such individual or company must sign a release of liability and provide a certificate of insurance with coverage of a minimum of \$1 million per occurrence and \$3 million in the aggregate.

In the event of sports coverage, the athletic department must sign off and be given time to process the necessary paperwork and permissions. No access should be given to individuals covering Blair without these steps having been completed. This only applies to those given special access, not to individuals photographing or filming from the stands. Players and coaches should not be mic'd up without the permission of the athletics office.

Another important piece that the Communications or Athletics Departments will address in the event of media presence at Blair events or programs is alerting parents to the presence of third-party outlets and the possibility that their child may be included in photos or video not covered by Blair's general release that families sign off on as part of the enrollment and re-enrollment process.

The business office's [liability release](#) can be found here and the department also maintains separate releases for coaches who work with students and other purposes and these are modified on an as-needed basis. [This sample](#) outlines what outside coaches and other professionals must sign off on before working with students on campus.

SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

The pace at which our use and understanding of technology grows and adapts is rapid indeed. The use of social media in particular within our community has a range and impact that extends far beyond Blair's campus—it has a reach that is exponential and global. While it would be both short-sighted and foolish to craft a policy delineating each and every appropriate or inappropriate use of social networking/media, it is critical that we define our general expectations for all employees and establish rules and guidelines for best practices involving social media.

Without the express written permission from the School and the current or prospective student's parents, employees are prohibited from friending, following, tagging, interacting or collabing with current or prospective students via public or private personal social media accounts (with the exception of employees who are parents of current or prospective students being permitted to follow their own children). Employees who run approved School-sanctioned social media channels may reply or react to comments made by students on those approved channels, but are prohibited from friending, following or tagging students' accounts from those sanctioned accounts. Collabing with students is permitted if it is done through school-sanctioned accounts.

There is no question that social media has many benefits: It provides avenues for communication within and beyond the Blair community; it allows for easy and timely resource sharing; and it expands the educational experience for students and faculty alike. That said, the downside of using such platforms must be understood and avoided.

In the spirit of maintaining both professional standards and a healthy community, the School expects employees to adhere to the following guidelines. With the overarching goal of supporting and protecting faculty, staff and students, the guidelines may evolve over time as technologies change. But its spirit—which is to promote the well-being of those in the Blair community—will not.

Best-Practice Guidelines

Blair encourages employees to use social media in a professional, ethical, legal, respectful and thoughtful manner consistent with the rules and expectations of the School. As you represent the School in both professional and personal settings, it is important to use discretion when using social media channels.

Employees are expected to always be respectful, courteous and fair to parents, students, families, alumni, donors, friends, guests, vendors, or people who work with the School when using social media. If an employee decides to post complaints or criticism, the employee should avoid using statements, photographs, video or audio that reasonably could be viewed as malicious, obscene, threatening, or intimidating, that disparages students, parents, visitors or other third parties, or that might constitute harassment or bullying. Examples of such conduct might include offensive posts meant to intentionally harm someone's reputation or posts on the basis of race, sex, gender, gender identity, religion, sexual orientation, physical or mental disability or any other status protected by law or School policy. Nothing herein is intended to curtail employees' rights to engage in protected concerted activity under Section 7 of the National Labor Relations Act.

All information shared via social networking has the potential to become public information. Therefore, it is imperative that you think and act deliberately before posting information to School-sanctioned channels and personal accounts. If you realize you have posted inaccurate or potentially offensive information, you must correct it immediately.

Employees are required to maintain the confidentiality of the School's private or confidential information. Employees must not post internal reports, procedures or other internal business-related confidential communications.

Any communication over the School's network may be monitored and retained by the administration. Therefore, please ensure that when communicating over the School's network, you do so in a professional manner and in accordance with the School's Acceptable Use, Electronic Communications and Other Technology, and Internet Usage policies.

Given students' growing reliance on texting, we ask faculty and staff to use the same good judgment in sending texts as they would in sending email and posting to social media sites. While texting is not a social platform in the same sense as sites such as Facebook, Instagram and X, texts are just as shareable as status updates and comments. And even though texts are easily deleted on your personal devices, they live on forever in phone company records. Finally, we must be mindful of the time of day and the frequency with which we communicate with students and colleagues. See the "Communications & Interactions" with students policy for further detail regarding appropriate texting parameters.

Any concerns regarding faculty and staff use of text messages or social media channels should be immediately forwarded to Blair's Associate Head of School, Dean of Faculty Life and/or Director of Communications.

The School expects that any concerns about students' safety, well-being and behavior (including potential violations of the Student Handbook) will be promptly reported to the Student Life Office, whether the information in question comes from social media or other sources.

The School will determine whether a particular social media and/or Internet communication violates the School's policies. The School may request that employees edit or remove any communications or posts, in accordance with the School's policies and/or applicable law.

Definitions

Social Media Channels

Websites and other applications used for social networking (including, but not limited to Facebook, Threads, X, Flickr, Vimeo, YouTube, What'sAppLinkedIn, Snapchat, Vine, Instagram, Pinterest and TikTok).

Personal Social Media Channels

All social media channels other than those accounts sanctioned by the School.

School-Sanctioned Social Media Channels

Those social media channels proposed to and approved by the Blair Communications Department, which can be obtained from the Director of Communications.

School-Sanctioned Social Media

The School maintains many social media accounts. Any social media account not reported to and approved by the Communications Department will be considered a personal social media channel. As such, any account purporting to be an official School platform that has not been officially sanctioned by the Communications Department must be reported immediately to the Director of Communications. In the event that a Blair social media channel is not sanctioned by the Communications Department, it must be deactivated immediately by the faculty or staff member who created it.

Anyone desiring to create a new School-sanctioned social media account must request permission, in writing, from the Director of Communications. If the request is approved, the Communications Department will provide the employee with the School's guidelines about how to best use Blair's logo, colors, fonts and images, as well as appropriate interactions with students on the approved account/channel (i.e., employees should never follow, friend or tag students in their posts). Any School-sanctioned social media platform that has a known lifespan—e.g., for a specific sports season or campaign—must be deleted and no longer updated once the lifespan ends so that search-engine results for Blair do not return results for outdated materials on now-defunct social media accounts/channels.

Any employee creating a School-sanctioned social media account must provide a username and password for the account to the Communications Department as a condition precedent to the site's being sanctioned. There are no exceptions to this rule. It is the employee's obligation to notify the Communications Department immediately if the user name or password for the social media site is changed.

Managing student-created social media accounts in Blair's name has also become an issue in recent years, particularly because the School cannot delete abandoned groups, pages, channels or feeds if it does not have login information. The administration asks that employees who become aware of student-run social media platforms that bear the School's name instruct students to report the existence of such accounts (along with usernames and passwords) to the Student Life Office and Communications Department.

Prohibited Contact

1. It is unacceptable for employees to post comments that are discriminatory, harassing or threatening in nature.

2. Employees are prohibited from interacting with current or prospective students via public or private personal social media accounts/channels. This includes “friending,” “following,” “tagging,” “connecting” or “collabing” with current or prospective students (or accepting such requests), commenting on students’ private or public social media feeds, posting pictures or video of current or prospective students, or in any way engaging with current or prospective students through their personal accounts. The only exception to this rule would be sharing posts made by Blair on its official channels or parents of current Blair students who are posting images of their own children. Blair’s expectation is that employees who have already “friended,” “followed,” “connected” or “collabed” with current or prospective students will defriend, unfollow and disconnect from those individuals after reading this policy.

3. Employees are prohibited from posting comments regarding current or prospective students on any public or private personal social media channels (again, with an exception being made for their own children). Those who run School-sanctioned accounts in Blair’s name may post photos of current and prospective students with their first name and the first letter of their last name and class year (as long as they confirm with the Communications Department the parents of those featured have signed Blair’s photo/video release, which is done annually). On School-sanctioned accounts, employees can comment on, react to, or reply to student comments, but they should never friend or follow students’ personal accounts or tag them. Collabing through school accounts is permitted.

4. Employees are prohibited from sharing personal or confidential information (e.g., contact information, health records, date of birth) pertaining to any members of the Blair community, including without limitation: students, faculty, staff, parents, family members, Trustees, donors and alums of the School.

5. Employees are prohibited from posting pictures of students to Blair-sanctioned channels who are on the Communications Department’s list of students for whom permission has been withheld by parents. Before posting a photo of a current or prospective student on a School-sanctioned social media platform, you must first check with the Communications Department to ensure that permission has not been withheld by parents.

6. Harassment of other employees or students via social media will not be tolerated. Blogs or communications through social networking services must not violate the School’s conduct-related policies. Even after deleting a blog, certain technology may still make that content available to readers.

Violations of the School’s social media policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

For an updated list of School-sanctioned social media channels, please see the Communications Department. Anyone who has been granted permission to run a School-sanctioned account must obtain and review a list of guidelines for that account from the Director of Communications.

OUTSIDE EMPLOYMENT

The School discourages outside employment during the academic year. Full-time employees who accept external employment or engage in external business activities outside the School should

conduct this work outside of normal working hours. This work should not interfere or conflict with your job responsibilities at Blair Academy.

Employees will be judged by appropriate performance standards, and will be subject to the School's scheduling demands, regardless of whether an employee has more than one job. The School expects that any other job will not conflict in time or content with an employee's position at the School. In the event that the School determines that an employee is neglecting their responsibilities to the School due to outside employment or outside business activities, they may be asked to terminate the outside employment or outside business activities or will risk disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment from the School. Outside employment and outside business activities will present a conflict of interest if they have, or potentially have, an adverse impact on the School.

If employees wish to offer private lessons or private tutoring to individuals within or outside of the Blair community, they must speak with the Head of School office.

CREDIT CARD POLICY

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to communicate eligibility, usage and payment of expenditure requirements for Blair Academy's corporate credit card. Adherence to this policy is necessary to meet the standards of Blair Academy's auditors.

Policies

- Blair Academy will issue a corporate credit card to eligible employees for job-related expenses. Being a corporate cardholder is a privilege.
- Employees shall use their corporate credit cards to charge business-related expenses. Expenses must be for approved budget items only. Any items not budgeted must be authorized by the Chief Financial & Operations Officer or Head of School.
- Personal purchases of any type are strictly prohibited. If a personal purchase accidentally occurs on the School credit card, the employee must make payment in the Business Office within 30 days or request a payroll deduction for the amount owed.
- Employees may NOT take cash advances on Blair Academy credit cards.
- Employees are responsible for all charges made to the card. The employee will be held liable for any unauthorized items appearing on the credit card statement. The budget manager approval must be noted in the description of the transaction.
- Cardholders are required to sign the "cardholder agreement" (which will be provided by the business office) indicating they accept those terms. Individuals who do not adhere to these policies and procedures risk revocation of their credit card privileges and/or disciplinary action.

Procedures

- The Chief Financial & Operations Officer authorizes the use of corporate credit cards and assigns credit limits.
- Upon receiving a corporate credit card, the employee should call the (800) number on the front of the card to activate it and sign the back of the card.
- Before any purchases are made, the employee should verify that the funds are available in their budget to cover the expense(s).

- The employee must obtain an itemized receipt for the purchase AND include a brief description of the business purpose and the budget account code on the receipt. In the case of meals, each receipt should include names of all persons involved in the purchase, in accordance with Internal Revenue Service regulations.
- All receipts and information relating to each charge, including the account to be charged, the receipt, who was involved and what the business-related purpose was for the charge are to be uploaded into the JPMorgan Chase credit card approval portal no later than the fifth day of each month. Failure to complete the necessary documentation by the deadline could result in your credit card privileges being suspended.
- Upon receipt of the credit card statement, the Business Office will review receipts to confirm appropriate accounting codes. The statement, along with a summary, will be submitted to the Director of Finance for approval. Any transaction where a receipt is not available, the employee must complete and sign the Lost Receipt Form, which is located on the faculty/staff portal of Blair's website. If no receipt or form is provided, the transaction will be the personal responsibility of the cardholder (unless the expense is an authorized monthly deduction).
- The employee must notify the Business Office immediately, and call JPMorgan Chase (1-800-207-5359) in the event a card is lost or stolen. The employee is also responsible for reviewing transactions to ensure that no fraudulent charges have occurred.
- The corporate credit card is the property of Blair Academy. An employee leaving the employment of Blair Academy must surrender the credit card to the Business Office and they will notify the issuing authority to cancel the employee's account.

MISCELLANEOUS BILLS

Although Blair employees should not make personal charges to their Blair credit cards—which are issued to pay for school-related expenses—there are times that mistakes are made and employees must reimburse the School. At times, personal charges for the services of FedEx or UPS are allocated to Blair as well. Expenses related to both of these scenarios will appear on employee miscellaneous account bills issued regularly and which should be paid off as soon as possible.

Blair Academy credit card holders should not make work-related purchases on their personal credit cards and then seek reimbursement.

BLAIR ACADEMY TRAVEL & EXPENSE GUIDELINES

Blair Academy expects its employees to travel and entertain in the most appropriate, safe, comfortable and efficient manner possible. The School also expects employees to use reasonable efforts to take advantage of any discounts or other available cost-saving measures in order to maximize the use of the institution's resources.

This policy will not address every situation that may arise while traveling on Blair business, but we anticipate that these general guidelines will establish acceptable parameters and expectations. Ultimately, we hope that all employees will use their best judgment when deciding what is an appropriate and reasonable expense to be charged to the School versus a personal benefit where the cost should be paid by them.

Spending guidelines

In general, all travel and meal expenses will be covered by Blair Academy as long as the expenses are reasonable, incurred in the best interest of the School and all documentation completed as outlined in these guidelines.

Travel

Economy class should be used for all air or train travel unless the trip is anticipated to be longer than eight hours in duration. Car services should only be utilized when the cost is less than driving and paying for the parking. In cases where a car service to the airport is necessary, you should use the service designated by the School for all student travel. Any exceptions to this policy should be pre-approved by either the Chief Financial & Operations Officer or the Director of Finance.

If you must rent a car while traveling, please follow Blair's [vehicle rental policy](#).

In the event of local travel, please use a School vehicle whenever possible and have it fueled up at Phillips 66 in Blairstown. In the event you cannot use a Blair vehicle because one is not available, the School will reimburse the employee \$.76/ mile (which covers gasoline expenses, as well as any costs associated with damage to your vehicle while traveling).

Lodging

When your business travel requires you to stay overnight, employees are expected to find reasonably priced lodging. Please use a guide of approximately \$225 per night in non-metro areas and \$350 per night in metro areas.

Meals

The School also recognizes that meal costs can vary significantly depending on location so the following is provided as a guideline while using common sense of what is reasonable. The range below provides some variance but, in general, you should adhere to the lower limits. However, if you are entertaining legitimate guests or business associates of the School, it may be appropriate to be at the higher end of the range.

Employees may consume alcohol in moderation at School-sponsored events, gatherings or functions at which alcohol is served, provided that they behave professionally and in accordance with common standards of acceptable conduct at all times. In general, alcoholic beverages are permitted in moderation, both in amount and price (up to \$35 per bottle of wine). Please use your discretion on both accounts (for more about Blair's alcohol use policy).

Suggested range per person, including tip, & tax

Breakfast: \$10-\$20

Lunch: \$20-\$30

Dinner: \$30-\$70

When a meal is provided to Blair-related guests in the home of an employee, only actual out-of-pocket costs relating to that specific event will be paid by Blair.

If the presence of an employee's partner is required during travel or meals, then those costs will be covered by the School; however this should be approved ahead of time by a supervisor.

Incidentals

Reasonable charges for tips, small gifts to alumni and hosts while traveling, Internet connection fees and business center use are all permitted costs of traveling when they are directly related to school business.

Non-reimbursable expenses

- Personal entertainment (such as books, magazines, movies, sightseeing, athletic contests, concerts etc.)
- Mini-bar charges
- Kennel costs for pets
- Traffic or parking violations
- Personal care items (toiletries, medication, etc.)
- Massages, pedicures, tanning, etc.
- Any incremental costs associated with a partner or other family member traveling unless previously approved.

Proper accounting

School credit card documentation: Those employees who use a School credit card should login to JPMorgan Chase's portal, upload receipts, assign all charges to a budget and provide an explanation of the expense by the 10th of the month (getting approval of their supervisors or other departments as needed). If proper documentation is not provided in a timely manner, the School may suspend the use of the credit card until further notice.

Reimbursements

In the event an employee needs to be reimbursed for out-of-pocket expenses while on a School business trip, they should retain all receipts that will qualify for reimbursement as per above. Within 30 days of the trip, the employee must complete and submit to blairpayables@blair.edu an expense report or check requisition including reasons for the trip, account numbers and appropriate receipts. These documents should be approved by the appropriate supervisor prior to submission to the Business Office. Any expenses not reimbursed within 60 days or by the close of the fiscal year will not be processed.

Travel advances

If you anticipate out-of-pocket expenses prior to your trip, you may come to the Business Office to receive a cash advance. Cash advances will not be issued for less than \$50 and any advance over \$250 needs approval from the appropriate supervisor. The process for clearing a cash advance is the same as a reimbursement, except that all cash advances must be cleared within 10 business days of the completion of the trip.

Criteria for determining an allowable expense

The School asks that, in the course of spending Blair Academy funds, that you consider whether or not you are being a good steward of the funds that have been entrusted to us by alumni, parents and other constituents, and that you ask yourself:

- Is the expense necessary?
- Is the expense reasonable?
- Is the expense appropriate?
- Is the expense allowable?

Any questions regarding these guidelines should be directed to either the Chief Financial & Operations Officer or the Director of Finance.

PURCHASING

This policy is intended to ensure that all purchases made in the interest of Blair Academy are done in a manner that:

- Maximizes Blair's purchasing power by using existing vendors and accounts that already include previously negotiated discounts that might not be available to all purchasers.
- Vendors such as Amazon may advertise the lowest price but many times our negotiated prices with vendors are lower.
- Takes full advantage of our tax-exempt status by utilizing Blair's tax exemption form located in the faculty/staff portal of Blair's website.
- When appropriate, include a bidding process for the purchase with multiple vendors providing competitive bids.
- Provides for efficient delivery of products or services to campus.
- Includes appropriate documentation to allow for a full audit of the purchase process.
- When appropriate, all warranties are captured and retained for future use if necessary.
- Provides for prompt payment to all vendors to ensure loyalty.
- Provides prompt payment to take advantage of any payment discounts that might be available.

METHODS OF PURCHASING

Blair prefers to centralize all School purchases through the Business Office and can be executed as follows:

Communicate all of the necessary details of your purchase to the Business Services & Support Coordinator by emailing orders@blair.edu and include all of the required information for the purchase so that the items can be made on your behalf. All orders should include the quantity

desired, the account to be charged and any delivery requirements.

- If you locate an item online, you can send the URL for the item to orders@blair.edu and we will order that item (or a similar one) from either that vendor or one with which we already have a relationship established. All orders should include the quantity desired, the account to be charged and any delivery requirements. Please follow this protocol and do not charge such items on a Blair credit card.

Preferred vendors

- Office/classroom supplies: Quill, Wayfair, Amazon and Staples
- Building supplies/hardware: Ace Hardware, Home Depot, Blue Ridge and Lowe's

Purchase orders:

If you cannot send the information for your purchase to the Business Office or need to pick up the item at the vendor's location, then you can inquire to see if they will take a purchase order (PO), an agreement made by Blair Academy to pay the stated vendor for the listed items upon receipt. This allows the vendor to send Blair Academy an invoice for payment instead of payment being required at the time of pickup.

Invoices

All invoices should be sent directly to blairpayables@blair.edu for payment in a timely manner. Invoices can only be accepted in PDF format; the Paymerang system cannot recognize any other formats. Invoices being sent to blairpayables@blair.edu from an established vendor do not need a check request or W-9 to be completed.

Blair Academy credit card

If the two previous methods of purchase are not available, the next option is to use a Blair Academy credit card for the purchase. All purchases using a Blair credit card will need to be processed and approved through the JPMorgan Chase Smartcard portal and receipts provided. This processing must be done by the cardholder and processed in a timely manner each month.

Purchase reimbursements

If none of the options previously described are available, then you may continue to purchase your product with your own funds and proceed to get reimbursed by Blair Academy. This method is not preferred and should not be used for any purchases that involve sales tax or are greater than \$250.

Methods of reimbursement

- For all reimbursements under \$100, you should submit or bring your receipts along with the proper approvals and account numbers supplied by the budget manager, to the Business Services & Support Coordinator for a cash reimbursement.
- If your reimbursement is for travel-related expenses, please complete an expense report and either submit for reimbursement through the Business Office or blairpayables@blair.edu, depending on the amount of reimbursement as described above.
- All reimbursements more than \$100 should be submitted to blairpayables@blair.edu as a PDF document that includes a check request and all receipts scanned in as one complete document. Do not scan in separately.

- All reimbursements should be processed within 14 days of the original purchase in order to ensure that budgets remain up to date.

Compensation

Any employee that is entitled to additional compensation such as for student transportation or any other school-related activity should submit their timesheet to blairpayables@blair.edu and expect to receive payment through payroll. This process is different from a reimbursement and, as such, will go through payroll and be recorded accordingly.

If you have any questions regarding this policy, please reach out to the Chief Financial & Operations Officer, Director of Finance or Business Services & Support Coordinator.

II. THE WORKPLACE

STANDARDS OF CONDUCT

To ensure orderly operations and provide a supportive, professional workplace, the School expects each employee to observe and follow School policies and to maintain proper standards of conduct at all times and protect the interests and safety of all employees, students and visitors. Accordingly, employees are expected to be a positive reflection of the School by being courteous to students, parents, families and other visitors, by using the School's resources and equipment appropriately, and by complying with the School's policies and practices and with federal, state and local laws. For all employees, professional conduct should be a matter of course.

While it is not possible to list all forms of behavior that are considered unacceptable in the workplace, the following are examples of violations that may result in disciplinary action, up to and including discharge: violation of the School's policies or safety rules; physical, verbal or emotional abuse of a child; endangering the safety of a child; inappropriate conduct, including inappropriate friendships, relationships and socialization with students of the School; insubordination; unauthorized or illegal possession of illegal controlled substances and/or prescription medications; working under the influence of alcohol or illegal controlled substances; use, distribution, transfer, or sale of alcohol or illegal controlled substances on work premises or during working hours, while engaged in School activities or in the School vehicles; unauthorized possession, use or sale of weapons, firearms or explosives on work premises; theft, damage to or inappropriate removal or possession of property of the School, students, parents, co-workers or visitors; unethical, dishonest or criminal conduct; physical, verbal or written harassment or discrimination; sexual harassment; disrespect toward students, visitors or other members of the public; use of Blair property, equipment or facilities in connection with outside work while on Blair time; fighting or threatening violence in the workplace; poor attendance; unsatisfactory or poor job performance or conduct; or unauthorized disclosure of proprietary, confidential or personal information or violation of the School's policies that seek to protect such information. These examples are not all inclusive, and discipline decisions will be based on an assessment of all relevant factors.

If an employee's performance, work habits, overall attitude, conduct or demeanor becomes unsatisfactory, as determined by the School, based on violations of this policy or of any other policies or rules of the School, the employee may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Disciplinary action may include a verbal warning, a written warning, and a suspension without pay and/or discharge. The appropriate disciplinary action imposed will be determined by Blair Academy, and the School does not guarantee that one form of action will necessarily precede another.

Nothing in this policy is designed to modify our employment-at-will policy.

SETTING BOUNDARIES

One of the most difficult but absolute sets of professional expectations has to do with setting clear and conscious boundaries between ourselves and our students. We must never lose sight of our role as adults with moral and legal authority over students who are our subordinates and, in most cases, legal minors.

COMMUNICATIONS & INTERACTIONS WITH STUDENTS

The relationships that students develop over time with employees of the School is an important aspect of the Blair experience. The School supports these relationships and is committed to ensuring that they are formed and maintained in ways that contribute to the well-being and safety of its students and the adults whose responsibilities entail working closely with them. In light of the influence, power imbalances and trust inherent in these relationships, it is important to provide guidelines for appropriate conduct. These guidelines, in conjunction with the School's policies on harassment and with any other policies regulating student and employee behavior, define the boundaries that should exist between students and the adults who work at the School. It should be noted, however, that these policies regarding employee-student interactions do not necessarily apply when the adult employee is the parent or guardian of the student in question.

Communications

All School employees are responsible for creating, modeling, and maintaining healthy, supportive, and appropriate boundaries with students and alumni of the School. While the School values employees' efforts to connect with students in a positive and healthy manner, even well-intentioned interactions with students can be problematic where they are inherently personal or overly emotional.

When communicating and interacting with students, employees are expected to display respect and concern for students through their language, humor and physical contact. This does not mean that students cannot be constructively criticized, addressed firmly or reprimanded. However, these instances must not be personally degrading or include comments about the student's physical appearance (dress excepted), nor include any inappropriate reference to the student's gender, race, religion, sexual orientation, national origin or other protected characteristic. Employees who receive communications from a student which are of an inherently personal or emotional nature should seek guidance and support from the Dean of Faculty Life and/or the Associate Head of School.

Employees should avoid having emotional confrontations with students, particularly in public settings, whenever possible. Employees are expected to correct or criticize students in an appropriate manner, with the criticism focused on the student's inappropriate behavior, rather than the student specifically. Further, employees are expected to have what may be difficult, critical conversations with students in a private manner (in some cases, it may be helpful to have a colleague join you if the issue is particularly volatile or if you are concerned about how a student might react).

Employees should refrain from excessive communications with students, and from communications post "lights out," keeping in mind appropriate frequency, time of day, tone and topic. Only School-provided email accounts should be used to communicate with students by email. We recognize that mobile calls and text messaging are increasingly common, especially if an employee is in need of a quick response, in an emergency situation, communicating via group text strings or needs to schedule meetings or appointments. Communications with students should directly relate to the work an employee does at Blair in their various roles. Although texting students within the guidance above is permissible, employees should never communicate with students via their personal email or personal social media platforms.

Physical Contact

Employees are required, at all times, to exhibit a professional and appropriate demeanor in their interactions with students and must refrain from engaging in inappropriate physical conduct with

them. Physical contact should be limited to a brief supportive or congratulatory hug, arm squeeze, high five or pat on the back if appropriate. Please consider first asking what the student may need to feel comforted or supported to help establish that there is consent for the interaction. Patting of the buttocks, even in the context of an athletic event, is always unacceptable. If a student engages in repeated or prolonged physical contact with an employee, the employee should seek to reset the appropriate boundary and seek guidance from the Associate Head of School or Dean of Students.

Sexual contact of any nature with a student (including kissing or touching) is both unprofessional and immoral and shall lead to immediate termination. All sexual or romantic physical contact or communications with students (including text messages and communications by other electronic means) are strictly prohibited. Moreover, beyond the professional consequences at Blair, the State of New Jersey may determine that sexual contact between teacher and student violates state law, leading to criminal and/or civil actions. The obligation to maintain appropriate boundaries extends to employees' interactions with recent graduates of the School. Relationships with former students present their own sets of complications, and employees should endeavor to be role models to alumni in the same manner as with current students. Employees may not become personally involved in a romantic or sexual manner with a former student for at least three years following that student's graduation from Blair/high school.

Responding to Boundary Crossing/Inappropriate Conduct

If an employee receives information about a boundary crossing or inappropriate conduct by an employee directed toward a student, whether the information is a direct complaint or is obtained in some other manner (such as from overhearing a group conversation), the employee must report it as outlined below. Anyone making a report in good faith will be covered by the School's Whistleblower Policy.

Boundaries are often crossed inadvertently and may require nothing more than a reminder to the adult or student to maintain the boundary in the future. At other times, the crossing of a boundary indicates a more serious problem.

Any suspicion of sexual, romantic, or inappropriate relations or boundary crossings by an employee with a student will be thoroughly investigated, and a finding of such conduct will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, and/or notification to the appropriate authorities.

Information about boundary crossings and inappropriate conduct should be brought to the immediate attention of the Head of School, Dean of Faculty Life, and/or Associate Head of School (or, if it involves the Head of School, to the Chair of the Board of Trustees). Moreover, if an employee believes that a current or former student under the age of 21 has been placed at imminent risk of serious harm because of a violation of this policy, the employee is required to report such concern to one of the individuals listed above.

COMMUNICATION WITH STUDENTS' PARENTS/GUARDIANS

The importance of effective communication with parents/guardians of students cannot be stressed enough. The School strives to have a positive relationship with all parents and guardians, which includes having open lines of communication. The following principles apply to all communications with parents/guardians of current students:

- Do not share sensitive documents or information such as personnel letters, contents of discussions at faculty/staff meetings, and memos/emails that contain confidential, sensitive or proprietary information of the School with parents/guardians.
- Do not disclose to a parent/guardian information regarding another student or parent/guardian of a student without prior authorization from the Head of School or Associate Head of School.
- Employees have many points of connection with students, including but not limited to their roles as classroom teachers, coaches, dorm staff, advisors, monitors and, more generally, adult mentors in the community. When communicating with parents or family members, employees should be mindful of frequency, time of day, tone and topic, looping in the Associate Head of School or Dean of Faculty Life if questions or concerns arise.
- Faculty members are encouraged to submit a commendation to OnCampus and OnRecord whenever a student with whom they are connected does something praiseworthy; parents and students appreciate when these are forwarded with a note of congratulations or encouragement.
- Employees serving in the role of monitor are expected to email or call parents/guardians if their student's academic performance is low or drops precipitously, or if their student exhibits inappropriate behavior. The Associate Head of School and advisor should always be contacted before an email is sent or a phone call is made about a behavioral issue.

Employees should encourage parents/guardians to call or set up a meeting if they have questions or concerns regarding their students. It is important to produce a written record of conferences with parents/guardians when academic, social or behavioral problems are discussed. It can be in the form of a summary within an email or written in a separate document that is then sent to the parents/guardians and/or the Associate Head of School and advisor after the conference.

Additionally, some of our students may come from multiple households or co-parenting arrangements. These situations can be stressful for parents/guardians and confusing for students. While the School will support these students and families, it is the School's position not to become involved in divorce proceedings, child custody actions or other legal matters involving a student's family, unless otherwise required by law.

In the event an employee is contacted by a parent/guardian, lawyer or other professional involved in a divorce, child custody action, or any other legal matter on behalf of parents or guardians of a student, the employee should direct the person making the inquiry to the Associate Head of School. Employees should not provide information regarding another parent/guardian of a student and should always advise any person requesting this type of information to contact the Associate Head of School and then inform them of the contact.

COMMUNICATIONS AMONG EMPLOYEES

One of the most challenging and most important issues we face as a professional community is responsible, effective communication. Below are some specific suggestions/expectations. The

School's social media policy provides further rules and expectations.

- Endeavor to avoid allowing conflict, frustration, anger or unhappiness to simmer—talk to a colleague and/or administrator sooner than later. The Associate Head of School, your supervisor or the Director of Human Resources Operations can be helpful in advising on this.
- Use emails, text messages or other electronic communications for informative communication, not emotional venting. Be aware of the perils and consequences of inappropriate language, emotional outbursts or unprofessional conduct with email, text messages or other electronic communications. Even in informative messages, discretion must be used with sensitive, confidential correspondence, given the potential for emails and other electronic messages to gain wider distribution than intended. Finally, emails generated through the Blair system (i.e., @blair.edu) are “owned” by the School and subject to scrutiny if circumstances warrant.
- On a regular basis, use the advisor/monitor system to keep other faculty and staff in the loop about any concerns you may have regarding a student's behavior or performance. Immediately inform the Associate Head of School or the Dean of Students in the event you have concerns about any student (even if you're not quite sure why).
- When you receive an email, call or a voicemail, respond promptly, even if you need some advice beforehand. Indicate that you received the communication and will respond more fully soon, but do let your colleagues or supervisor know that you received the message as needed. In that regard, you are expected to check your voicemail boxes and email at least daily. Responses to voicemails or emails should be made within 24 hours.
- Employees who have nightly dormitory duty are expected to write dormitory reports that are shared with the appropriate distribution list.

POLITICAL ACTIVITY

Under the Internal Revenue Code, all section 501(c)(3) organizations are prohibited from directly or indirectly participating in, or intervening in, any political campaign on behalf of (or in opposition to) any candidate for elective public office. Contributions to political campaign funds or public statements of position (verbal or written) made on behalf of the organization in favor of or in opposition to any candidate for public office clearly violate the prohibition against political campaign activity. Violating this prohibition may result in denial or revocation of Blair Academy's tax-exempt status and the imposition of certain excise taxes.

As a school, it is imperative that Blair's educational mission (and its tax-exempt status) not be jeopardized due to real or perceived engagement in partisan political activity. Thus, while employees are free to express and promote a particular political viewpoint in their private lives, such promotion or expression is prohibited while working or performing job-related duties on behalf of the School on or off campus, including, but not limited to in the classroom, on duty during field trips or athletic events, or in dormitories or other School-provided housing. Additionally, the posting of campaign signs or pamphlets or literature on the School's campus, including in or around School-provided housing, is prohibited.

HARASSMENT

Blair Academy is committed to providing a work environment that is free of harassment based on an individual's personal characteristic protected under federal or state law. This policy is intended to describe the conduct of this nature that is prohibited at the School.

Employees are prohibited from engaging in any verbal, written, or physical conduct that denigrates or shows hostility or aversion related to a person's race, color, creed, religion, national origin, nationality, ancestry, age, sex, pregnancy, breastfeeding, marital status, domestic partnership/civil union status, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, genetic information or refusal to submit to or provide the results from any genetic test, disability or atypical hereditary cellular or blood trait, veteran status or current military service obligations with the Armed Forces of the United States, or any other status protected by applicable law and that has the purpose or effect of creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive environment or unreasonably interferes with an employee's work performance.

While it is not easy to define precisely what harassment is, it includes, but is not limited to: using slurs, epithets, threats, derogatory comments or visual depictions, or making unwelcome jokes and teasing that focus on a protected characteristic; and circulating or displaying written or graphic material that denigrates or shows hostility or aversion toward a person or group because of a protected characteristic.

Any employee who believes that they are a victim of prohibited harassment or is being or has been retaliated against for complaining of prohibited harassment or witnesses such conduct, is encouraged to immediately notify the Director of Human Resources Operations. If you prefer not to discuss the matter with this administrator, you may contact any other member of the administrative team with whom you feel comfortable. Any administrator receiving such a report is required to notify the Director of Human Resources Operations.

1. Blair Academy will investigate every reported incident in a prompt and thorough manner. Any employee of Blair Academy who has been found to have violated this policy may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including immediate discharge. The School will also take appropriate corrective action to address harassment by non-employees.
2. Blair Academy will conduct all investigations in a discreet manner, but full confidentiality may not be possible and will be maintained to the extent practicable under the circumstances. We recognize that every investigation requires a determination based on all the facts in the matter. We also recognize the serious impact a false accusation can have. Accordingly, it is the responsibility of all employees to act responsibly and in good faith when making a complaint.
3. The reporting employee and any employee participating in any investigation under this policy have the School's assurance that no reprisals will be taken as a result of lodging a good-faith harassment complaint. It is our policy to encourage discussion of the matter to help protect others from being subjected to inappropriate behavior and/or retaliation.
4. Employees found to have engaged in misconduct constituting prohibited harassment will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

5. If any one person directly involved in a prohibited harassment investigation is dissatisfied with the outcome or resolution, that person or persons may request a review of the resolution by the Head of School.
6. If an investigation results in a finding that the person or persons complaining did so in bad faith, that person or persons may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

SEXUAL HARASSMENT

Blair Academy has zero tolerance for any form of sexual harassment. Sexual harassment means sexual advances, requests for sexual favors and/or verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature when: (1) submission to or rejection of such conduct or advances is explicitly or implicitly made a term or condition of employment; (2) submission to or rejection of such conduct is used as the basis for employment decisions; (3) such conduct has the purpose or effect, whether intended or not, of unreasonably interfering with work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile, humiliating, or offensive working environment. An impermissible hostile environment can, thus, be created unintentionally by the use of sexual comments, jokes or teasing, or any sexual pictures or drawings on campus, at any school-related events or in the presence of students.

The legal definition of sexual harassment is broad and includes other sexually oriented conduct that is unwelcome and has the effect, whether intended or not, of creating a workplace that is hostile, offensive, intimidating or humiliating. While it is not possible to list all of the circumstances that may constitute sexual harassment, the following are some examples of conduct which, if unwelcome, may constitute sexual harassment, depending on the circumstances, including the severity and pervasiveness of the conduct:

- Sexual advances, whether or not they involve physical touching.
- Epithets or jokes of a sexual nature, written or oral references to sexual conduct, discussion of one's sex life, or comments about an individual's sexual prowess, deficiencies or activity.
- Display of objects, pictures or cartoons of a sexual nature.
- Leering, whistling or physical touching of another's body.
- Continuing to ask another employee to socialize after the employee has said no.

Whatever form it takes, sexual harassment is illegal, insulting and demeaning to the recipient and will not be tolerated at Blair Academy. All employees, managers, non-supervisors and vendors alike must comply with this zero-tolerance policy and take appropriate measures to ensure that such conduct does not occur.

Any employee who feels that they are the victim of sexual harassment should report such actions in accordance with the following procedures. All complaints will be promptly and thoroughly investigated.

1. Any employee who believes that they are a victim of sexual harassment or retaliated against for complaining of sexual harassment or witnesses such conduct, is encouraged to immediately report it to the Director of Human Resources Operations. If you prefer not to discuss the matter with this administrator, you may contact any other member of the

administrative team with whom you feel comfortable. Any administrator receiving such a report is required to notify the Director of Human Resources Operations.

2. Blair Academy will investigate every reported incident in a prompt and thorough manner. Any employee, supervisor or agent of Blair Academy who has been found to have violated this policy may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including immediate discharge. The School will also take appropriate corrective action to address sexual harassment by non-employees.
3. Blair Academy will conduct all investigations in a discreet manner, but full confidentiality may not be possible and will be maintained to the extent practicable under the circumstances. We recognize that every investigation requires a determination based on all the facts in the matter. We also recognize the serious impact a false accusation can have. Accordingly, it is the responsibility of all employees to act responsibly and in good faith when making a complaint.
4. The reporting employee and any employee participating in any investigation under this policy have the School's assurance that no reprisals will be taken as a result of lodging a good-faith sexual harassment complaint. It is our policy to encourage discussion of the matter to help protect others from being subjected to inappropriate behavior and/or retaliation.
5. Employees found to have engaged in misconduct constituting sexual harassment will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.
6. If anyone directly involved in a sexual harassment investigation is dissatisfied with the outcome or resolution, that person or persons, may request a review of the resolution by the Head of School.
7. If an investigation results in a finding that the person or persons complaining did so in bad faith, that person or persons may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

INTERPERSONAL EMPLOYEE RELATIONS

In general, Blair Academy neither encourages nor discourages personal relationships between employees. However, in reminding employees that modeling appropriate adult behavior is a very important part of their role in a residential school, the School does expect employees to be discreet and sensitive with regard to all personal relationships. Moreover, should a relationship compromise an employee's responsibilities, the School would have no choice but to question the appropriateness of employee behavior and potentially invoke disciplinary action.

Employees are required to immediately contact the Director of Human Resources Operations and the Head of School if they become involved in a romantic relationship with an individual in their direct chain of command (i.e., with a supervisor or with an individual whom they supervise), or if an employee moves positions internally, resulting in an individual supervising another employee with whom they are in a romantic relationship. These types of relationships create the potential for conflicts of interest to arise.

Blair Academy may take whatever steps it deems necessary to ensure that those engaging in such close personal relationships do not work under circumstances in which undue influence or conflicts of interest may arise. Such steps may include transferring one or both employees, modifying an employee's job responsibilities or supervisory authority, determining that one of the employees may not remain employed by the School and/or asking the individuals to enter into a written relationship agreement. The administration has the discretion to determine which steps to take in a particular circumstance, but may take into account various factors. These include, for example, the nature of the working relationship, the job responsibilities and supervisory authority of each employee, and the department in which they work.

As noted later in this *Handbook*, full-time employees may receive housing for themselves, their legal dependents, spouses and/or domestic partners as a condition of employment. All such housing is assigned and approved by the Head of School. Please note that the School cannot allow residential faculty to host guests in Blair housing for longer than a reasonable visit (i.e., shorter when school is in session; longer over holidays); our tax-exempt status might be challenged if non-dependents were perceived as using school housing as a residence.

OPEN DOOR POLICY

The School is committed to providing a workplace that is supportive and responsive. Part of this commitment is encouraging an open and frank atmosphere in which any problem, complaint, suggestion or question receives a timely response from the School. Blair Academy recognizes that problems may develop which require attention and understanding. Employees are encouraged to discuss problems openly with their supervisors before they become serious. Employees are also encouraged to report disputes and conflicts to their supervisors or the Associate Head of School, Head of School, Director of Human Resources Operations or to any other member of the administrative team with whom the employee feels comfortable.

DRESS POLICY

Employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of personal cleanliness, hygiene and grooming and present a neat, professional appearance at all times. The School may define what is and is not appropriate professional attire and its expectations for employee appearance. The School may make exceptions to the dress code in accordance with sincerely held religious tenets.

The following represent acceptable attire:

- Shirts/tops: Collared shirts, tailored blouses, turtlenecks or sweaters.
- Pants: Khakis, trousers (leggings may only be worn under long tops or skirts or dresses).
- Dresses/skirts.
- Footwear: Dress shoes, clean sneakers or dress sandals.

Whether or not your job responsibilities place you in direct contact with our constituents, you represent the School with your appearance, as well as your actions. Properly attired employees help to create a favorable image for Blair to the public, prospective and current families, alumni, donors, friends and fellow employees. Please note that hats must not be worn indoors by employees.

On certain occasions, more formal attire is required. Choice of formal dress should be sincere and consistent with the significance of the occasion. Any comparable ethnic attire to that which is described above is acceptable.

If the School feels that an employee's personal appearance is inappropriate, the employee may be asked to leave the workplace until they are properly dressed or groomed. Under such circumstances, the employee may not be compensated for the time away from work.

During times on campus when students are not present, the employee dress code can be more relaxed but should still be professional.

If you have any questions or would like to request any modification or exception to this policy (including any requests for accommodations), please contact the Director of Human Resources Operations or Dean of Faculty Life.

ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY

Blair Academy provides and maintains both a telephone and computer network for students, staff and faculty. The computer network includes Internet access, an email system, file resources, web-based services, network printing and a variety of software packages. Members of the community are expected to be responsible users of these systems and to use them in an ethical and legal manner consistent with the rules and expectations of the School. Improper use of the School systems may result in the loss of computer privileges, a disciplinary response or legal consequences.

Improper use includes the following:

- Any deliberate physical damage to any School-owned computer, computer peripheral or telephone.
- Deleting, editing, viewing or duplicating other users' files or voice messages without permission.
- Recording or sending obscene, inappropriate or threatening messages via any School-owned computer or telephone.
- Sending messages via any School-owned computer or telephone intended to bully or harass another person.
- Using the School systems to view, post or distribute obscene, profane or pornographic materials.
- Deliberately bypassing system security programs or protocols.
- Duplicating or distributing software or copyrighted material.
- Accessing or sharing other user accounts or passwords (users are expected to use only their own accounts at all times).
- Using Blair systems for personal profit or political lobbying.
- Installing software or performing similar activities which may lead to a breach in computer security or possible computer virus infection.
- Excessive waste of printer resources.

Students, faculty and staff are each assigned individual user accounts, which allow access to the computer network, email, Internet and web privileges. Users are responsible for their own computer

accounts and should not share their accounts with others under any circumstances. Student accounts may be disabled at night and at the discretion of the School.

Blair may assign, manage, access and withhold user accounts and data at its discretion. The School is not responsible for any damage which may occur to privately owned equipment used in conjunction with the School's systems or that is serviced by Blair personnel. The School assumes no responsibility for information or materials found on the Internet. Blair user accounts, including email addresses, are discontinued when an employee departs Blair for another professional opportunity, retirement or any other reason.

Blair Academy's technology resources are the property of the School. The School may monitor the use of the network, devices and the contents of email, voicemail and AI interactions when required to protect the integrity of the system or to comply with legal obligations. The School may inspect the contents of email, voicemail or AI conversations in the course of an investigation of impropriety. In addition, the School may conduct routine maintenance and track problems that might interfere with the function of the School network, the integrity of the email and voicemail systems, as well as AI accounts. In such cases, content of those messages and platforms may be revealed.

Users must recognize that there is no guarantee of privacy associated with their use of School technology resources. Users should not expect that email, voicemail, AI exchanges or other information created or maintained using Blair computers or servers are private, confidential or secure. The School provides Internet service to users on campus at its discretion, and may block or filter Internet content as it deems appropriate for an academic institution, or as necessary to ensure optimal performance for the majority of the users.

System Security

Employees are responsible for ensuring that their use of Blair information systems does not compromise the security of the School's computer systems and networks. These duties include taking reasonable precautions to prevent intruders from accessing the School's network by selecting a password and keeping it secret, following all password and user authentication protocols and complying with the School's firewall, anti-virus and spyware requirements.

Only authorized persons are permitted to install and repair School equipment. Employees are required to use the School's anti-theft systems, must exercise vigilance when equipment is used outside of School premises and must return all School equipment when their employment at the School ends. In the event of theft or other loss of School equipment, employees are required to immediately notify the Director of Technology and/or Director of Human Resources Operations.

Software

The School purchases and licenses the use of computer software for business and educational purposes. The School prohibits the illegal duplication of software and its related documentation.

Employees may not install or use encryption software on any School computers or network without first obtaining written authorization from the Director of Technology. Further, all employees are required to follow School encryption protocols.

ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS & OTHER TECHNOLOGY

As stated in the Acceptable Use Policy above, the School may provide information technology and communication resources (e.g., some or all of the following: computers, tablets, computer files, email, cell phones, facsimile, telephones, voicemail system, Internet access and software, and/or other electronic communication media) to employees for business purposes. The electronic communication media and resources provided to employees by the School, including the information therein, are the property of the School (the “School’s information systems”) and are intended primarily for School work-related uses. All employees are required to comply with this important policy.

Employees and partners/spouses who opt to establish and use a Blair email address should have no expectation of privacy for the use of, or for the information contained in, the School’s information systems, including, without limitation, any infrequent personal use of such systems.

All employees are required to comply with the following guidelines:

- The School’s information systems should be used primarily for School business. Any personal use of such systems should be minimal and must not interfere with the employee’s work-related activities or performance.
- Voicemail greetings and email signatures should be business-like and reflect an appropriate business-like image. The listing of a personal website or email address as part of the School’s email is not permitted.
- When sending or receiving email messages for business purposes, employees are required to use the School’s email system. Employees are prohibited from sending or forwarding School-related business information to personal email accounts.
- Communications (e.g., email, text and voicemail messages) may be inadvertently intercepted by someone who was not meant to receive them. For that reason, the School recommends that employees must use good judgment and ensure the protection and non-disclosure of information that is confidential.
- The School’s information systems should not be used for personal profit or gain (or for any scheme aimed at obtaining personal profit or gain), solicitation of non-School-related business or otherwise engaging in non-School-related commercial activities other than those expressly permitted by the Head of School.
- Employees are prohibited from infringing on the rights of Blair Academy and third parties, including intellectual property rights, whether relating to trademarks, copyrights, logos, multimedia creations, software, text, photos or images of any kind (*please see below for specifics about the trademarks and copyrights held by Blair*). Any statement with respect to copyright may not be deleted, and reproduction, adaptation or modification of the work of an author without the author’s consent is prohibited. Employees are prohibited from using links to websites which violate the law or infringe on Blair Academy’s or third-party rights.

Any employee who becomes aware of inappropriate use of School's information systems, including information security violations or the possible introduction of a virus, should immediately notify the Director of Technology and/or Director of Human Resources Operations.

INTERNET USAGE & E-MAIL MONITORING

Blair facilitates communication among colleagues and constituents and provides employees with the many benefits of high-speed Internet service.

Consistent with applicable federal and state law, the time you spend on the Internet at Blair is tracked through activity logs for business purposes. All abnormal usage will be investigated thoroughly. As such, employees should have no expectation of privacy with regard to their use of Blair's Internet system.

Employees learning of any misuse of the School's Internet network should notify the Director of Technology and/or Director of Human Resources Operations.

Blair's email system is intended for business use only. The use of Blair's e-mail system and Internet network to solicit fellow employees or distribute non-job-related information to fellow employees is strictly prohibited. Employees are also prohibited from the display or transmission of sexually explicit images, messages, ethnic slurs, racial epithets, or anything which could be construed as harassment or disparaging to others.

All email passwords must be made available to the School at all times.

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

For business purposes, management may enter, search, and/or monitor the School's email system and the files/transmission of any employee without advance notice and consistent with applicable state and federal law. As such, employees should have no expectation of privacy with regard to messages sent and received on Blair's email system.

USE OF BLAIR'S SEAL & WORDMARK

Please be aware that, as of August 2026, Blair has trademarked its seal, the wordmark BLAIR ACADEMY and several versions of the Blair "B" in blue and black with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. With additional marks pending, you may notice them appear in certain places with the ® or (™) symbols as a result. The marks are now registered federal trademarks on the Principal Trademark Register with protection in all 50 U.S. states.



Blair Academy

In addition, the Blair seal and various B's have been registered as copyright-protected works of art with the U.S. Copyright Office. As such, using the Blair wordmark, seal or B's for non-school-sponsored materials, programs, websites, accounts or apparel will be considered trademark infringement and/or copyright violation. Anyone using the Blair seal, wordmark or B's on programs or materials not approved, hosted or created by Blair should refrain from doing so. Should you have questions or wish to seek approval for use of these assets, please contact Blair's Business or Communications Offices for further information. Infringement of Blair Academy's protected marks or the intellectual property rights of any third party, including trademarks, copyrights, logos, multimedia content, software, text, photographs or images, is strictly prohibited because it may expose the School to legal liability and reputational harm.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Artificial intelligence (AI) refers to technologies—including machine learning algorithms, software and related tools—that simulate human intelligence.

AI use at Blair should always be considered in the framework of preserving the meaning-making, authenticity and human connection at the heart of Blair's mission.

While faculty and staff are encouraged to use AI tools to increase productivity, enhance efficiency and foster innovative problem-solving, the automation of tasks and workflows should always support the best educational experience possible for students. The end goal should be delivering fully on Blair's mission while saving time and resources where appropriate so employees can dedicate themselves to human-centered, meaningful work across areas of school life.

AI may be used to support employee work but employees must work in partnership with AI, taking at least a "human first, human last" approach to ensure that prompts into AI and outputs coming from it are designed intentionally. Ultimately, it is the responsibility of the employee to own the output of anything produced with AI.

All Blair employees have access to a variety of licensed AI software which is available through the technology office with supervisor approval. Currently licensed AI platforms include frontier large language models (LLMs) such as Gemini, Claude and ChatGPT (with all employees having access to Gemini through Blair's existing Google Workspace for Education subscription and others having upgraded to pro- or teams-level subscriptions on these platforms). Employees are expected to proactively and regularly assess the AI tools embedded in the software that Blair already pays for (Canva, Raiser's Edge, etc.) to ensure that the School is getting maximum benefit from operational expenditures, including AI-enabled features and add-ons.

Employees should always use licensed software in completing their Blair work because of the enhanced privacy and security features of paid platforms. If you need access to a paid subscription, please get supervisor approval and contact the technology office. All student use of AI should take place through Flint K-12 in partnership with faculty members, unless otherwise approved by the academic office.

As stated in the School's "Acceptable Use" and "Electronic Communications & Other Technology" policies in the *Employee Handbook*, any inputs and interactions with licensed AI software are accessible to and owned by Blair Academy.

General Acceptable Use of AI

AI may be used to:

- Inspire ideas, brainstorm and create content.
- Gather, organize and summarize information.
- Build background knowledge and support research.
- Analyze data sets and identify or visualize trends, provided that privacy of confidential or identifiable constituent and School data is protected (*see below*).
- Edit and refine written communications and other materials.
- When appropriate, automate routine tasks and workflows, provided that all outputs are reviewed and approved by the employee.

Accountability

Employees remain fully accountable for the performance of their responsibilities and for the accuracy and appropriateness of any work product created with the assistance of AI. Employees who use AI are expected to:

- **Be mindful of hallucinations:** Review, fact-check and verify AI-generated content using credible sources before relying on or sharing it.
- **Be transparent in its use:** Disclose the use of AI when appropriate based on the nature of the work. Supervisors will establish expectations regarding when AI use is encouraged, required or prohibited. Employees who are uncertain should consult their supervisor.
- **Act judiciously when working with data:** Protect confidential, proprietary and personally identifiable information (PII) by complying with all applicable School policies, including the "Protecting the School's Confidential Information" policy in the *Employee Handbook*.
- **Rely on professional judgment:** Ensure that AI-generated content is accurate and consistent with an employees' own professional knowledge and judgment, and aligned with the School's values and communications standards.
- **Use only School-approved, licensed AI tools:** AI platforms licensed by the school provide appropriate privacy and security protections. Free-to-use, unlicensed platforms, on the other hand, may use inputted data to train their models.

Transparency & Authenticity

- Copying and pasting unedited AI-generated language for the purpose of School publications is prohibited. Material copied directly from AI should not be submitted to the Communications Department for production of Blair materials or published independently in materials intended for internal or external Blair constituents.
- Misrepresenting unedited AI-generated work as one's own without appropriate disclosure is strictly prohibited. Such acknowledgement will vary by department and employees and supervisors should proactively establish clear expectations. Regardless of disclosure, an

employee who uses AI to create or refine a work product is fully responsible for the quality and accuracy of what is produced.

Images & Videos

While AI allows for the creation and editing of images and video, the ability to make and alter digital assets should never be used to produce or distribute deepfake images that depict others in non-consensual, derogatory or sexualized ways. Such use of AI by Blair employees is strictly prohibited.

More generally, in keeping with the School's commitment to authenticity, Blair policy prohibits the use of AI to create or substantially edit images with people in them, whether for internal or external use, except for very rare cases with clear and transparent disclosure.

Privacy & Security

In leveraging AI tools for tasks and workflows, employees should be always mindful of privacy when authenticating and automating on AI platforms; AI should never compromise the confidentiality or privacy of the School's constituents or data. Employees should also be mindful and cautious of the access they are giving AI platforms to their other School accounts if they are enabling access of AI to different apps, like Google Drive, as well as access to files and folders stored locally when working with LLMs on the desktop.

Blair's technology office should be consulted before purchasing, building or deploying any tool or platform that involves integrations with Blair data systems, APIs, third-party systems or reporting that uses confidential, identifiable or system-sourced School data.

As is a general expectation of faculty and staff, Blair employees are prohibited from using AI to infringe on the intellectual property rights, trademarks or copyrights of Blair Academy and any third parties.

Expectations & Support

All departments are encouraged to explore and thoughtfully experiment with AI tools as part of their work, using them responsibly and in alignment with School guidelines. Supervisors are expected to regularly check in with their teams to identify appropriate ways AI is supporting their roles. Effective AI use relies on thoughtful prompting, openness about its use and critical evaluation of outputs. Blair will provide ongoing training to help employees use AI strategically and responsibly, with these guidelines in mind, in their daily work.

A quick reference of appropriate operational use of AI in your work as a Blair employee is included below. For more information about use of AI in faculty-specific tasks, classroom work and communication with students and families, please see Appendix D.

Do	Don't
Fact-check and verify AI-generated content	Use free (unlicensed) AI models for School

against credible sources before relying on or sharing it. Consult the technology office before building or deploying tools that integrate with Blair data systems. Gather, organize and summarize information, and analyze data to identify or visualize trends. Disclose your use of AI when appropriate, and consult your supervisor when expectations are unclear. Automate routine tasks and workflows where appropriate—always reviewing and approving the output.	work. Copy and paste unedited AI-generated language into Blair publications or submit it for production. Integrate Blair’s data systems with AI or AI-generated tools without contacting the technology office. Misrepresent unedited AI work as your own without appropriate disclosure. Use AI to create or substantially alter images with people in them for internal or external use. Create or distribute deepfake images that depict others in non-consensual, derogatory or sexualized ways. Use AI to infringe on the intellectual property, trademarks or copyrights of Blair or third parties.
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POLICY ON AI GENERATED HEADSHOTS

Blair values authenticity in how we represent our community. For that reason, students and employees may not use AI-generated headshots or portraits heavily manipulated by filters on the website or in official publications. All headshots must be taken by the Communications Department for the sake of authenticity and consistency.

The Communications Department may use tools like Photoshop or other software to make minor adjustments to images or video, but we do not use AI to generate or substantively alter images of people—except in rare cases for illustrative or editorial purposes. In those instances, a clear disclaimer will be included to ensure transparency with the Blair community.

E-SAFETY

At times, Blair Academy operations involve collaborating, working or learning through online and remote platforms. As such, the need to create an online and remote learning/working environment that is effective, user-friendly and safe is critical to support students, families, employees and all other members of the School community.

During participation in, and use of, the School's online and remote learning/working environment (i.e., on Zoom or Google Meet), employees are expected to adhere to the following:

- Dress Code: When visible in the online and remote environment, and in any related interactions, employees are expected to be appropriately dressed.
- Remote Workspace: When participating in the online and remote learning environment, it is of the utmost importance that employees maintain a separate, private workspace free from distractions. An employee's background for all virtual video interactions with students, families and co-workers should present a professional image and not contain any inappropriate items or displays that would not be suitable in the classroom or on the School's campus.
- Boundaries, Harassment & Online Conduct: When participating in an online and remote environment, it is of the utmost importance that employees maintain and model appropriate boundaries with students, families and colleagues. Employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of conduct, respect and integrity, including by refraining from any activity that might constitute or contribute to cyberbullying, sexual abuse or harassment, child abuse or neglect (as applicable), or other prohibited interpersonal conduct.
- One-on-One Interactions: School employees may provide online and/or remote one-on-one meetings with students as appropriate. All such one-on-one interactions between students and employees should be limited to those necessary to support the academic and social well-being of students and families.
- Recording: Online and remote learning sessions and communications should not be considered confidential and may be recorded. The School strictly prohibits employees from secretly recording any interactions in the School's online and/or remote learning environment. The School also prohibits employees from using any School-authorized recorded interactions for any reason other than for purposes of students' academic and social well-being.

The School's online and remote working/learning environment is subject to the constantly changing nature of available technology. The School will provide employees with updates to this policy and the School's expectations regarding use of its online and remote learning programs as necessary.

TELEPHONE USAGE

It is important to keep School telephone lines free for School-related calls and business. The occasional use of the School's telephones for personal phone calls during non-working time should be kept to a minimum. Employees may be required to reimburse the School for any charges to the School resulting from their excessive personal use of the telephone. Cell phone usage during the working day should also be kept to a minimum.

To ensure effective telephone communications, employees should always speak in a courteous and professional manner. If an employee is unable to help a caller, the employee should transfer the caller to another employee who may be able to provide assistance.

VOICEMAIL MONITORING

Blair recognizes your need to be able to communicate efficiently with fellow employees and constituents. Therefore, we have a voicemail system to facilitate the transmission of business-related information within the School and with our constituents.

The voicemail system is intended for business use only. The use of Blair's voicemail system to solicit fellow employees or distribute non-job-related information to fellow employees is strictly prohibited. Employees are also prohibited from the display or transmission of sexually explicit messages, ethnic slurs, racial epithets, or anything which could be construed as harassment or disparaging to others.

All voicemail passwords must be made available to the School at all times.

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

For business security purposes, management may enter, search and/or monitor the School's voicemail system and the voicemail box of any employee without advance notice and consistent with applicable state and federal law. As such, employees should have no expectation of privacy with regard to messages stored on Blair's phone system.

USE OF CELLULAR TELEPHONES & OTHER COMMUNICATION DEVICES

Blair Academy is committed to protecting employees and others from the problems that can be caused by inappropriate use of a cellular telephone, tablet, smartphone, or other communication device for telephone calls, text messaging, reading/sending email, and/or accessing the Internet (collectively referred to as "communication devices").

To minimize distractions within the School's premises and to promote productivity, employees who use a communication device in the workplace are required to adhere to the following guidelines:

- In keeping with Blair's cell phone policy for students, cell phones should be kept out of sight in public campus spaces. Should you need to use your phone, please duck into an office or other private space as needed.

- While at work, employees are expected to exercise discretion in using personal cellular telephones, as is expected for the use of the School's telephones.
- While the School recognizes that the use of such communication devices is often an important way for family members to reach each other, they should only be used infrequently during the workday or when employees are executing their school obligations.
- Employees are expected to participate in any personal telephone calls on non-working time and to ensure that friends and family members are aware of the School's policy.
- Employees are discouraged from using communication devices in the classroom when students are present or while otherwise supervising students, unless in the event of an emergency.

Employees who use communication devices while traveling outside of the School's facilities are required to adhere to the following guidelines:

- Employees must adhere to all federal, state and local laws, regulations and ordinances governing the use of cellular telephones and all other communication devices while driving. The hand-held use of a cellular telephone or other communication device while driving is illegal in New Jersey.
- Employees who are charged with traffic violations or any criminal action resulting from the use of a communication device will be solely responsible for all liabilities that result from such use.
- Employees are always expected to exercise discretion and care while utilizing any communication device, and to avoid placing themselves or others at risk.

If an employee has any questions regarding this policy, please contact the Director of Human Resources Operations.

CARE OF SCHOOL PROPERTY & EQUIPMENT

You are expected to demonstrate proper care when using the School's property and equipment. No property may be removed from the School's premises without the proper prior authorization of a member of the administrative team. Employees should be alert to obvious hazards, waste or theft and should report them immediately to their department head or any member of the administration.

Office equipment, vehicles, tools and other property assigned to employees should be kept in good condition and workplaces should be neat and orderly. If you lose, break or damage any property, report it to your supervisor and the Business Office immediately.

MOTOR VEHICLE SAFETY POLICY

Blair Academy employees operate Blair Academy-owned, leased, rental or personal vehicles as part of their jobs. Employees are expected to operate vehicles safely to prevent accidents that may result in injuries and property loss. It is the policy of Blair Academy to provide and maintain a safe working environment to protect our employees, students and all other members of the School. Blair Academy is committed to promoting a heightened level of safety awareness and responsible driving behavior in its employees. Our efforts and the commitment of employees will help prevent vehicle accidents and reduce personal injury and property loss claims. This program requires the full cooperation of each driver to operate their vehicle safely and to adhere to the responsibilities outlined in the Motor Vehicle Safety Program, as well as applicable law. Elements of this program

include:

- Assignment of responsibilities at all levels of employment.
- Vehicle use and insurance requirements.
- Employee motor vehicle record checks and identification of high-risk drivers.
- Accident reporting and investigation.
- Vehicle maintenance.
- Training standards.
- Safety regulations.

ORGANIZATION & RESPONSIBILITIES

1. The Business Office is responsible for directing a vehicle safety program, and has established objectives to ensure compliance.
 - A. Resources necessary to implementation and maintenance, appropriate action to manage high-risk drivers, and required driver training for high-risk drivers.
2. The Executive Assistant to the Associate Head of School serves as Vehicle Coordinator, who will oversee Keycafe.
 - A. Support distribution of keys as needed (vans and buses).
 - B. Maintain a record of vehicle use.
3. The Chief Financial & Operations Officer will:
 - A. Review motor vehicle accident reports.
 - B. Review and recommend changes to the Motor Vehicle Safety Program to the Business Office.
4. Drivers will:
 - A. Request vehicle keys from Keycafe/the Vehicle Coordinator.
 - B. Always operate a motor vehicle in a safe manner as explained under the section titled, "Driver Safety Regulations."
 - C. Maintain a valid driver's license and minimum insurance requirements on personal vehicles used for Blair Academy business.
 - D. Report any issues with Blair Academy vehicles to the Business Office in accordance with the vehicle report safety standards.
 - E. Return keys to the Student Life Office via Keycafe in the Annie Hall parking lot.

VEHICLE USE

1. Blair Academy-Owned Vehicles:
 - A. Passenger Cars, Vans & Buses: Employees with appropriate license and authorization from the Vehicle Coordinator will be permitted to operate a passenger car, van or bus.
 - B. Maintenance/Facilities Vans & Trucks: Employees with appropriate license, authorization from the Business Office and qualified by state and federal Department of Transportation (when applicable) will be permitted to operate the vehicle.

2. Personal Vehicles on Blair Academy Business:
 - A. Employees who drive their personal vehicles on Blair Academy business are subject to the requirements of this program, including:
 - a. Maintaining auto liability insurance with minimum limits of \$100,000 for bodily injury and \$100,000 for property damage per occurrence with a combined single limit of \$300,000.
 - b. Maintain current state vehicle inspections when required.
 - c. Maintain their own vehicle in a safe operating condition when driven on Blair Academy business.
 - d. Complete waiver for annual Motor Vehicle Report (MVR).
 - e. No “business use” exclusion on personal insurance policy.
3. Rental Vehicles:
 - A. Rental vehicles will be leased from rental agencies as approved by the Business Office. Please see Blair’s [vehicle rental policy](#).
 - B. Collision damage waiver will be refused.
 - C. The Business Office will provide proof of insurance.
4. Unauthorized Use of Vehicles: Assigned drivers and other authorized employees will not allow an unauthorized individual to operate a Blair vehicle.
5. Contractors & Temporary Hire Employees: Contractors and temporary employees will be treated as Blair Academy employees and will be required to comply with the requirements of this program. Failure to meet all requirements will result in the immediate loss of driving privileges.

DRIVER SELECTION

1. Driver Evaluation: Employees’ driving history will be screened. To evaluate employees as drivers, the Business Office will:
 - A. Ensure employees complete a Motor Vehicle Record (MVR) release form and review the employee’s Motor Vehicle Record (MVR) annually.
 - B. Ensure the employee has a valid driver’s license.
 - C. Ensure the employee is qualified to operate the type of vehicle they will drive.
2. Driver Qualification: Effective driver qualification controls are important elements of a successful motor vehicle safety program. The Business Office developed and incorporated standards into this program that reflect the skills necessary for satisfactory job performance while taking into consideration applicable federal and state regulations.
 - A. Blair Academy has implemented two levels of driver qualification criteria. Use of any or all of these criteria is dependent upon the nature and scope of the driving requirements.
 - i. State-regulated driver qualification parameters must be met. Regulatory information will be obtained from applicable state departments of transportation and motor vehicle services.
 - ii. Where applicable, drivers will comply with Department of Commercial Driver License (CDL) regulations.

- B. The Business Office has established criteria to identify high-risk drivers. A driver is high-risk if the driver's accident/violation history in the past three years includes one or more of the following moving violation convictions:
1. Driving under the influence of alcohol or drugs (DWI).
 2. Hit-and-run or leaving the scene of an accident.
 3. Failure to report an accident.
 4. Negligent homicide arising out of the use of a motor vehicle.
 5. Operating during a period of suspension or revocation.
 6. Using a motor vehicle for the commission of a felony.
 7. Operating a motor vehicle without the owner's authority.
 8. Permitting an unlicensed person to drive.
 9. Reckless driving.
 10. Speeding (three or more tickets in a three-year period).
 11. Speeding 25 miles per hour or more above the speed limit.
 12. Two preventable accidents in a 12-month period.
 13. Suspended license.
 14. Drug offense.
 15. Two or more at-fault accidents.
 16. Three or more moving violations in the past three years.
 17. Less than three years of driving experience operating a similar size/weight vehicle.
 18. Any operator with a temporary operator's permit.
 19. Open container violation.
 20. Vehicle manslaughter/homicide.
 21. Eluding a police officer.
 22. Speed contest or racing violation.
 23. Passing a stopped school bus.
 24. Driving 10 miles per hour or more over the speed limit in a school zone.
 25. Lending an operator's license or registration to another.

Drivers identified as high risk or in violation may be subject to several actions from Blair Academy including, but not limited to:

1. Attending a defensive or safety driving course on the driver's own time and at their own expense.
2. Having their driving privileges suspended or revoked.
3. Termination of employment.

ACCIDENT RECORDKEEPING, REPORTING & ANALYSIS

For more information about accident recordkeeping, reporting and analysis, please contact Blair's Business Office.

EMPLOYEE ACCIDENT REPORTING PROCEDURE

Every Blair Academy vehicle should have an accident reporting kit in the glove box. This should include an accident report form and a pen or pencil. Employees must take the following actions when there are injuries to persons and/or damage to other vehicles or property:

1. If possible, move the vehicle to a safe location out of the way of traffic. Call for medical attention if anyone is hurt.
2. Secure the names and addresses of drivers and occupants of any vehicles involved, their operator's license numbers, and insurance company names and policy numbers, as well as the names and addresses of injured persons and witnesses. Record this information on the accident report form (in the reporting packet). Do not discuss fault with or sign anything for anyone except an authorized representative of Blair Academy, a police officer or a representative of the insurance company.
3. Immediately notify the Chief Financial & Operations Officer ([cell] (201) 874-7161, [office] (908) 362-2016 or Associate Head of School ([cell] (717) 805-8577, [office] (908) 362-3106). If you are unable to reach them or someone in the Business Office, contact the Dean of Students immediately).
4. You will be contacted by the Business Office to advise you on procedures to arrange for repairs to the vehicle. Do not have the vehicle repaired until you receive authorization from the Business Office.

When there is theft of or damage to your vehicle only:

1. If you did not witness the damage to the vehicle, you must notify the local police department immediately.
2. Immediately notify the Chief Financial & Operations Officer ([cell] (860) 424-6891, [office] (908) 362-2016).
3. You will be contacted by the Business Office to advise you on procedures to arrange for repairs or replacement of the vehicle. Do not have the vehicle repaired until you receive authorization from the Business Office.

Send a copy of the police report along with a memo outlining any additional information to the Business Office.

BLAIR ACADEMY ACCIDENT REVIEW

All vehicle collisions should be analyzed, and a written report submitted to the Business Office for review. A determination of accident preventability should be made. Where the collision was preventable by the Blair Academy driver, the driver may be required to undergo counseling or additional training, transferred to non-driving duties, or may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment (or services for independent contractors).

However, this does not absolve the Business Office from improving safety of the work and driving environment. The Business Office, drivers and other personnel as necessary should each participate in the analysis. Business Office deficiencies and/or lack of management action should also be part of the accident review. The Business Office has the legal obligation not only for driver safety, but the safety of the general public as well.

The Campus Safety Committee will review accidents if it is appropriate to do so.

DRIVER TRAINING

1. Blair Academy will confirm that all employees with driving privileges have the basic skills and credentials necessary to perform this function through the new-hire process and during continued employment.

2. All employees with driving privileges may be required to complete a safe driving course.
3. New employees, contractors and temporary hires will receive a copy of this program as part of their initial orientation. A formal orientation program is established to help assure all drivers are presented with Blair's policy, understand their responsibilities and are familiarized with the use of Blair vehicles. Areas that must be addressed with the driver include:
 - a. Understand, review and receive a copy of the Fleet Safety Program.
 - b. Sign release for Motor Vehicle Report (MVR).
 - c. Understand accident reporting and emergency procedures.
 - d. Review operation and controls of vehicles being assigned.
4. License Suspension: Drivers must immediately notify the Business Office if their license is suspended or revoked.

DRIVER SAFETY REGULATIONS

1. Safety belts: The driver and all occupants are required to wear safety belts when the vehicle is in operation or while riding in a vehicle. The driver is responsible for ensuring passengers wear their safety belts. Children under four years of age or under 40 pounds in weight must be secured in a Department of Transportation-approved child safety seat.
2. Impaired driving: The driver must not operate a vehicle at any time when their ability to do so is impaired, affected, influenced by alcohol, illegal drugs, prescribed or over-the-counter medication, illness, fatigue or injury.
3. Traffic laws: Drivers must abide by federal, state and local motor vehicle regulations, laws and ordinances.
4. Vehicle condition: Drivers are responsible for ensuring the vehicle is in safe driving condition prior to departure.
5. Cellular phones: The following procedures apply to employees driving on Blair Academy business who wish to use cellular phones in the vehicle.
 - A. External speaker and microphone must be included to allow hands-free operation;
 - B. Drivers are to minimize phone calls while the vehicle is in motion; and
 - C. If you must make a call that could be distracting or extensive, please find a safe place to park before placing or receiving that call.
6. Motorcycles: Employees are prohibited from using motorcycles when traveling on Blair Academy business.
7. General safety rules: Employees are not permitted to:
 - A. Pick up hitchhikers.
 - B. Accept payment for carrying passengers or materials.
 - C. Use any radar detector, laser detector or similar devices.
 - D. Push or pull another vehicle or tow a trailer unless approved by the Business Office.
 - E. Transport flammable liquids or gasses unless a Department of Transportation or Underwriters' Laboratories-approved container is used, and only then in limited quantities.
 - F. Use burning flares unless absolutely necessary (reflective triangles are preferred).
 - G. Assist disabled motorists or accident victims beyond their level of medical expertise. If a driver is unable to provide the proper medical care, they must restrict their assistance to calling the proper authorities. Your safety and well-being is to be protected at all times.

8. Blair Academy & Personal Property: Employees are responsible for Blair Academy property such as computers, work papers and equipment under their control, but the School will use its discretion about absolving faculty and staff from liability in the event of theft, considering whether all precautions have been taken. Blair Academy will not reimburse the employee for stolen personal property.

**Please contact the Business Office for more information about preventable and non-preventable accidents, as well as general and situation-specific questions to consider.*

USE OF SCHOOL VEHICLES

The School has buses and vans available for employees to use for transporting students to and from functions or events that are related to Blair's program of instruction or approved School-related activities and travel. In addition to the School's Motor Vehicle Safety Policy above, all employees are required to comply with the following:

1. You can reserve vehicles through Keycafe, contacting the Executive Assistant to the Associate Head of School for support. The Keycafe cabinet is in the Annie Hall parking lot.
2. Take the vehicle to Blairstown Phillips 66 Station for oil and gas needs.
3. Fill the vehicle with gas after your trip so that it is ready for its next use.
4. Be sure that the interior of the vehicle is clean when you return it; have students clean out paper, cans, etc. Be sure that students treat the vehicle with care.
5. Return all vehicles to their proper places after use.
6. Return keys to Keycafe immediately upon return—someone else is often waiting for the vehicle. If Keycafe is not functioning,, put the keys in the mail slot of the door of the Student Life Office.
7. Be sure to report any damage or vehicle problems to the Business Office immediately; the safety of all depends on this.
8. Any emergency use of School vehicles for personal reasons must be **approved by the Business Office.**

School vehicles are becoming increasingly expensive to purchase, maintain and operate. It is important that employees see that vehicles are treated well and that any damage or malfunction be reported to the Business Office as soon as possible. A number of considerations, insurance requirements being primary among them, prohibit the use of School vehicles for personal reasons; therefore such use may be approved in very limited circumstances.

USE OF PERSONAL VEHICLES FOR SCHOOL-RELATED ACTIVITIES

Blair Academy's insurance carrier does not cover accidents incurred while an employee is on a School-related trip using their own personal vehicle. Should a School vehicle not be available, all use of personal vehicles for Blair business must be approved by your supervisor. In the event an accident occurs, you will be liable for any injuries to passengers or damages to other vehicles through your own insurance carrier. In the event that you are involved in an accident with your own vehicle while performing approved School business through no fault of your own, the School may pay your deductible up to a maximum of \$500.

While it may create difficulties in the short run, employees are expected to use School vehicles for any activity directly related to Blair-related business, although there may be times that such vehicles

are unavailable. Please return the vehicle and keys promptly after use in accordance with the policies outlined above. If you have a need to rent a vehicle for a School-related function, please follow the School's [vehicle rental policy](#).

Reimbursement for personal vehicles' mileage during a School-related trip, activity, or business will be made on an exceptional basis **at a rate of \$.76/mile**. The most direct route to the destination should be used.

Expense statements should be redeemed within 48 hours of a return from a trip. All expenses must be documented, with receipts attached to the expense forms provided by the Business Office. Blair Academy may reject requests for reimbursements not processed in a timely manner.

SOLICITATION & DISTRIBUTION

In order to avoid unnecessary annoyances and work interruptions, the electronic or physical solicitation or distribution of literature or other materials regarding any non-Blair-related activities by an employee is prohibited.

Employee distribution of such literature or other materials in work areas is prohibited at all times.

Trespassing, soliciting or distribution of literature or other materials in any campus spaces, for any purpose, by non-employees with the School's buildings and/or on the School's premises or property is prohibited at all times.

Definitions for the Purposes of this Policy

- "Soliciting" includes approaching anyone for any of the following purposes: offering anything for sale, asking for donations, collecting funds, canvassing or seeking to promote, encouraging or discouraging (i) participation in or support for any organization, activity or event or (ii) membership in any organization. Handing out or delivering membership cards or applications for any organization is considered soliciting.
- "Distributing literature or other materials" includes handing out or delivering to anyone any literature or any other printed or written materials (except that handing out or delivering membership cards or applications for any organization is considered soliciting).
- "Working time" does not include meal periods, coffee breaks or rest periods or other specified periods during the work day when employees are properly not engaged in performing their work duties.
- "Work areas" includes School buildings, premises or property or any other location at which an employee is performing work on behalf of the School.

If you have questions about this policy, please speak with the Dean of Faculty Life.

GOOD HOUSEKEEPING

Good work habits and a neat place to work are essential for job safety and efficiency. You are expected to keep your place of work organized and materials in good order at all times. All School vehicles must be kept clean and organized.

You are also required to follow all health, safety and sanitation procedures for your work areas as provided by the School in compliance with federal, state and local guidance.

In addition, the School's facilities are costly, as are their furniture and equipment; they should be treated with care to preserve the School's investment and to ensure that others who follow in the work area inherit a workplace that is as attractive and functional as it was for those who came before. You are required to report to your supervisor anything in your work area or School vehicle that needs repair or replacement.

VISITORS TO CAMPUS

The School expects all employees to assist in identifying visitors to the School, and, if appropriate, help direct them to their intended destination. Employees should be vigilant in asking unidentified visitors walking campus their nature of business at Blair and, if concerned about specific individuals, call Blair Security, the Safety & Security Consultant, Chief Financial & Operations Officer and/or Associate Head of School.

PARKING

Parking can be a problem if consideration is not taken for others. The area outside of the Head of School's office is for prospective families and other school visitors, and not to be used for employee parking. Please do not park on the front drive, as it creates an unnecessary hazard for other vehicles. The Business Office will assign parking spaces to employees (including dorm residents) at the beginning of each academic year. Please note it is illegal to park in handicapped spots without the proper permit.

OCCASIONAL/HYBRID/REMOTE WORK POLICY

Blair Academy values personal connections and face-to-face interactions and believes that students and community members are best served when employees are physically on campus. The School also recognizes, however, that allowing occasional/hybrid/remote work arrangements on a temporary basis may provide advantages for both the School and its employees; these include, but are not limited to, increased productivity and performance, enhanced employee recruitment and retention, cost-and-space reduction, and work-life balance. Additionally, certain events or circumstances may necessitate that specific employees temporarily work remotely to fulfill their job responsibilities away from campus. Remote work is not appropriate for all types of jobs or all individuals.

Eligibility:

Full-time employees who have been employed at the School for a minimum of six months and perform workplace duties that can be accomplished from a suitable location outside their campus office may be eligible to work remotely under this policy. Employees in student-facing positions or offices, such as faculty members, are **ineligible** for any type of remote work when students are on campus, but could be eligible for occasional remote work during School breaks. Additionally, remote work is not an option for positions that provide essential in-person or onsite services.

Occasional, Hybrid & Remote Work Designations

- Occasional (periodic, seasonal and situational):

- A portion of job duties can be performed remotely without loss of productivity or other negative impacts, but most work requires or benefits from onsite presence and/or in-person collaboration with other team members.
- Not regularly scheduled.
- Hybrid:
 - A portion of job duties can be performed remotely, without loss of productivity or other negative impacts, but some work requires or benefits from onsite presence and/or in-person collaboration with other team members.
 - Regularly scheduled at one to two days per week.
- Remote:
 - All job duties can be performed remotely without disrupting departmental and School goals, but onsite collaboration with team members is beneficial occasionally.
 - Regularly scheduled on average of three to five days per week.

Guidelines For Determining Occasional, Hybrid &/Or Remote Work Arrangements

The School will consider several factors will in determining whether an employee's job at the School allows for occasional/hybrid/remote work arrangement, or if such an arrangement is a viable option for a particular employee, including, but not limited to:

- Whether the nature of the work lends itself to remote work.
- Operational needs of the School and department.
- The employee's circumstances.
- The employee's ability to define goals, organize tasks and work independently to achieve them.
- The employee's past and present level of job performance.
- The job type, including whether a job's successful performance can be assessed in terms of identifiable outcome measures.
- The impact on students, other employees, alumni and visitors.
- Whether key duties benefit from or require extensive face-to-face contact with supervisors, other employees, students or the public.
- The impact on other faculty or staff members (including inconvenience caused by an individual's lack of campus presence or increased workload), particularly those within the department or who may regularly work with the department.

The duration of an occasional/hybrid/remote work arrangement will be determined by the School based on the institution's needs and the particular event and/or circumstances. The School may terminate an occasion/hybrid/remote work arrangement at any time for any reason and require an employee to return to work on campus full-time immediately.

General Expectations & Conditions

Employees must be able to perform their daily tasks and responsibilities, be available to answer emails and phone calls during their scheduled work hours, and participate as scheduled/requested in any meeting. Additionally:

- Employees are required to:
 - Maintain a separate, private workspace in the home or other remote work location.

- Accurately record all time worked in accordance with the School's policies and procedures.
- Comply with state and federal health and safety requirements.
- Comply with confidentiality and privacy obligations.
- Comply with security protocols.
- Employees will be expected to make themselves available to physically attend scheduled work meetings on campus as requested or required by their supervisor or by the School.
- Employees are not permitted to conduct personal business during designated working hours.
- Employees must manage dependent care and professional responsibilities in a way that allows them to fully meet their job responsibilities successfully.
- The School assumes no liability for injuries while working remotely to employees other than those which may be covered by state worker's compensation laws.
- Employees will be held to stated goals and performance standards, and are expected to achieve outcomes and productivity as outlined in their position description.
- All policies, procedures and guidelines in the *Employee Handbook* apply while in any type of remote setting.
- Blair Academy will not assume any costs associated with working from home (Internet, phone bill, etc.) from a home office.
- Employees needing to make an occasional change to the agreed upon scheduled remote day must get approval from their supervisor.
- Occasional, hybrid and remote work is viewed as a workplace benefit, and is not a right or entitlement to employment and as such may be revoked by Blair Academy at any time or may be denied on a case-by-case basis if it disrupts the productive flow of the day-to-day work of the office, collaboration among offices or at the discretion of the administration.

Process To Request An Occasional/Hybrid/Remote Work Arrangement

- Employees must initiate conversations with their supervisors to discuss if any type of occasional/hybrid/remote work option is available to them.
- If yes, employees and supervisors must complete a Remote Work Agreement and submit to the Director of Human Resources Operations for approval. The agreement should be discussed annually at staff performance reviews and updated if needed.

All of the School's rules, policies, practices and instructions apply to occasional/hybrid/remote work, regardless of where you work. Any violation may result in preclusion from working remotely and/or disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

III. HEALTH & SAFETY

STUDENT SAFETY

Though we have many goals and aspirations for our students, our first responsibility is their safety and well-being. All other considerations (i.e., getting to an appointment on time, finishing an athletic contest or completing a class assignment) are subordinate to this responsibility. All employees must keep this professional responsibility paramount and are required to seek appropriate advice from their supervisors or the administration and make appropriate decisions if ever student safety is in question.

To that end, it is the expectation that all employees communicate any concerns regarding student safety to the administration. Specifically, employees must immediately report perceived concerns regarding student-employee ***boundary crossings, inappropriate relationships or other potentially unsafe situations*** to the Dean of Faculty Life and/or the Associate Head of School in accordance with the School's "Communications & Interactions with Students" Policy. A concern involving the Head of School should be brought to the Chair of the Board of Trustees. In the case that a student's safety is in immediate and obvious danger, employees are required to intervene. Concerns regarding student safety will be investigated and managed as discreetly as possible and, in a manner consistent with the policies and procedures in the School's *Student Handbook* and legal obligations under applicable law. The healthy functioning of the Blair community is dependent on employees' collective willingness to share concerns in their support of one another and the student body.

DISPENSING STUDENT MEDICATION

All employees (excluding Health Center staff) are prohibited from distributing any medication (prescription drugs or over-the-counter medications) to students without authorization from Blair's Health Center. Distributing controlled substances (including prescription drugs) is dangerous, unprofessional, and could lead to immediate termination of employment and/or notification of appropriate authorities.

EMPLOYEE SAFETY

The School makes every effort to provide employees with safe working conditions; however, a safe and healthy work environment is everyone's responsibility and can only be achieved through teamwork at Blair. Each employee, supervisor and manager must practice safety awareness by thinking defensively, anticipating unsafe situations and reporting unsafe conditions immediately.

Please observe the following precautions:

1. Notify your supervisor of any emergency situation.
2. If you are injured or become sick at work, no matter how slightly or insignificant the injury or illness may appear, you must inform your supervisor and the Business Office immediately. This will enable the School to process any workers' compensation claim that may be associated with the accident or injury. It may also help prevent a similar accident or injury in the future. An employee's failure to report a work-related accident or injury may jeopardize their eligibility for workers' compensation benefits.
3. Use, adjust and repair machines and equipment only if you are trained and qualified to do so.
4. Get help when lifting or pushing heavy objects.
5. Understand your job fully and follow instructions. If you are unsure of the safe procedure for

- completing a task, don't guess; ask your supervisor.
6. Know the locations, contents, and use of first-aid and firefighting equipment.
 7. Wear personal protective equipment in accordance with the job you are performing.

The School will provide information to employees regarding workplace safety and health issues through regular internal communication channels such as supervisor-employee meetings, bulletin boards, memoranda and other written communications. The School is also committed to providing employees with information about the nature and spread of communicable diseases, including symptoms to watch for, as well as required steps to be taken in the event of a pandemic or outbreak. Employees are expected to obey safety-and-health rules and to exercise caution in all workplace activities. Employees must immediately report any unsafe condition to Blair Security, the Safety & Security Consultant or Chief Financial & Operations Officer. Employees who violate safety standards, who cause hazardous or dangerous situations, or who fail to report or, where appropriate, remedy such situations, may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

No employee who reports any unsafe condition, potential safety hazard, safety suggestion and/or health-and-safety-related issue shall suffer harassment, retaliation or other adverse employment consequences in connection with making such a report. It is a violation of this policy for anyone, whether acting alone or on behalf of the School, to retaliate against any individual who makes a report in accordance with this policy. While the School encourages the reporting individual to include their name to facilitate investigation, concerns reported anonymously will be investigated to the fullest extent practicable. Upon receipt of a report, the School will promptly conduct a thorough investigation in such a way as to maintain the confidentiality of the individuals involved to the extent possible under the circumstances.

A violation of this policy may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

MEDICAL CARE

Beginning in fall 2026, Blair Academy expects to offer an on-campus employee health clinic operated and managed by Omega Healthcare Services ("OHS"). The clinic is intended to provide convenient access during the workday for the evaluation and treatment of minor illnesses and injuries, required commercial driver's license (CDL) medical examinations and such other limited occupational health services as OHS may offer from time to time., an independent healthcare provider. Telehealth services may also be available, as determined by OHS. The services will be available to all full-time Blair Academy employees and without charge to the employees. Spouses, partners and dependents of employees are not eligible to use the clinic at this time.

The clinic is intended to provide convenient access during the workday for the evaluation and treatment of minor illnesses and injuries, required commercial driver's license (CDL) medical examinations and such other limited occupational health services as OHS may offer from time to time. The clinic is not intended to serve as a substitute for an employee's primary care physician, emergency medical services or ongoing medical care, and preventive care services generally are not provided.

Additional information regarding clinic hours, appointment scheduling, and available services will be

provided at the beginning of the school year.

OHS is solely responsible for the provision of medical services provided at the employee health clinic. Blair Academy does not direct or control the medical judgment of OHS or its healthcare professionals. Medical information maintained by OHS will be handled in accordance with applicable privacy laws and is not part of an employee's personnel file, except to the extent information is lawfully provided to Blair Academy for employment-related purposes.

The Academy reserves the right to modify, suspend, relocate or discontinue the clinic or any of its services at any time.

COMMUNICABLE ILLNESSES

The School recognizes and appreciates its employees' dedication to performing their duties and to assuring that students' needs are met. At the same time, however, the School must ensure that employees do not jeopardize the health or safety of the School community by spreading contagious infections to students or other employees. For that reason, the School asks that employees with contagious infections take necessary, reasonable steps to avoid the spread of infection during the contagious period.

The School may exclude any person who (a) has a communicable illness, (b) has been exposed to an infected person, and/or (c) has traveled to an area impacted by a communicable illness, if the School determines that such exclusion is appropriate for the welfare of the person who has the communicable illness or the School community. The School may also screen such persons or require such persons to be screened by appropriate medical professionals to determine whether they pose a risk to the community. The School's decisions shall be based on current and well-informed medical judgments concerning the illness, the risks of transmitting the illness to others, the symptoms and special circumstances of each individual who has a communicable illness, and an analysis of the identified risks and available alternatives for responding to an individual with a communicable illness.

ACCOMMODATIONS

Reasonable Accommodations (Americans with Disabilities Act)

Blair Academy is committed to providing equal employment opportunities to otherwise qualified individuals with disabilities in accordance with applicable law. The School will make reasonable accommodations that are medically necessary for the known physical or mental impairments of an otherwise qualified employee with a disability where appropriate, unless the School determines that such accommodations would result in undue hardship to the School.

In the event you need an accommodation to enable you to perform the essential functions of your position, it is your responsibility to notify the Director of Human Resources Operations of the need for such accommodation. Upon doing so, you may be asked for input on the type of accommodation you believe may be necessary, or the functional limitations caused by your disability. The School may require medical documentation supporting the need for the accommodation. Also, when appropriate, the School may need permission to obtain additional information from your physician or other medical or rehabilitation professionals. The Director of Human Resources Operations will notify you in writing of the School's determination. You should not assume that an accommodation has been granted until you have received written confirmation from the School. Blair will keep your request and any medical information provided confidential, except on a strict "need-to-know" basis.

Pregnancy-Related Accommodations

The School prohibits discrimination and retaliation against any employee on the basis of pregnancy, childbirth or conditions related to pregnancy. Employees who are pregnant or affected by conditions related to pregnancy must be treated in the same manner as other qualified applicants or employees with similar abilities or limitations and have a right to reasonable accommodations unless such accommodations would cause an undue burden on the School's operations. Reasonable accommodations may include, but not be limited to, the ability to sit or drink water, closer parking, additional break time, including lactation breaks, leave or time off to recover from childbirth, or restructuring of job duties to avoid exposure to compounds not safe for pregnancy or strenuous activities.

Employees who may need a workplace accommodation because of their pregnancy, childbirth or pregnancy-related condition should contact the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Accommodations For Nursing Mothers

The School is committed to supporting nursing mothers who choose to express breast milk while at work. Specifically, the School will provide a clean, private location, other than a bathroom, that is shielded from view, free from intrusion by coworkers, students and the public, and is available for the employee when needed to express breast milk, in accordance with applicable law. In addition, for a reasonable time period following the birth of her child, an employee is permitted to take reasonable breaks for the purpose of expressing breast milk, as frequently as needed. To the extent possible, such breaks shall be simultaneous with any paid breaks already provided to the employee. If a non-exempt employee needs to take time to express breast milk beyond the time already permitted for breaks, such time will be unpaid.

An employee who chooses to express breast milk at work must provide reasonable notice to the Director of Human Resources Operations to enable the School to provide a suitable location for expressing breast milk and to ensure that designated location is available when needed by the employee.

SUBSTANCE USE

Blair Academy has a vital interest in ensuring a safe, healthy and efficient working environment for our employees, our students and their guests. The unlawful or improper presence or use of controlled substances, cannabis or alcohol in the workplace presents a danger to everyone. For these reasons, we have established as a condition of employment and continued employment with Blair Academy the following substance-use policy.

Employees are prohibited from reporting to work, working or performing any job-related activities, on or off the School's premises, while using or otherwise under the influence of any illegal controlled substance, drug, cannabis or alcohol. Consuming alcohol or illegal controlled substances/drugs during the work day, including during meal and rest breaks, is also prohibited. Further, use of alcohol or illegal controlled substances/drugs in a School-owned vehicle or in any motor vehicle while engaged in School business is prohibited, as is the operation of any motor vehicle on School business while under the influence of alcohol or illegal controlled substances/drugs.

An illegal controlled substance is any drug that is unlawful under federal, state or local law, as well as any drug that, though available legally, has been obtained illegally. Although medical and/or recreational use of marijuana is legal in certain circumstances in New Jersey, such use remains illegal under federal law. Moreover, New Jersey law does not allow the possession or consumption of marijuana on the grounds of any school (including School-provided housing). Accordingly, Blair prohibits marijuana in accordance with this policy.

An employee's use of prescription drugs/medication (with the exception of marijuana) while at work is permitted, provided that the drug has been prescribed to the employee by a licensed healthcare provider/physician and it is used in accordance with the healthcare provider's instructions and the prescribed dosage, and provided that the employee's drug does not affect their job performance (e.g., by causing dizziness or drowsiness) or impair the employee's ability to perform the job safely and effectively. It is the employee's responsibility to determine from their healthcare provider/physician whether a prescribed drug may impair safe job performance and to notify a supervisor of any job restrictions that should be observed as a result. The employee may be required to provide the School with a copy of the prescription and/or other medical verification. Employees are prohibited from using, or reporting to work impaired by, or under the influence of, any over-the-counter drug that may affect their safety or job performance. If an employee is unable to perform the employee's job duties safely and effectively while taking a prescribed medication, the employee may be re-assigned, or, if no suitable position is available, may be placed on a leave of absence.

In addition, employees are prohibited from engaging in the unlawful or unauthorized manufacture, distribution, sale or possession of illegal controlled substances/drugs, cannabis, prescription drugs, and/or alcohol in the workplace, including: on School paid time, on School premises, in School vehicles or while engaged in School activities.

Your employment or continued employment with Blair Academy is conditioned upon your full compliance with this substance-use policy. Any violations may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. Furthermore, any employee who violates this policy and who is subject to termination, may be permitted to participate in an appropriate treatment, counseling or rehabilitation program as recommended by a substance-use professional. In this instance, the employee is required to successfully complete the program as a condition of continued employment. Any information concerning an individual's drug or alcohol use will remain confidential.

Consistent with its fair employment policy, Blair Academy maintains a policy of non-discrimination and reasonable accommodation with respect to individuals recovering from an addiction, and those having a medical history reflecting treatment for substance-use conditions. Blair encourages employees to seek assistance before their drug or alcohol use renders them unable to perform their essential job functions or jeopardizes the health and safety of themselves or others. Blair Academy will attempt to assist its employees through referrals to rehabilitation, appropriate leaves of absence, and other measures consistent with the School's policies and applicable federal, state or local laws.

Blair Academy may take any and all appropriate and lawful actions necessary to enforce this substance-use policy, including, but not limited to: the inspection of School-issued lockers, desks or other suspected areas of concealment; an employee's personal property; and an evaluation or examination by an appropriately trained professional to determine the use of alcohol or illegal

controlled substances/drugs when the administration has reasonable suspicion to believe that the employee has violated this substance-use policy.

ALCOHOL USE

Drinking alcohol is an accepted legal and social norm in adult behavior, and each employee is free to make their choice regarding responsible alcohol use during non-working time. Discretion and good judgment must be used with regard to drinking or serving alcohol on School property, including School-provided housing. Employees who serve alcohol in School-provided housing are responsible for their guests' behavior. Drinking while on duty or carrying out supervisory tasks is specifically prohibited (see "Substance Use" Policy above); serious professional consequences—including termination—could arise from failure to follow this directive. Above all else, employees must be sensitive to their professional standing and act in ways that do not blur the boundaries between student and employee behavior, do not jeopardize anyone's safety or well-being, or bring disrespect or negative attention to the School (*for more information on acceptable alcohol use when attending or hosting School events or gatherings, see the travel policy on page 31*).

Serving alcohol to or using alcohol with students is strictly prohibited and will lead to immediate termination. This prohibition includes times when school is in or out of session, on or off Blair property, on School trips or sanctioned functions, or any time employees act as in their role as School personnel. Situations may arise when employees are in the presence of students who are drinking alcohol off-campus with the knowledge and approval of Blair parents. While School expectations of students do not usually extend to situations that occur when students are under parental responsibility, the School's expectations of how employees behave in these situations remains unchanged.

Any questions about alcohol consumption by employees can be answered by the Dean of Faculty Life or Associate Head of School.

SMOKING

By New Jersey state law and in keeping with the School's intention to provide a safe and healthy work environment, Blair Academy is a smoke-free community, and employees may not smoke anywhere on campus, including School-provided housing. When performing job-related duties or attending School-sponsored events off campus, employees may not smoke in the presence of students. The term "smoking" applies equally to all products, including, but not limited to smokeless tobacco, vaporizers, e-cigarettes, cannabis and cannabis products. This policy applies to all individuals on the School's premises. Failure to follow School expectations may carry serious professional consequences.

EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLAN

Blair Academy has an emergency response plan that outlines the School's expectation that all employees understand fully and follow during an emergency and/or crisis. All campus locations should have an "emergency lockdown procedure" form readily available. It is the responsibility of Blair to appropriately train employees to execute emergency response protocols. Employees are expected to review and understand the School's response plans which are available from the Business Office and participate in emergency drills conducted throughout the year. [Here](#) is the current plan.

STUDENT DISCIPLINE

The School encourages its employees to assume that students will act with honor, and it hopes that all student-employee relations will be based upon mutual trust. Employees are expected to respond to all inappropriate behavior by students.

However, corporal punishment is not allowed at the School. Please remember that the general rule when discipline is required is not to “lay hands” upon students. Faculty members are expected to resolve the day-to-day discipline problems of their classrooms. Should a situation (or student) present a particularly unique or difficult problem, or cause repeated behavioral issues, the Dean of Students and Associate Head of School should be notified to assist in handling the situation. Please see the Student Life section of this Handbook (Appendix B) for more information regarding how student discipline should be addressed.

Generally, discipline at the School is not aimed to punish as much as it is designed to teach young people to be responsible for their actions and to be members of a society that requires cooperative interaction. However, any behavior that is dangerous, disobedient or disrespectful of others will not be tolerated.

MANDATED REPORTING

Blair Academy is committed to the highest standards of care for its students. The following policy is intended to ensure that children are protected from any inappropriate or hurtful actions by adults responsible for their care. In addition, under New Jersey law, all professionals responsible for the care of children are required to report suspected abuse or neglect of children under the age of 18.

Any person having reasonable cause to believe that a child has been subjected to child abuse, including sexual abuse, or acts of child abuse shall report to Department of Children and Families, Division of Child Protection and Permanency (CP&P) by telephone or otherwise. Such reports, where possible, shall contain the names and addresses of the child and their parents, guardians or other persons having custody and control of the child and, if known, the child’s age, the nature and possible extent of the child’s injuries, abuse or maltreatment, including any evidence of previous injuries, abuse or maltreatment, and any other information that the person believes may be helpful with respect to the child abuse and the identity of the perpetrator.

Reporting Procedures

When an employee learns or becomes aware of a situation of possible abuse or neglect, the employee should consult immediately with at least one of the following administrators: the Director of Counseling, Associate Head of School and/or Director of Health Services so that appropriate action can be taken to protect the child and timely reports can be made to CP&P. They will help you to clarify your reasons for concern and work with you in determining a course of action appropriate to the situation, including possible additional reporting. If appropriate, legal counsel and/or a consultant specializing in the care and protection of children also may be involved in these reviews. The confidentiality of the child and the child’s family will be protected to the extent appropriate. If the abuse or neglect is suspected to come from the child’s family, an approach to protecting the child will be defined and the family will be promptly notified of the School’s obligation to report the information to CP&P.

If it is determined that a report should be made to CP&P, the employee or the Associate Head of School will make the first report to CP&P by telephone call to the **Child Abuse Hotline (State Central Registry) at 1-877-652-2873**. In the event it is not clear whether conduct reaches a level of

reportable abuse or neglect or there is a disagreement between an employee and the School's administration, any party who believes that the incident rises to the threshold for making a report must make the report. The responsibility to report rests both on the individual professional and on the School.

Any person who knowingly fails to report an act of child abuse having reasonable cause to believe that an act of child abuse has been committed, is a disorderly person. Any person who knowingly fails to report an act of sexual abuse against a child and who has reasonable cause to believe that an act of sexual abuse has been committed is guilty of a crime of the fourth degree.

Definitions

The New Jersey State Child Abuse and Neglect Law (N.J.S.A. 9:6-8.9 et seq.) defines an "abused child" as a child under the age of 18 years whose parent, guardian or other person having his custody and control: (a) Inflicts or allows to be inflicted upon such child physical injury by other than accidental means which causes or creates a substantial risk of death, or serious or protracted disfigurement, or protracted impairment of physical or emotional health or protracted loss or impairment of the function of any bodily organ; (b) Creates or allows to be created a substantial or ongoing risk of physical injury to such child by other than accidental means which would be likely to cause death or serious or protracted disfigurement, or protracted loss or impairment of the function of any bodily organ; or (c) Commits or allows to be committed an act of sexual abuse against the child; or (d) A child whose physical, mental or emotional condition has been impaired or is in imminent danger of becoming impaired as the result of the failure of his parent or guardian, or such other person having his custody and control, to exercise a minimum degree of care (1) in supplying the child with adequate food, clothing, shelter, education, medical or surgical care though financially able to do so or though offered financial or other reasonable means to do so; or (2) in providing the child with proper supervision or guardianship, by unreasonably inflicting or allowing to be inflicted harm, or substantial risk thereof, including the infliction of excessive corporal punishment or using excessive physical restraint under circumstances that do not indicate that the child's behavior is harmful to themselves, others or property; or (3) by any act of a similarly serious nature requiring the aid of the court; or (e) A child who has been willfully abandoned by his parent or guardian, or such other person having custody and control; or (f) A child who is in an institution as defined in section 1 of P.L. 1974, c. 119 (C. 9:6-8.21) and (1) has been so placed inappropriately for a continued period of time with the knowledge that the placement has resulted and may continue to result in harm to the child's mental or physical well-being; or (2) has been willfully isolated from ordinary social contact under circumstances that indicate emotional or social deprivation.

Neglect of a child shall consist in any of the following acts, by anyone having the custody or control of the child: (a) willfully failing to provide proper and sufficient food, clothing, maintenance, regular school education as required by law, medical attendance or surgical treatment, and a clean and proper home, or (b) failure to do or permit to be done any act necessary for the child's physical or moral well-being. Neglect also means the continued inappropriate placement of a child in an institution, as defined in section 1 of P.L. 1974, c. 119 (C. 9:6-8.21), with the knowledge that the placement has resulted and may continue to result in harm to the child's mental or physical well-being.

STUDENT SEXUAL ASSAULT & REPORTING GUIDELINES

Sexual Assault in New Jersey is any conduct proscribed by N.J.S.A. 2C:14-2(a)(1) through (7), N.J.S.A. 2C:14-2(b), and N.J.S.A. 2C:14-2(c)(1) through (4) of the New Jersey Criminal Code,

including any act of penetration performed or perpetrated on one person by another under circumstances indicating a lack of consent, either due to force, or an inability of one party to consent due to age, relationship, mental defect or physical incapacitation.

Under New Jersey law, an individual who is at least 13 years of age but fewer than 18 years of age is eligible for a full range of services by the Sexual Assault Response Team (SART). Current New Jersey law requires that before any sexual assault medical forensic examination of an adolescent is performed, parental notification is required, unless it is determined it is not in the best interest of the victim. A child less than 13 years of age is not eligible for services of the SART; however, children aged 12 and under may receive an emergent sexual assault medical forensic examination.

In any and all cases of suspected sexual assault, the suspicious or concerning findings must be reported immediately to the Director of Health Services who will report to the Head of School and Associate Head of School. In cases where the Director of Health Services is not available, cases should be reported to the Associate Head of School. In addition to reporting to the aforementioned individuals, all cases must be reported to the New Jersey Department of Children and Families Child Protection and Permanency (CP&P) as outlined in the above policy.

WORKPLACE SEARCHES

To protect property and to ensure the safety of all employees, students, constituents and the School, the administration may conduct personal searches consistent with both federal and state law, and to inspect packages, parcels, purses, handbags, briefcases, lunchboxes, or any other possessions or articles. In addition, the administration may search any employee's office, desk, files, lockers, computer, equipment or any other area or article on our premises. Blair also reserves the right to search the campus residences of employees if the School suspects there is a violation of School policies. In this regard, it should be noted that all offices, desks, files, lockers and equipment are the property of the School and are to be used by employees only during their employment. Inspection may be conducted at any time at the discretion of the administration.

As such, employees working on or entering or leaving the premises who refuse to cooperate in an inspection, as well as employees who after the inspection are believed to be in possession of stolen property or illegal drugs, may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

WORKPLACE VIOLENCE

The School is committed to providing a campus that is free from acts of violence and threats of violence. In keeping with this commitment, employees are strictly prohibited from threatening or committing any act of violence on campus, while on duty, while on School-related business, or while off-duty if the School determines that the incident may lead to an incident of violence on School premises. Violence of any kind by an employee or anyone else against an employee, supervisor or member of the administration will not be tolerated.

The purpose of this policy is to minimize the potential risk of personal injuries to employees at work and to reduce the possibility of damage to Blair property in the event that someone, for whatever reason, may be unhappy with a decision or action by an employee or member of the administration. This policy applies to all employees, as well as third parties, such as employee guests, independent contractors, and anyone else who is on School property or engaged in School business. The School has zero tolerance for individuals and employees who make threats, engage in threatening behavior,

or commit acts of violence against employees, students, families, visitors, alumni, guests or other individuals. Compliance with this policy is every employee's responsibility.

If you receive or overhear any threatening communications from an employee or outside third-party, you should report it immediately to Blair Security, Safety & Security Consultant or Chief Financial & Operations Officer. Do not engage in either physical or verbal confrontation with a potentially violent individual. If you encounter an individual who is threatening immediate harm to an employee, student, other community member or visitor to our premises, contact an emergency agency (such as 911) immediately.

All reports of work-related threats will be kept confidential to the extent practicable under the circumstances, investigated in a prompt and thorough manner, and documented accordingly. Employees are expected to report and participate in investigations or suspected or actual cases of workplace violence.

Employees who become aware of any workplace security hazards, or who have suggestions for increasing security on campus, should speak with their supervisors. The School encourages employees to help make the campus as safe and secure as possible.

Violations of this policy, including your failure to report or fully cooperate in Blair Academy's investigation, may result in disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination of employment.

WEAPONS ON CAMPUS

Possession, use or sale of weapons, firearms or explosives on work premises, including School-provided housing, is forbidden under any circumstances, in accordance with state and local laws (unless approved, in advance and in writing, by the Head of School). To the extent permitted by applicable law, this policy includes a prohibition against employees having prohibited material in their vehicles while parked on the School's property. Employees who have licenses to carry weapons must also comply with this policy at all times. Violations of this policy will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment and the School will report any violation to the appropriate authorities.

IV. COMPENSATION & HOURS OF WORK

ATTENDANCE & PUNCTUALITY

Attendance and punctuality are important factors for your success within Blair. We work as a team and this requires that each person be in the right place at the right time.

All employees are expected to work their full scheduled workdays. If you are going to be late for work or absent, you are required to notify your supervisor as soon as possible before the start of your workday. If a non-exempt employee is late reporting to work, the employee's supervisor may arrange for the employee to make up the time lost during the same payroll week.

Personal issues requiring time away from your work, such as doctor's appointments or other matters, should be scheduled during your non-working hours, if possible.

Except for time off taken in compliance with the School's time off policies and applicable law, if you are absent for more than three consecutive days without notifying your supervisor, it is assumed that you have voluntarily abandoned your position with Blair, and you will be removed from the payroll effective the start of the fourth day.

If you are absent for three days or more due to illness, you may be asked to provide a doctor's note supporting your absence.

A consistent pattern of questionable absences and/or lateness may be considered excessive and result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

SEVERE WEATHER

Severe weather can be expected throughout the year. Although driving may at times be difficult, the School does not have the option of sending students home during severe weather, and Blair must continue to function. Please exercise good judgment for your personal safety and that of others when deciding to commute to work. Time taken off due to poor weather conditions while the School and offices remain open is to be used as work from home (for those who are authorized to work remotely), paid time off (PTO) or unpaid. In the rare event that the School decides to close the campus due to severe weather, non-essential employees will be paid for the day and are expected to "work from home" as best they can. Essential employees are required to report to work.

MEAL & BREAK PERIODS

All staff members are entitled to a 30-minute meal break each day. With the exception of staff members whose work requires them to be "on call" during the meal break (including security, nursing staff, Boiler House and Childcare Learning Center employees), all meal breaks shall be unpaid. Please coordinate with your supervisor, who is responsible for approving the scheduling of your lunch break.

All staff members are permitted to take one 15-minute paid break of each workday, which must be approved by their supervisor.

Meal and break periods for faculty members vary depending on daily schedules and needs of the department.

RECORDING YOUR TIME

For payroll purposes, the workweek starts on Sunday and ends on Saturday.

To comply with federal and state wage and hour laws and regulations, non-exempt employees are required to record their hours in the School's automated payroll system, Paychex Flex. Paychex Flex is used to record regular hours, overtime hours, paid time off (PTO) and holidays. Time should be recorded daily, must accurately reflect start time, end time and meal breaks. The School requires employees to complete their time records accurately and on time.

OVERTIME

There may be times when you will need to work overtime so that we may meet the needs of the School. Non-exempt employees must have all overtime approved in advance by their supervisor.

Non-exempt employees will receive overtime pay at a rate of one-and-a-half their regular hourly rate of pay for all hours actually worked in excess of 40 hours in a workweek.

Only actual hours worked count toward computing weekly overtime. PTO hours, as well as holidays, and unpaid leave of absence are not counted when computing weekly overtime.

All non-exempt, essential employees who report to work to remove snow will be paid double time for all hours worked outside a normal day (prior to 7 a.m. and after 3:30 p.m.). If snow removal is required on a Saturday or Sunday or on a Blair-recognized holiday, then double time will be paid. The Director of Facilities will approve all "snow-time" worked.

If you have any questions concerning overtime pay, check with the Business Office.

THE DORMITORY COMPENSATION PLAN

Employees who live in a School dormitory and serve as a dorm head or an assistant dorm head are eligible to receive an additional taxable stipend that is reviewed annually by Blair, the amount of which will be determined by the Associate Head of School for these additional duties.

EMPLOYEE RECRUITMENT BONUS

To encourage employee participation in building a strong team, Blair Academy offers a \$250 recruitment bonus to any current employee who refers a candidate who is hired for a full-time position. To be eligible, the referring employee must notify the Director of Human Resources Operations at the time of the candidate's application, and the candidate must include the employee's name on their application or resume. Only one bonus will be paid per hired individual, and hiring managers involved in the recruitment process are not eligible.

PAYCHECKS

The School's pay frequency is bi-weekly/every other Friday. If a payday falls on a non-working day, employees will be paid on the preceding workday. The School's payroll is paperless, meaning that all employees are required to enroll in direct deposit and will have access to their pay stubs online.

PAYROLL DEDUCTIONS

Blair Academy is required by law to make certain deductions from your paycheck each pay period. Such deductions typically include federal and state income taxes and Social Security. In addition, you

may authorize payroll deductions for certain other purposes, such as group insurance plans. All voluntary deductions must be authorized in writing.

All deductions and the amount of those deductions are listed on your pay stub and are totaled each year on your Form W-2, Wage and Tax Statement. Each January, the School will issue your Form W-2 for the preceding calendar year. If your employment with the School terminates prior to January, your W-2 form will be mailed to the last address on record at the School.

If you have any questions, please see the Director of Human Resources Operations.

PAYCHECK POLICY

The School seeks to ensure that employees are paid promptly and properly on their scheduled paydays. In addition, the School makes a good faith effort to avoid making any improper deductions from an employee's pay. In the unlikely event there is an error in the amount of an employee's pay, or an impermissible deduction is made from the employee's pay, the employee should promptly report the matter to the Director of Human Resources Operations or Director of Finance so that appropriate corrections may be made as quickly as possible. In the event of an improper deduction, the School will promptly reimburse the employee for the improperly deducted amount. In the event of an over-payment of wages, the School expects the employee to cooperate in correcting the over-payment. Accordingly, the School may deduct repayment from the employee's future wages to the extent permitted by applicable law. In the event that no further wages are due to the employee, the School may seek to recover the wage over-payment to the fullest extent permitted by applicable law.

WAGE ASSIGNMENTS & GARNISHMENTS

The School is legally bound to comply with certain government orders requiring the reduction of payroll dollars for garnishments, IRS restraining notices and wage assignments.

V. BENEFITS

EMPLOYEE BENEFITS OVERVIEW

Blair Academy has developed a comprehensive set of employee benefit programs to supplement our employees' regular wages. Collectively, our benefits packages offer employees substantial additional value and income. A number of the programs (such as Social Security, workers' compensation and unemployment insurance) cover all employees in the manner prescribed by law. Some benefit programs require contributions from employees, and others are fully paid by the School.

This section of the *Employee Handbook* summarizes the current benefit plans offered by Blair Academy. Separate guides that describe the various benefit plans in more detail are available from the Director of Human Resources Operations. You should contact the Director of Human Resources Operations or refer to the actual plan documents and summary plan description if you have specific questions. In each case, the actual provisions of the formal plan documents, policies or contract govern in determining eligibility for benefits, benefit levels and all other matters.

Blair Academy may amend, modify, and/or terminate any of its benefits at any time without notice. The School will attempt to keep you informed of any changes. Any interpretation or determination that the School makes regarding these plans and programs will be final and conclusive, in the absence of clear and convincing evidence that the School acted arbitrarily and capriciously.

MEDICAL INSURANCE

Eligible full-time employees and families may enroll in one of our multiple health insurance plan offerings after completing 30 days of employment. To assist you with the cost of this insurance, Blair contributes to single and family plans. You are responsible for paying the balance through payroll deductions.

A benefits guide summary containing the details of the plans and eligibility requirements may be obtained from the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Upon termination, you may be eligible to continue or convert the group medical insurance plan in accordance with the terms of the policy and/or applicable state and federal law. For more information, please see the COBRA policy below or contact the Director of Human Resources Operations.

If you are covered by another health insurance and wish to waive coverage under Blair's plan, you may do so. You will need to provide a copy of your current insurance card stating that you are covered to the Director of Human Resources Operations and sign a waiver of coverage. A stipend will be paid for waiving coverage at the end of the fiscal year.

DENTAL INSURANCE

Eligible full-time employees and families may enroll in one of our multiple plan offerings immediately upon hire. You will be responsible for the full cost of the insurance through payroll deductions.

A benefits guide summary containing the details of the plan and the eligibility requirements may be obtained from the Director of Human Resources Operations.

VISION INSURANCE

Eligible full-time employees and families may enroll in one of our multiple plan offerings immediately upon hire. You will be responsible for the full cost of the insurance through payroll deductions.

A benefits guide summary containing the detail of the plan and the eligibility requirements may be obtained from the Director of Human Resources Operations.

COBRA

You and your covered dependents will have the opportunity to continue medical benefits for a period of up to 18 months (or longer) under the provisions of the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA) when group medical coverage for you and your covered dependents would otherwise end due to your death or because:

- Your employment terminates for a reason other than gross misconduct.
- Your employment status changes due to a reduction in hours.
- Your child ceases to be a “dependent child” under the terms of the medical plan.
- You become divorced or legally separated.
- You become entitled to Medicare.

In the event of divorce, legal separation or a child’s loss of dependent status, you or a family member must notify the Director of Human Resources Operations within 60 days of such event.

The Director of Human Resources Operations will notify the individuals eligible for continuation coverage of their right to elect COBRA coverage.

RETIREMENT PLAN

Defined-Contribution Plan/DC (mandatory)

Administered by the Teachers Insurance and Annuity Association and the College Retirement Equities Fund (TIAA), the Blair Academy Defined-Contribution Retirement Plan is available to all full-time employees after having completed one year of service at Blair. Participation in the plan is mandatory. Blair Academy will contribute 7-½ percent of your base salary for the first five years of participation in Blair’s plan. Starting with the sixth year of participation in the plan, Blair will contribute 10 percent of your base salary. Blair’s retirement plan requires a 5-percent contribution from the employee on a tax-deferred basis. TIAA has a number of investment options from which an employee may choose.

Tax-Deferred Annuity Plan/TDA (voluntary)

The Blair Academy Tax-Deferred Annuity Plan is a retirement plan administered by TIAA to which all employees can contribute regardless of their participation in the regular annuity plan. The School does not contribute to the plan. Contributions by the employee can be made on a tax-deferred basis (pre-tax) so that the employee does not pay federal income tax on the amount contributed until it is redeemed or contributions can be made on a post-tax (ROTH) basis.

You can obtain from the Director of Human Resources Operations a copy of the summary plan description, which contains details about eligibility and benefit provisions. In the event of any conflict in the description of these plans, the official plan documents, which are available for your review, shall govern. If you have any questions regarding this plan, see the Director of Human Resources Operations.

SECTION 125 PLAN: FLEXIBLE SPENDING ACCOUNT

Blair Academy offers a pre-tax contribution option for employees. This employee benefit is known as a Section 125 plan, which allows you to pay for out-of-pocket medical/dental expenses or dependent-care expenses on a “before-tax” basis. Your qualified expenses are deducted from your gross pay before income taxes and Social Security is calculated. Contributions that go unused during the fiscal year will be forfeited.

To participate in this plan, you must complete an election form and return it to the Director of Human Resources Operations. Your gross pay is reduced by an amount equal to your contributions for medical insurance, dental insurance, and out-of-pocket medical expenses and dependent-care expenses.

You cannot make any changes to your pre-tax contributions until the next open-enrollment period, unless your family status changes or you become eligible for a special enrollment period due to a loss of coverage. Family status changes include marriage, divorce, death of a spouse or child, birth or adoption of a child or termination of your spouse employment. A change in election due to a change in family status becomes effective the following month.

SHORT-TERM DISABILITY

The School has established Short-Term Disability for its eligible employees through a private plan that meets the requirements established by the State of New Jersey for a Temporary Disability Benefits Plan. The School’s Short-Term Disability Plan provides coverage in lieu of benefits available through the State of New Jersey. This plan is intended to provide a percentage of income replacement benefits for eligible employees for illness, injury or short periods of disability that are not due to or arising from their work for the School.

Employees who have met the minimum earning requirements are eligible for short-term disability insurance. In the event an employee is absent from work for a period of seven days due to non-occupational illness, injury or pregnancy-related disability, the employee shall submit a claim for short-term disability coverage no later than 30 days after the first such absence. The weekly benefit is an amount equal to 85 percent of covered earnings, up to a maximum weekly benefit. The plan covers the first 26 weeks of a disability.

Employees are required to complete a claim form that includes written notice from their doctor stating the nature of the disability and expected date of return. Information on disability benefits can be obtained from the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Employees are required to use any accrued and unused sick/paid time off during the first week of their absence. Other employment benefits will continue, in the form and amount in effect on the date of the first such absence, throughout the short-term disability.

During the period of short-term disability, Blair may, on equitable consideration, grant benefits in

excess of those required by this provision, but neither agrees to continue to do so nor to make comparable benefits available to other employees similarly situated.

LONG-TERM DISABILITY

Long-term disability insurance is provided for all full-time employees. Blair Academy pays the entire cost of this insurance. This plan covers approximately 60 percent of the employee's annual income (including housing) for the length of the disability or until age 65. The plan is effective two months after full-time employment begins.

At the end of the six-month short-term disability period, the employee may file, within 30 days, an application for long-term disability.

LIFE INSURANCE & AD&D

Life insurance is provided to all full-time employees. There is a 60-day waiting period to become eligible. The insurance is equal to two times your salary, up to \$300,000, and Blair pays the entire premium. An additional rider that covers spouses for \$5,000 and children (up to the age of 19) for \$2,000 is available at an additional cost to the employee.

EMPLOYEE HOUSING

Full-time employees may receive housing as a condition of employment. Only the employee and their legal dependents, spouses and/or domestic partners may reside in School-provided housing. School-provided housing is assigned by the Head of School, and assignments are designed to meet the staffing needs of Blair's residential program. Depending on the needs of the School, employees may be required to relocate to other School or non-School provided housing. Whether in the dormitories, on the campus at large, or in the local community, School-provided housing is designed to allow employees their necessary and important daily involvement with our students.

Employees living in School-provided housing are required to sign an Employee Housing Agreement and abide by the School's Housing Guidelines in Appendix B.

In the event that any member of the Blair Academy community fails to comply with the housing standards set forth in the Employee Housing Agreement, this *Employee Handbook* and/or the Housing Guidelines or, in the view of the School, engages in conduct which is potentially injurious to the people or reputation of Blair Academy, the School may with or without notice, discipline such individual by measures up to and including immediate termination of employment and/or provision of School housing.

TUITION REMISSION

Tuition remission is available to all dependent children of full-time employees who have been employed for at least 12 months prior to the first day of classes of the year for which remission is sought. Part-time employees are not eligible for this benefit. Employees who are not eligible for this benefit or who are eligible for partial remission may apply for financial aid.

Children of employees must be admitted to the School as per the criteria outlined in the School's admission policies. Only the children of full-time employees who have been offered employment for the following school year will be considered under the School's tuition remission policy.

Remission for employee children who apply for admission and are accepted will be granted under the following criteria:

- Year one: 20 percent of day tuition will be funded by Blair.
- Year two: 40 percent of day tuition will be funded by Blair.
- Year three: 60 percent of day tuition will be funded by Blair.
- Year four: 80 percent of day tuition will be funded by Blair.
- Year five & after: 100 percent of day tuition will be funded by Blair.

For purposes of this policy, “child” includes the employee’s biological, adopted or foster child, as well as a stepchild or a legal ward.

DINING HALL ACCESS

Faculty members and their immediate families have access to the dining hall for all meals when the dining hall is open during the academic year. Staff members are welcome to eat in the dining hall throughout the school year and over the summer months for lunch; those who work during the evening hours due to professional obligations may also attend buffet dinners.

CHILDCARE LEARNING CENTER

Blair Academy provides access to childcare on a limited basis; the Childcare Learning Center will be available to full-time employees first and then to part-time employees (with preference given to families where both parents work), if there is room available. Please see the Childcare Learning Center Director to obtain the rates for daycare usage.

FACILITY USAGE

All full-time employees and their immediate family members (including an employee’s spouse/partner and dependent children) may use the following facilities: Timken Library, Fitness Center, Wallace Pool (with appropriate lifeguard supervision), performance gymnasium, field house, squash courts, tennis courts and golf course. Blair Academy athletic teams and students have priority of use, and Blair Academy may close these facilities on certain dates for maintenance and special events as necessary. All rules and regulations set forth for each facility must be followed.

Certain fees, such as golf cart rental, must be paid by the employee and/or immediate family member.

Please have your Blair ID with you and accompany your family member at all times. All employees and their family members should sign-in at the Pro Shop when using the golf course.

STATUTORY INSURANCE

Social Security

During your employment, you and Blair both contribute funds to the federal government to support the Social Security program, which is intended to provide you with retirement benefit payments and medical coverage once you reach retirement age. In addition to retirement benefits, the program provides benefits for eligible employees and their dependents in the event of disability.

Unemployment Compensation

The School pays the full cost of unemployment insurance, in accordance with applicable federal and state requirements. Upon separation from employment, you may be entitled to state and federal unemployment insurance benefits. Information about unemployment insurance can be obtained from the Business Office.

Workers' Compensation Insurance

Blair Academy has purchased workers' compensation insurance to provide protection to both employees and the School if an employee suffers an on-the-job injury or work-related illness. This benefit is provided to all employees at no cost.

Neither the School nor the School's insurance carrier will be liable for the payment of workers' compensation insurance benefits for injuries that occur during an employee's voluntary participation in any off-duty recreational, social or athletic activity sponsored by the School.

VI. TIME OFF

PAID TIME OFF (PTO)

The School has established this paid time off (PTO) policy to provide regular, year-round full-time employees with flexible, paid time off from work, which can be used for such needs as vacation, personal and/or sick time in accordance with the New Jersey Earned Sick Leave law including: (1) caring for the employee's own physical or mental illness, injury or other adverse health condition, or preventative medical care; (2) caring for the employee's family member, who is suffering from a physical or mental illness, injury or other adverse health condition, or during preventative medical care; (3) addressing physical, psychological or legal effects related to the employee or employee's family member's status as a victim of domestic or sexual violence; (4) the closure of an employee's workplace or of a school/childcare of an employee's child because of a public official's order due to a public health emergency; or (5) attending a school-related conference, meeting, function or other event for the employee's child.

If you need time off for sick leave purposes after exhausting all of your PTO, additional time off will not be provided unless otherwise required by law (e.g., FMLA).

Full-time employees are eligible to earn and use PTO as described in this policy.

Faculty members, part-time and seasonal/temporary employees are not eligible for PTO.

PTO Accrual & Eligibility

- Full-time non-exempt employees are eligible for PTO as follows:
 - Upon completion of your first three months of employment, you will begin to earn 1.42 days of PTO each month, up to a maximum of 17 days of PTO annually.
 - After five full fiscal years, you will earn 22 days of PTO annually.
 - After 10 full fiscal years, you will earn 24 days of PTO annually.
 - After 15 full fiscal years, you will earn 27 days of PTO annually.
- Full-time exempt employees' PTO is determined at the time of hire and communicated in offer letters:
 - After five full fiscal years, you will earn an additional five days of PTO annually.
 - After 10 full fiscal years, you will earn an additional two days of PTO annually.
 - After 15 full fiscal years, you will earn an additional three days of PTO annually.

After your first year of employment, PTO is calculated and allotted based on the School's fiscal year (July 1-June 30). If your hire date falls within the first three months of the fiscal year, then that year will count toward a full fiscal year for the purpose of calculating PTO.

Approval Process

All PTO requests are subject to supervisor approval and should be requested through the School's payroll system. The School understands that unscheduled absences occasionally happen; however, when possible, PTO should be scheduled at least three days in advance. Supervisors or the Director of Human Resources Operations will approve PTO requests, taking into account Blair's operating requirements. Length of employment may determine priority in scheduling PTO. Except for the purposes of sick time, requests for PTO may be denied for a variety of reasons, including because

the requested PTO is during a busy period or because it is too long. If you are absent from work due to illness for three or more days/shifts, Blair Academy may request documentation from your healthcare provider supporting the need for leave.

PTO Pay

PTO is paid at your base pay rate at the time of the absence. It does not include overtime or any special forms of compensation such as incentives or bonuses.

Unused PTO

PTO which is accrued but not used by the end of the fiscal year is forfeited, except that you can carry a maximum of 10 days may be carried over from one fiscal year to the next.

Upon termination of employment, any unused PTO carried over from the prior year and any accrued and unused PTO from the current year will be paid out in the employee's last paycheck, subject to applicable federal and state withholdings. If separation of employment occurs within the first six months of the fiscal year, PTO for that year shall be paid out on a prorated basis.

PAID SICK LEAVE

Blair Academy is committed to complying with the provisions of New Jersey's Earned Sick Leave law in all respects. The following policy has been implemented to meet the requirements of the law, as well as to provide employees who are not otherwise eligible for PTO in accordance with the policy above sick time in accordance with the law. This policy applies to faculty members, part-time employees and seasonal/temporary employees. Full-time, year-round employees are provided with paid sick time under the School's PTO policy above, and will not be entitled to additional time under this sick leave policy.

Accrual & Use

Employees will begin accruing sick time on their first day of employment with Blair Academy.

Part-time employees accrue sick time at a rate of one hour for every 30 hours worked, up to a maximum of 40 hours in a defined year. Faculty members will be provided with 40 hours of sick leave over the course of Blair's fiscal year, which runs from July 1 through June 30.

Employees will be eligible to utilize sick time 120 days after the date of the employee's hire.

Employees may use earned sick days for:

- Caring for their own physical or mental illness, injury, or other adverse health condition, or preventative medical care.
- Caring for their family member, who is suffering from a physical or mental illness, injury or adverse health condition, or during preventative medical care.
- Addressing physical, psychological or legal effects related to the employee or employee's family member's status as a victim of domestic or sexual violence, including medical attention necessary for physical or psychological injury; obtaining services from a designated domestic violence agency or other victim services organization; relocation; or legal services, including participation in any related legal proceeding.
- Closure of the employee's workplace, or of a school or childcare of an employee's child due to a public official's order due to a public-health emergency.

- Attending a school-related conference, meeting, function or other event for the employee's child.

Use of sick time for any other purpose is not covered by this policy. For purposes of this policy, "family member" is defined as the employee's child, grandchild, sibling, spouse, domestic partner, civil union partner, parent, or grandparent or any other individual related by blood to the employee or whose close association with the employee is the equivalent of a family relationship.

Notice & Documentation

If your need for earned sick leave is foreseeable (can be planned in advance), Blair Academy requires you to make a good-faith effort to notify the School at least seven days in advance of your intention to use earned sick leave. If your need for earned sick leave is unforeseeable (cannot be planned in advance), Blair Academy requires you to give notice as soon as it is practical under the circumstances.

Blair Academy requires its employees to provide documentation from a healthcare provider for use of leave time equaling or exceeding three consecutive days. Any documentation provided should state the need for the absence and the duration, but employees are not required—and should not request their healthcare provider—to disclose the specific medical diagnosis or underlying condition.

Unused Sick Leave

Employees may carry over up to a maximum of 40 hours of accrued and unused sick leave into the following fiscal year. However, employees are not entitled to use more than 40 hours of accrued sick time in any one defined year.

Accrued and unused sick days are not paid out at the end of the defined year, upon termination of employment or at any other time.

Break in Service

If an employee is rehired or reinstated within six months of separation from Blair Academy, any previously accrued and unused earned sick leave will be immediately restored to the employee's balance. Furthermore, any prior days of employment will count toward fulfilling the 120-day waiting period to utilize the leave.

HOLIDAYS

Blair Academy normally observes the following holidays during the year:

- New Year's Day
- Memorial Day
- Juneteenth
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving Day & the following Friday
- Christmas Day

Full-time employees are eligible for paid holidays after completing 90 days of employment.

If one of the above holidays falls on a Saturday, it normally is observed on the preceding Friday. If one falls on Sunday, it normally is observed on the following Monday.

In addition to the above holidays, after 90 days of employment, full-time employees will receive three extra days over the December/January break and two extra days during spring break, all of which must be taken during the periods when students are away from School.

Full-time, non-exempt employees who are required to work on a holiday listed above will receive their holiday pay, plus one-and-half times their regular rate of pay for all hours worked.

Full-time, exempt staff members who are required to work on a holiday listed above will receive additional PTO hours for hours worked on that day.

BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

Full-time employees who have completed 90 days of employment are eligible for up to three days of paid bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member (including spouses/domestic partners, parents, siblings, children, grandparents, grandchildren, parents-in-law and their parents).

Requests for bereavement leave should be made to your immediate supervisor as soon as possible. Blair may request written verification of an employee's familial relationship to the deceased and their attendance at the funeral service as a condition of the bereavement pay.

PAID PARENTAL LEAVE

Blair Academy will provide up to six weeks of paid parental leave to employees following the birth of an employee's child or placement of a child with an employee in connection with adoption or foster care.

Eligibility:

To be eligible for paid parental leave, an employee must have been employed as a full-time employee with the School for at least 12 consecutive months preceding the birth of the employee's child or placement of the child with the employee through adoption or foster care.

Amount, Time Frame, Duration & Coordination with Other Policies

- Eligible employees will receive a maximum of six weeks of paid parental leave per birth, adoption or placement of a child/children. The fact that a multiple birth, adoption or placement occurs does not increase the six week total amount of paid parental leave granted. In addition, in no case will an employee receive more than six weeks of paid parental leave in a rolling 12-month period, regardless of whether more than one birth, adoption or foster care placement event occurs with-in that 12-month time frame.
- Leave may start with the birth, adoption or placement of the child (or up to two weeks prior), regardless of School vacations/breaks.
- Each week of paid parental leave is paid at 100 percent of the employee's regular base pay.
- Approved paid parental leave may be taken at any time during the six-month period immediately following the birth, adoption or placement of a child with the employee. Paid parental leave may not be used or extended beyond this time frame.
- In the event of an employee who has given birth, the six weeks of paid parental leave can be

used in lieu of six weeks of short-term disability benefits.

- Employees must take paid parental leave in one continuous period of leave during the six-month time frame indicated above and may not be taken on an intermittent or reduced schedule basis. Any unused paid parental leave will be forfeited.

Coordination with Other Policies:

- Paid parental leave does not provide any type of job protection, just income replacement.
- To the extent an employee is eligible for paid leave or benefits under this policy and other School policies and/or applicable law, this leave will run concurrently with other leaves and/or paid benefits detailed in this *Handbook*.
- The School will maintain all benefits for employees during the paid parental leave period.
- If a School holiday or break period occurs while the employee is on paid parental leave, such day or break period will not extend the total paid parental leave entitlement.
- Employees should review the following policies in this *Handbook* for more information on job protection and additional income replacement benefits to which they may be entitled.
 - Family Medical Leave Act (FMLA)
 - New Jersey Family Leave Act (NJFLA)
 - New Jersey Family Leave Insurance (FLI)
 - Short-Term Disability

Requests for Paid Parental Leave & Returning to Work

- The employee will provide the Director of Human Resources Operations and the Dean of Faculty Life notice of the request for leave at least three months prior to the proposed date of the leave (or, if the leave was not foreseeable, as soon as possible).
- Faculty are expected to assign a grade for that portion of the course completed and shall meet with the person replacing them to facilitate a smooth transition.

FEDERAL FAMILY & MEDICAL LEAVE ACT

As set forth below, the School provides family and medical leave in compliance with the federal Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) of 1993.

To be eligible for FMLA leave, you must have satisfied the following conditions:

- Worked for Blair Academy for at least 12 months.
- Worked at least 1,250 hours in the last 12 months.
- The School employs at least 50 employees within a 75-mile radius of where the employee works.

Reasons for Leave

Eligible employees are entitled to up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for the following reasons:

1. Incapacity due to pregnancy, prenatal medical care or childbirth.
2. Care for the employee's child after birth or placement for adoption or foster care.
3. Care for a spouse, your child or parent ("covered relations") with a serious health condition.
4. Because of your own serious health condition renders you unable to perform an essential

function of your position.

Any leave due to the birth and care of a child or the placement of a child for adoption or foster care, and care of the newly placed child, must be completed within one year of the date of birth or placement of the child.

Eligible employee may also take unpaid leave when the employee's parents or immediate family members are called to active military duty status or in active military duty in the following ways:

- Up to 12 weeks of unpaid family leave in a single 12-month period for "qualifying exigencies" of covered service members.
- Up to 26 weeks of unpaid family leave in a single 12-month period to care for a covered service member with a serious injury and illness.

The substitution of paid leave time for unpaid time does not extend the 12-week leave period. Also, your family/medical leave may run concurrently with other types of leave.

Benefits During Leave

During an approved family/medical leave, Blair will maintain your health benefits under the same terms and conditions applicable to employees not on leave.

- If paid leave is substituted for unpaid family/medical leave, your portion of the health plan premium will be taken as a regular payroll deduction.
- If your leave is unpaid, you must pay your portion of the premium by making arrangements with the Business Office.
- Your health coverage may cease if your premium payment is more than 30 days late. If your payment is more than 30 days late, we will send you a letter to this effect. If we do not receive your co-payment within 15 days of receipt of this letter, your coverage will cease.

If you elect not to return to work at the end of the leave for at least 30 calendar days, you will be required to reimburse Blair for maintaining coverage during your unpaid leave, unless you cannot return to work because of a serious health condition or because of other circumstances beyond your control.

When spouses are employed by Blair Academy, they are entitled to a combined total of 12 weeks of leave: (1) for birth, adoption or foster care and to care for such a child; or (2) to care for a parent with a serious health condition. Individuals are entitled to 12 weeks of leave because of their own health conditions or to care for the serious health condition of a child or spouse without counting leave time taken by the other spouse.

Types of Leave

Leave due to a serious health condition may be taken intermittently (in separate blocks of time due to a single health condition) or on a reduced leave schedule (reducing the usual number of hours you work per workweek or work day), rather than continuously, if medically necessary and in accordance

with the conditions provided for such intermittent leave under the FMLA. Employees must make reasonable efforts to schedule leave for planned medical treatment so as not to unduly disrupt the School's operations. Leave due to qualifying exigencies, and leave for bonding with a military member on rest or recuperation leave, may also be taken on an intermittent basis. When leave is taken after the birth of a healthy child or placement of a healthy child for adoption or foster care, an employee may take leave intermittently or on a reduced schedule basis only if the School agrees to such an arrangement. If the leave is unpaid, Blair will adjust your salary based on the amount of time actually worked. In addition, while you are on an intermittent or reduced-schedule leave, Blair may temporarily transfer you to an available alternative position that better accommodates your recurring leave and that has equivalent pay and benefits.

You must complete the appropriate family/medical leave forms, which are available in the Business Office.

If your need for family/medical leave is foreseeable, you must give 30 days' prior written notice. If this is not possible, you must give notice to the Business Office as soon as practicable (within one or two business days of learning your need for leave). Failure to provide such notice may be grounds for delay of leave. If your need is because of a planned medical treatment, attempt to schedule the treatment to avoid disrupting the School's operations. You must provide sufficient information for the School to determine if the leave may qualify for FMLA protection and the anticipated timing and duration of the leave. Sufficient information may include that the employee is unable to perform job functions, the family member is unable to perform daily activities, the need for hospitalization or continuing treatment by a healthcare provider, or circumstances supporting the need for military family leave. Employees also must inform the School if the requested leave is for a reason for which FMLA was previously taken or certified.

The School will inform an employee requesting leave whether the employee is eligible for FMLA leave. The notice will specify any additional information required, as well as the employee's rights and responsibilities. If the employee is not eligible for FMLA leave, the School will provide a reason for the ineligibility.

The School will inform an employee if leave will be designated as FMLA and the amount of leave counted against the employee's leave entitlement. If the School determines that the leave does not qualify as FMLA, Blair will notify the employee.

Special Rules Applicable to Instructional Employees of School

In accordance with the Special School Rules under the FMLA, the School may require instructional employees (generally faculty members) to:

- Take FMLA leave for periods of particular duration not to exceed the planned medical treatment or supervision (if the leave was foreseeable and the employee would be on leave for greater than 20 percent of the total number of working days during which the leave would extend); or
- Transfer temporarily to an available alternative position offered by the School for which the employee is qualified, which has equivalent pay and benefits, and which better accommodates the recurring periods of leave than the employee's regular employment position.

In addition, if an instructional employee begins family or medical leave more than five weeks before the end of the academic term, the School may require the instructional employee to continue to take leave until the end of the term if:

- The leave is at least three weeks in duration.
- The return to employment would occur during the three-week period before the end of the academic term.

If an instructional employee begins FMLA leave more than three weeks and up to and including five weeks before the end of the academic term, the School may require the instructional employee to continue to take leave until the end of the term if:

- The leave is greater than two weeks in duration.
- The return to employment would occur during the two-week period before the end of the academic term.

If an instructional employee begins leave under this policy three weeks or fewer before the end of the academic term and the duration of the leave is greater than five working days, the School may require the employee to continue to take leave until the end of the term.

Medical Certification for a Serious Health Condition

If you are requesting leave because of your own or a covered relation's serious health condition, the appropriate healthcare provider must supply medical certification. Obtain a medical certification form from the Director of Human Resources Operations (except in an emergency situation). You should provide the medical certification with your request for leave 15 days before your leave begins. If you do not provide the required medical certification in a timely manner, leave may be denied or delayed until it is provided.

Blair Academy, at its expense, may require an examination by a second healthcare provider designated by the School, if it reasonably doubts the medical certification you initially provide. If the second healthcare provider's opinion conflicts with the original medical certification, the School, at its expense, may require a third, mutually agreeable, healthcare provider to conduct an examination and provide a final and binding opinion. Blair may require subsequent medical recertification. Failure to provide requested certification within 15 days if such is practicable may result in delay of further leave.

Tracking Your Leave

The 12-month period in which 12 weeks of leave may be taken will be tracked based on the first day of the FMLA leave.

Reporting While on Leave

If you take leave because of your own serious health condition or to care for a covered relation with a serious health condition, contact your supervisor on a prescheduled basis regarding the status of the medical condition and your intention to return to work. In addition, you must give notice as soon as practicable (within two business days, if feasible) if the dates of leave change or are extended or initially were unknown.

Returning to Work

If you take leave because of your own serious health condition (except if you are taking intermittent leave), you must provide medical certification that you are able to resume work before you return. Obtain return-to-work medical certification forms from the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Employees failing to complete the return-to-work medical certification form will not be permitted to resume work until it is provided.

Certain highly compensated or “key employees” (who are among the highest-paid 10 percent of employees) may be denied restoration to their prior or equivalent position. Denial may be based on the following conditions:

1. The denial is necessary to prevent substantial economic injury to the employer.
2. The employer has notified the employee of their “key” employee status, as well as its decision to deny restoration should the leave take place or continue.
3. The employee elects not to return to work after being notified of the employer’s decision.

No Work While on Leave

The taking of another job while on family or medical leave or any other authorized leave may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including discharge.

State & Local Family & Medical Leave Laws

Where state or local family and medical leave laws offer more protection or benefits to employees, the protection or benefits of such laws will apply. To the extent an employee is eligible for leave under this policy and any other School policy or applicable law, such leaves will run concurrently.

NEW JERSEY FAMILY LEAVE ACT

Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid family leave within a 24-month period and be restored to the same or an equivalent position upon their return to work under the New Jersey Family Leave Act (“FLA”).

To be eligible for family leave, you must have satisfied the following conditions:

1. Worked for Blair Academy for at least 3 months.
2. Worked at least 250 hours in the 12 months immediately preceding the leave.
3. Given at least 30 days’ notice of your anticipated date of departure and intention to return (except in an emergency situation).

Eligible employees may take family leave for any of the following reasons:

1. Caring for a newly born or adopted child, as long as the leave begins within one year of the date the child is born to or placed with the employee.
2. Caring for a child placed with the employee for foster care or adoption.
- 4.
5. Caring for an employee’s family member who has a serious health condition (including

COVID-19), or who has been isolated or quarantined by order or recommendation of a public health authority or health care provider due to suspected exposure to a communicable disease (including COVID-19) during a state of emergency declared by the Governor.

6. A declared state of emergency or as indicated by a public health authority for an epidemic of a communicable disease or to prevent spread of a communicable disease requiring:
 - In-home care or treatment of a child due to the closure of the child's school or place of care by public order.
 - Responsive or prophylactic measures, including mandatory quarantine, as determined by a public health authority to protect the health of others.
 - Self-quarantine due to exposure by recommendation of a healthcare provider or public health authority to protect the health of others.

For purposes of this policy and in accordance with the FLA, "family member" means a child, including children under 18 years old who are biological, adopted, foster, or stepchildren or legal wards and children over 18 years old because of a physical or mental impairment; a parent, including biological, adoptive foster and stepparents, parents-in-law and legal guardians; sibling; grandparent; grandchild; spouse, domestic partner or partner in a civil union couple; any individual related to the employee by blood; or any other individual whose relationship to the employee is the equivalent of a family relationship.

Any leave due to the birth and care of a child or the placement of a child for adoption or foster care, and care of the newly placed child, must be completed within one year of the date of birth or placement of the child.

Eligible employees must provide written notice of the need for leave to the Director of Human Resources Operations as follows:

- For the birth or placement of a child, at least:
 - 15 days in advance for intermittent or reduced leave; or
 - 30 days in advance for consecutive leave.
- For leave to care for a family member due to a communicable disease:
 - As soon as practicable for intermittent or reduced leave; or
 - In a reasonable and practicable manner for consecutive leave.
- As soon as possible in emergency or unforeseen circumstances.

NEW JERSEY EMERGENCY RESPONSE LEAVE

Employees who fail to report to work because they are serving as volunteer emergency responders during a state of emergency (declared by the President of the United States or the Governor of New Jersey) or are actively engaged in responding to an emergency alarm may be eligible for an unpaid leave of absence. To be granted such leave, the employee must provide notice at least one hour before scheduled to report to work and, upon returning to work, provide a copy of the incident report and a certification affirming that they were actively engaged in rendering emergency services on a set date.

Employees should submit their request for Emergency Response Leave and relevant documentation to the Director of Human Resources Operations.

Employees may choose to use accrued paid time off in order to receive pay for an absence due to volunteer duties related to emergency response, but the School will not require an employee to do so.

NEW JERSEY DOMESTIC & SEXUAL VIOLENCE LEAVE

In accordance with the New Jersey Security and Financial Empowerment Act (“NJ SAFE Act”), eligible employees are entitled to up to 20 days of unpaid leave in any 12-month period if the employee or the employee’s family member is a victim of domestic violence or a sexually violent offense and the employee is using the leave from work to:

- Seek medical attention for, or recover from, physical or psychological injuries.
- Obtain services from a victim services organization.
- Obtain psychological or other counseling.
- Participate in safety planning, temporarily or permanently relocating, or taking other actions to increase the safety.
- Seek legal assistance or other necessary remedies to ensure health and safety.
- Attend, participate in, or prepare for criminal or civil court proceedings.

For purposes of this policy, “family member” means the employee’s parent-in-law; sibling; grandparent; grandchild; child; parent; spouse; domestic partner or civil union partner; any other individual related by blood to the employee; or any other individual that the employee shows to have a close association with the employee which is the equivalent of a family relationship.

Domestic and Sexual Violence Leave must be used in the 12-month period immediately following an instance of domestic violence or a sexually violent offense. Leave must be taken in one day increments on either a continuous or intermittent basis.

To be eligible, the employee must have worked at least 1,000 hours during the immediately preceding 12-month period and, the School must employ 25 or more employees.

Eligible employees are required, if the necessity for the leave is foreseeable, to provide the Director of Human Resources Operations with written notice of the need for the leave, unless an emergency or other unforeseen circumstance precludes prior notice. The employee must provide written notice as far in advance as reasonable and practicable under the circumstances. The School may require the employee to provide documentation of the domestic violence or sexually violent offense that is the basis for the leave.

All information related to the employee’s leave will be kept confidential by the School and will not be disclosed, except in limited circumstances in accordance with applicable law.

Employees may choose to use all available PTO and/or sick leave before taking unpaid leave, but the School will not require them to do so. To the extent employees are eligible for leave under the federal Family and Medical Leave Act (“FMLA”) and/or the New Jersey Family Leave Act law and the New Jersey SAFE Leave Act, or are receiving temporary disability leave benefits, such leaves and benefits will run concurrently.

SIMULTANEOUS LEAVES OF ABSENCE

If an employee is on a leave of absence for a condition covered by various leave laws, then the time period runs simultaneously, as does any paid leave, in accordance with applicable law.

NEW JERSEY FAMILY LEAVE INSURANCE

Employees may be eligible for up to 12 weeks of Family Leave Insurance (FLI) benefits in a 12-month period, which are payable to covered employees to:

1. Bond with a child during the first 12 months after the child's birth, if the covered individual or the domestic partner or civil union partner of the covered individual, is a biological parent of the child, or the first 12 months after the placement of the child for adoption with the covered individual; or
2. Care for a family member with a serious health condition supported by a certification provided by a healthcare provider.

FLI benefits may be claimed on a continuous or non-continuous (intermittent) leave basis. Eligible employees may claim benefits for one continuous 12-week period, or on an intermittent schedule for 56 individual days (eight weeks) during a 12-month period beginning with the first date of the claim.

For purposes of this policy, "family member" includes a child; spouse; domestic partner; civil union partner; parent of a covered individual; siblings; grandparents; grandchildren; parents-in-law; any blood relative; and any individual that the employee shows to have a close association with the employee which is the equivalent of a family relationship.

"Child" means a biological, adopted or foster child; stepchild or legal ward of a covered individual; child of a domestic partner of the covered individual; or child of a civil union partner of the covered individual. FLI must be used concurrently with any leave taken under either the NJFLA or the FMLA.

Generally, employment covered under the New Jersey Unemployment Compensation Law, including state and local government employment, is also covered for Family Leave Insurance ("covered employment"). To be eligible for FLI benefits, employees must have earned a certain amount in New Jersey covered employment during their "base year."

Employees covered under the New Jersey State Plan can obtain information pertaining to the program and application for Family Leave Insurance benefits (Form FL-1) by visiting the Department of Labor and Workforce Development's website at www.nj.gov/labor.

This program is financed by employee contributions, which are deducted from employee wages for all employees covered under the New Jersey State Plan.

Receiving TDI or FLI benefit payments automatically entitles the worker to job restoration upon return to work (same or equivalent pay, seniority, and benefits).

INSURANCE PREMIUM PAYMENT DURING LEAVES OF ABSENCE

Blair Academy will continue to pay its share of insurance premiums for employees and their dependents while an employee is out on an approved leave of absence. Employees are responsible to

pay their portion of these insurance premiums on a bi-weekly basis. Failure to do so may result in loss of coverage for you and your dependents.

JURY DUTY

Full-time employees summoned for jury duty are paid the difference between their normal rate of pay and the jury duty pay for the full length of jury service.

Exempt employees may be provided time off with pay when necessary to comply with state and federal wage and hour laws.

Employees must provide Blair's Director of Finance with a copy of the court's payment records in order to be compensated.

Make arrangements with your supervisor as soon as you receive your summons.

We expect you to return to your job if you are excused from jury duty during your regular working hours.

MILITARY LEAVE

Employees who are required to fulfill military obligations in any branch of the Armed Forces of the United States or in state military service will be given the necessary time off and reinstated in accordance with federal and state law.

The time off will be unpaid, except where state law dictates otherwise. Exempt employees may be provided time off with pay when necessary to comply with federal and state wage and hour laws.

Accrued vacation may be used for this leave if the employee chooses. Military orders should be presented to the Director of Human Resources Operations and arrangements for leave made as early as possible before departure. Employees are required to give advance notice of their service obligations to the Business Office, unless military necessity makes this impossible. You must notify your supervisor of your intent to return to employment based on requirements of the law. Your benefits may continue to accrue during the period of leave in accordance with state and federal law.

Additional information regarding your military leaves may be obtained from the Business Office.

VII. PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT

The primary purposes of the performance improvement process are to correct problems, prevent recurrences, and help the employee to achieve satisfactory performance and conduct in the future. By utilizing various types of disciplinary responses, the School hopes that most employee challenges can be corrected at an early stage, benefiting both the employee and the School. As part of this process, it is essential that the employee accept personal responsibility for maintaining high standards of conduct and job performance, including observing the School's rules and policies.

In addressing deficiencies in conduct and work performance, the School strives to be fair and consistent with employees. Many factors are taken into consideration in implementing the performance improvement process, including the nature and seriousness of the challenge, the employee's past record, the impact on the School, and any mitigating or aggravating circumstances. In general, disciplinary action may include any or all of the following measures:

- Verbal warning(s)
- Written warning(s)
- Suspension with or without pay
- Termination of employment

The purpose of disciplinary measures short of termination of employment is corrective, to encourage the employee to improve the employee's conduct or performance. These disciplinary measures will not apply in the event of an offense that warrants immediate termination of employment, or in other circumstances when the School determines that intermediate measures would be inappropriate.

VIII. TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT

VOLUNTARY TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT

A voluntary termination of employment is a termination of employment initiated by the employee. A voluntary termination may occur:

- By written resignation;
- As a result of an absence from work for more than three consecutive work days without notifying the School; or
- As a result of an employee's failure to return to work at the expiration of an approved leave of absence or of any extension of such leave granted by the School.

Should you decide to leave your employment at Blair, we ask that staff provide their supervisor with at least two weeks advance notice. Blair faculty members generally receive their appointment letters from the Head of School in February and are required to return them before spring break. If you are considering not returning to Blair for the following academic year, we ask that you share your plans with the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School as soon as possible.

Your professionalism and understanding of the School's hiring needs are appreciated and will be noted favorably should you ever wish to re-apply for employment at Blair Academy. Out of consideration for your co-workers, you should give as much notice as possible. In some cases, the School may accept your resignation effective immediately or as of another date prior to the end of the notice period. Regardless of the length of notice given, all resigning employees should provide the School with a written notice of resignation.

INVOLUNTARY TERMINATION

An involuntary termination is any termination of employment initiated by the School. An involuntary termination may occur as a result of an employee's unsatisfactory job performance or misconduct, or it may result from other reasons or circumstances, such as a reduction in force, a personnel problem, or any other situation in which the School determines that termination of employment is appropriate.

Employees who are rehired following a break in service other than an approved leave of absence must serve a new initial introductory period, whether or not such a period was previously completed. Such employees are considered new employees from the effective date of their reemployment for all purposes, including the purposes of measuring benefits.

RETURN OF SCHOOL PROPERTY

Employees are responsible for all the School's property, materials, and written or electronic information (including but not limited to student record information) issued to them or in their possession or control. All School property must be returned in satisfactory condition immediately upon request or upon termination. Employees may not retain copies of such property, materials or written or electronic information. Otherwise, Blair Academy must take further action to recoup any replacement costs and/or seek the return of Blair property through appropriate legal recourse to the extent permitted by applicable law.

EXIT INTERVIEW & FINAL PAY

The Dean of Faculty Life and Director of Human Resources Operations may schedule exit interviews with departing employees. During the exit interview, they will inform the employee of any benefits that they may be eligible to continue. Suggestions, complaints and questions may also be voiced during the exit interview.

In the case of an involuntary termination of employment, final pay will be provided to the employee in accordance with applicable law. In the case of a voluntary termination of employment, the employee's final paycheck will usually be issued on the next regular payday or as otherwise required by applicable law.

The last paycheck earned by employees during their tenure at Blair will include: (i) payment for hours worked since your last payday; and (ii) payment for accrued and earned PTO. Final pay will be reduced by: (i) required legal deductions, such as Social Security payments and state and federal income taxes; (ii) authorized deductions, such as those for coverage under the group health and dental insurance plans; (iii) any overpayment of wages due and reimbursable to the School as a result of advance pay; and (iv) any other amounts authorized by you or permitted by applicable law.

APPENDIX A: FACULTY GUIDELINES

This section of the *Employee Handbook* outlines faculty policies, procedures and guidelines designed to support a safe educational environment for our community. Living and working in a boarding school community requires a higher sensitivity to our behavior. How we conduct ourselves impacts the lives of our students, our parent and alumni communities, one another's lives and simply Blair itself as a respected and historically prominent institution. This *Handbook* cannot articulate or address every situation that might occur or might have a negative and unacceptable impact upon one or more of the constituencies of the Blair community. That said, should a situation arise in which a faculty member's conduct harms one of the various communities that make up this School or in any way threatens the positive reputation of Blair, then an appropriate response will necessarily follow, up to and including termination of employment. Please direct any questions regarding this section to the Dean of Faculty Life or the Head of School.

CLASS COVERAGE

In the event that a faculty member is required to cover an absent faculty member's classes for more than four consecutive days, the substituting faculty member will be compensated at a rate of \$85 per class covered, starting with the fifth day, retroactive to the first day of class coverage. The department head shall report all such coverage to the Director of Human Resources Operations in a timely manner so payment can be made. Only current Blair faculty may substitute for other faculty who need to be absent.

FULL-TIME & FLEXIBLE WORK GUIDELINES

Blair Academy strives to retain and support high-quality faculty, and we acknowledge that the traditional, triple-threat boarding school model has evolved over the years. Those who continue to teach four classes, coach two interscholastic sports/direct three plays, and work/live in our dormitories are invaluable members of the faculty whose work is essential to the smooth and successful running of the School. That said, professional responsibility falls along a wide spectrum, and it is the goal of the following guidelines to lay a common and equitable foundation upon which responsibilities and compensation can be decided—while also acknowledging this balance as we aim to support a diverse and talented faculty. The School will review requests for flexible work arrangements on a case-by-case basis and in keeping with the needs of the School.

The framework for full-time and flexible-work arrangements at Blair Academy informs decisions that are ultimately approved on a case-by-case basis and at the discretion of the Head of School and Dean of Faculty Life.

Full-Time (FT) Work Arrangements:

1. The foundation of a full-time load of a teaching faculty member is four classes, two or three seasons (interscholastic/theater/video) and dorm. While some administrative faculty members teach, they largely have additional responsibilities in their area of expertise. All faculty members are expected to have advisees.
2. Other full-time substitutions *may* include a combination of teaching five classes, coaching one season of a sport and doing dorm duty; others teach three, coach three and do dorm duty.
3. While dorm duty differs greatly for those living in the dorm versus those living in other campus housing, dorm heads and assistant dorm heads receive a dorm stipend in

acknowledgement of this difference.

4. Faculty overseeing afternoon activities—as opposed to theater/video or competitive sports—may be asked to do so for three seasons.
5. When possible, the School will make efforts to accommodate full-time couples' teaching and coaching schedules (e.g., alternate athletic assignments when possible). However, our ability to craft complementary/flexible schedules is limited at best and must align with the needs of the community.

CELL PHONE USE

Faculty should be sensitive to the expectation that students' use of cell or smartphones is restricted. In an effort to keep active cell phone use out of the public areas of School, faculty should seek to adhere to that expectation as well in accordance with the School's policy on the use of cellular telephones and other communication devices. Further, while all of us have and use cell phones, we should remember that parents will try to contact us on our School and mobile lines (or the number that is published in the online Blair faculty/staff directory) and that we should maintain active management of our published numbers and voicemails. Contact numbers can be changed by submitting a profile update via the faculty/staff portal on [Blair's website](#).

ATTENDANCE EXPECTATIONS & OVERSIGHT

Members of the faculty are required to attend School Meetings and Chapels. While there may at times be unavoidable professional conflicts, these should be the exception, and the Dean of Faculty Life or Assistant Head of School for Academics should be notified when they occur. Those who are on evening and weekend duty in the dormitories are expected to abide by the expectations communicated annually by the Student Life Office. In general and when not required, supporting students and colleagues at athletic events, performances and fine arts events, and lectures is strongly encouraged.

Faculty members are expected to take an active role in overseeing the Romano Dining Hall. Family-style dinners require faculty supervision, and faculty members sharing responsibility for a table should ensure that the table is always covered. At buffet meals, we need to be vigilant and aware of student behavior and our surrounding environment. When necessary, faculty members are required to take action to encourage appropriate behavior and confront inappropriate behavior.

Members of the faculty are encouraged to take advantage of opportunities to be away from campus. For the most part, however, faculty should be accessible as needed, even when they are not specifically on dormitory, study hall or dining hall duty. Dormitory faculty should be sure that their associates in the dorm are aware of their plans if they intend to be away overnight or for a weekend.

The requirement for activity/athletic coverage can vary according to individual circumstances, but, generally speaking, full-time faculty members who do not coach an interscholastic sport or the equivalent are expected to fulfill up to three terms/seasons of afternoon activity coverage.

ABIDING BY SCHOOL CALENDAR

Faculty members have significant personal time during the year; in most cases, teaching faculty enjoy school breaks for at least a third of the calendar year. Therefore, faculty members have the responsibility of familiarizing themselves with the annual school calendar (maintained by the Academic and Faculty Life Offices) and are expected to plan any personal trips, personal business, elective medical procedures and vacation departures around professional expectations. Generally,

missing classes, faculty meetings or other School obligations to facilitate personal plans should be avoided and, in any case, requires timely communication with and permission from your department head and Dean of Faculty Life.

While there will occasionally be significant family or religious obligations, which rightly take priority over our professional lives, in general, we should work around School expectations. While generally showing up for campus events to support students and colleagues in their varying endeavors is very strongly encouraged at Blair, below is a list of School obligations, which are subject to change, that require mandatory attendance for all full- or adjunct faculty.

- August 27: Opening faculty/staff meeting begins at 8:30 a.m.
- August 27: Opening-of-school dinner starts at 6 p.m.
- August 27, 28, & 31: Faculty meetings from 8:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m.
- September 2: Pre-season registration (faculty not helping with registration report to the dorm to greet students & help with move-in)
- September 7: Final registration from 8:30 a.m.-1 p.m. & orientation from 1 p.m.-8 p.m.
- September 11: Convocation opens Blair's 179th academic year at 7:30 p.m.
- September 12-13: Community (closed) weekend
- September 19-20: Community (closed) weekend
- October 12, 14 & 17: Faculty meetings; Monday from 6:30 p.m.-8:30 p.m., Wednesday & Saturday from 8:30 a.m.-noon
- October 22-24: Family Weekend
- November 7: Peddie Day (at Peddie)
- November 20: Faculty may depart once advisor letters are approved and submitted; dorms may require coverage until Saturday morning due to student flight arrangements.
- November 29: Faculty return to campus following Thanksgiving break by 7 p.m.
- December 11: Christmas Vespers (4:30 p.m. or 7 p.m.) or Winter Gathering (6 p.m.)
- December 17-18: Faculty meetings (December 17 from 2-4 p.m., December 18 from 1-3 p.m.)
- December 19: Faculty meetings from 8:30 a.m.-4 p.m.
- January 4: Faculty in-service from 8:30 a.m.-4 p.m.
- January 29: Faculty may depart for long winter weekend at 12 p.m. (with the exception of some winter coaches & dorm staff members)
- February 3: Faculty return from long winter weekend by 7 p.m.
- March 1-March 4: Faculty meetings from 8:30 a.m.-9:30 a.m.
- March 5: Faculty meetings from 8:30 a.m.-4 p.m.
- March 22: Faculty return to campus following spring break by 7 p.m.
- TBD: Admission Revisit Days
- May 14: Day of Service
- May 19: Class of 2027 Assembly at 5 p.m.
- May 20: Commencement at 11 a.m. & attendant activities
- May 25: Underclass Prize Assembly at 5 p.m.
- May 31- June 2: Department/faculty meetings
- June 4-6: Faculty (who have worked at Blair for five or more years) attend Alumni Weekend

Please direct questions to the Dean of Faculty Life, Assistant Head of School for Academics or Associate Head of School. Faculty members must understand that only the most compelling conflicts will be considered a reason for exception. Finally, the December faculty-staff holiday, March spring break party and June end-of-year parties are not absolutely required, but full faculty attendance is strongly encouraged.

TERM-END EXPECTATIONS

At the end of each term, faculty members are expected to fulfill all meeting and report obligations (i.e., grades, comments and letters) before leaving campus. Faculty who disregard attendance or reporting expectations may face employment consequences.

CDL REQUIREMENT

Full-time faculty are required to obtain a New Jersey Commercial Driver's License (CDL) with the support of the School. Blair will pay all fees and will provide test prep support and training. In order to drive students in the School's buses, you must have a valid CDL (and exceptions to obtaining a CDL can only be made by the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School). A CDL requires regular physicals and periodic random drug/alcohol testing. A faculty member who fails this test will lose their CDL validation and may be subject to professional consequences as a result. In addition, failure to obtain a CDL within the designated timeframe will result in the assignment of additional responsibilities within the weekend activities duty schedule or during your off season supporting the Health Center with afternoon driving and/or conducting afternoon rounds throughout campus.

Faculty are required to begin the process of obtaining their CDL in their third year of employment and should have a plan in place for doing so by the end of their second year of employment. Individual plans should be reviewed with the Dean of Faculty Life.

Failure to achieve your CDL by the end of January during your third year of employment will require you to meet with the Head of School and Dean of Faculty Life prior to reappointment to document a plan to obtain your CDL by September of that year.

PLEASE BE AWARE THAT, WHILE ADULT CANNABIS USE HAS BEEN LEGALIZED IN NEW JERSEY, CDL REGULATIONS ARE BASED ON FEDERAL LAW AND CANNABIS IS CLASSIFIED AS A SCHEDULE I DRUG ON THE FEDERAL LEVEL. THEREFORE, SHOULD A FACULTY MEMBER TEST POSITIVE FOR CANNABIS, THEY MAY LOSE THEIR CDL ENDORSEMENT, WHICH MAY SUBJECT THE FACULTY MEMBER TO DISCIPLINE FROM BLAIR DUE TO THEIR INABILITY TO PROVIDE TRANSPORTATION SERVICES AS EXPECTED AS PART OF THEIR EMPLOYMENT AND CONTINUED EMPLOYMENT WITH THE SCHOOL.

FACULTY CHILDREN

Faculty children are a wonderful part of the School community. Nevertheless, their presence should not disrupt classes or School functions. In general, faculty should avoid childcare conflicts that impact classes, school offices or athletic responsibilities, though the School strives to be understanding and flexible.

Caregivers who are from outside of the Blair community should be made aware of daily expectations when they are on campus. Those caregivers who will be caring for faculty children living in a dormitory need to submit to a background check.

RELATIONS WITH & GIFTS FROM PARENTS

Blair encourages good, open relations with all of the School's constituencies, including students, parents, families, alumni and Trustees, and understands interactions can be social and not directly related to work. When parents want to take faculty out to dinner, to a show or an event or play golf/tennis, there is no inherent conflict with such activity. In fact, such involvement could strengthen these individuals' partnership with the School. However, if a particular related child/children is/are struggling socially or academically, particularly if the issues may lead to a severance from Blair, faculty should be sensitive about socializing with parents to avoid the perception of such activities leading to the expectation of advocacy. As you will read often in this section of the *Handbook*, faculty members are encouraged to seek advice from the Dean of Faculty Life or other administrators if there is any question regarding such social relations.

Along similar lines, gifts to faculty from parents, while thoughtful and well-intentioned, can create problems. Gifts can be defined as any financially significant object, opportunity (i.e., a meal, trip, tickets, etc.) or service that is offered (*note that there is a difference between a parent or alum hosting a faculty member for dinner or an activity, and those same individuals giving a faculty member that opportunity without the parent being part of the activity*).

Gift-giving has long been part of faculty relations with all Blair constituencies, but, at times, in boarding schools with residential oversight issues, parents are inclined to be even more generous and supportive than elsewhere. Moreover, the international diversity of our community includes varied cultural norms of giving and receiving gifts. There are two overriding rules in this admittedly confusing area: No gift should be accepted if the faculty member feels that the purpose behind the gift is inappropriate; and any uncertainty about a gift should lead to a discussion with the Dean of Faculty Life, both to clarify the issues at hand and to protect the faculty member and School should questions arise at a later date.

Below are some guidelines to help faculty members sort out the issues associated with gift-giving:

- **Gifts of nominal monetary value** (generally \$300 or less), particularly related to holidays or end-of-the-year, may be accepted without concern or the expectation of a discussion with the Dean of Faculty Life. These include gift certificates for restaurants and events.
- **Gifts of clearly significant monetary value** (watches, jewelry, accessories, clothing, electronics, etc.) should either be rejected outright or should involve a discussion with the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School. If the value is unclear, as with a piece of art or cultural decoration more common from international families, a faculty member may want advice, but such gifts are generally less problematic than other consumer goods.
- **Services from professional parents** almost always need clearance from the School, as the conflict-of-interest issues are significant. That said, sometimes a faculty member will see a professional and find out later that a "professional courtesy" of no or minimal charge has been extended. In such cases, a report to the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School is urged to guard against future problems.

- Finally, **under no circumstances is cash an acceptable gift to faculty.** While it can be argued that a gift certificate of \$300 is not substantially different from three \$100 bills, the appearances and inherent implications of accepting cash undermines us as professionals. Cash gifts that cannot be returned for logistical or social reasons should be turned over to the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School and will be given to the Blair Fund with an explanatory note of both gratitude and explanation.

Again, any act of support from a School constituency to an individual faculty member that does not fall under or is not clarified by the preceding guidelines should be brought to the Dean of Faculty Life or Head of School for consideration. Failure to have such a discussion could have serious consequences.

ADDITIONAL BENEFITS FOR FACULTY

Professional Development

Blair faculty are encouraged to develop their skills as professionals in their area of expertise. The School has a variety of endowed funds to support these pursuits, and faculty interested in learning more about varying options should speak directly with the Dean of Pedagogy & Innovation. Annual conversations with one's department head regarding professional goals and development are an expectation.

Funding has been used for years to support various faculty projects and individual professional goals both during the school year and in the summer. While all requests may not be supported in full, the School does make every effort to support faculty professional development requests in substantial ways. Certainly, there is a set of priorities, related to work that directly supports classroom instruction. Requests for funding for professional events (workshops, visits to other schools and the like) should be presented first to the Dean of Pedagogy & Innovation, while also communicated to your department head.

Faculty Enrichment

Income generated from endowed funds are available for faculty study grants, travel or other forms of professional development. Proposals are to be submitted via the professional development application in the [faculty-staff portal](#) of the Blair website.

The Tedlow Fellowship is awarded annually to a faculty member for personal and professional enhancement and growth.

The John C. & Eve S. Bogle Chair for Excellence in Teaching was established in 1993 by John C. Bogle '47. This award is presented annually to a senior faculty member who exemplifies the blend of enthusiasm for the classroom, subject knowledge, commitment to excellence and compassion for students.

Mr. and Mrs. Mahlon Apgar IV '58 established the Apgar Award for Teaching Excellence in 1993. This award is presented annually to a faculty member who has recently started a career in teaching and has had a demonstrable impact on students.

Robert and Letizia Riether established the Riether Residential Life Prize in 1997. This award is

presented annually to a faculty member who, among many responsibilities, has made significant contributions to residential life in the role of dorm head or assistant dorm head.

Mr. William S. Risley '63 established the James M. Howard Jr. Fellowship Prize in 2002. This award is given to a new faculty member who has made a special distinction and impact at Blair Academy in any one particular year.

The Geller family established the Geller Family Fund for Faculty Enrichment in 2008. This award is presented annually to one or more faculty members who have shown significant personal commitment to their students, both in and out of the classroom.

Mr. Herbert J. Siegel '46 established The Head's Prize for Faculty in 2018. This award is presented annually to a faculty member who has demonstrated the utmost excellence in classroom teaching, including a clear commitment to innovative and effective teaching practices that make a difference in students' learning and lives.

The Herbert J. Siegel Faculty Equity Plan

Herbert J. Siegel '46 established the Siegel Faculty Equity Plan in 1993 with a gift to the Blair Academy Endowment Fund. The purpose of the plan is to benefit faculty members who have been full-time employees of the School for 10 years or more. The benefit is given to the employee as a partial replacement for equity employees might have realized if they owned their own homes instead of living in Blair Academy housing. This is also a reward for past service and an additional incentive to help retain senior faculty members. Adjunct faculty who work fewer than 1,000 hours annually aren't eligible for the Siegel Equity Plan. Certain members of the senior administrative team may also not be eligible for this benefit. This will be communicated to those individuals directly.

The amount of the annual benefit is determined by applying a rate (between 5 percent and 7 percent) times the annual salary. The starting rate of 5 percent is applied during the 11th year of service. The rate is increased by .5 percent each of the next four years and remains at 7 percent thereafter. The Board of Trustees reserves the right to amend or eliminate this additional benefit, if deemed necessary.

Advanced Degree Program

Blair Academy offers an advanced degree program that must be used for graduate work culminating in a graduate degree. Applications for any other type of program will be handled on an ad hoc basis. All faculty members who have completed a minimum total of four years of consecutive, full-time employment at the School are eligible to apply. Any faculty member wishing to apply for the advanced degree program must do so by November 1 of the year preceding the beginning of the proposed degree program; at the earliest, the application may be made during the fourth year of employment at Blair.

To officially apply, a faculty member must craft a letter outlining the specifics of the degree program (timeline, cost, degree earned) and one's rationale for pursuing the degree. The letter must be submitted simultaneously to the Head of School, Chief Financial & Operations Officer and Dean of Faculty Life.

Faculty who continue to work full-time at Blair Academy while completing an advanced degree will continue to receive their current salary. The School will contribute to the cost of tuition, up to an

amount equal to their current salary. All applicants will be required to apply for financial aid at the institution to which they are applying.

Faculty who do not perform their current full-time job duties on campus while pursuing an advanced degree will not receive compensation from the School. Blair will contribute to the cost of tuition, up to an amount equal to the employee's current salary. Again, all applicants will be required to apply for financial aid at the institution to which they are applying.

Faculty who receive funding for an advanced degree will be required to remain employed at Blair for the two years following the granting of the pursued degree; those who request and are granted a contribution larger than their current salary from the School will owe an additional year for each \$10,000 (up to \$20,000) spent by the School.

Faculty members will be granted advanced degree funding as determined by the Head of School, Chief Financial & Operations Officer and the Dean of Faculty Life. Priority will be given to faculty members who have not yet earned an advanced degree.

There is no guarantee that funding will be granted, and the School's ability to fund such endeavors will be reviewed annually and be based on available funds in the current budget. In the event when more than one faculty member applies for the advanced degree program, a number of factors will be considered, including, but not limited to, seniority and applicability of the graduate degree toward one's professional responsibilities at Blair.

The offer of funding may be withdrawn based on faculty performance either in the application year or during the program year itself. Faculty may abandon the pursuit of the advanced degree at any time up to the arrangement by the School. Faculty who abandon the advanced degree program after it has commenced may be liable for the School's contribution and costs.

'All In' Faculty Recognition Plan

All Blair Academy faculty members who work a minimum of 1,000 hours annually (excluding the Head of School and other highly paid administrators) will receive an award based on the completion of a set number of years of full-time service (with a full year being considered July 1 to June 30 annually) as follows:

- Three years: \$5,000
- Five years: \$5,000
- Seven years: \$7,000
- 10 years & every subsequent five years: \$10,000

This *All In* Recognition Plan complements other programs and benefits offered to faculty including, but not limited to the Herbert J. Siegel Faculty Equity Plan, tuition remission, retirement contributions, Sigety Faculty Summer Institute and advanced degree funding. Payment will occur in November via payroll; faculty members receiving this award must be employed at the time of payment. The *All In* recognition plan is subject to the annual approval of the Blair Academy Board of Trustees.

Transitional Discretionary Retirement Gift

Purpose & Intent:

Blair historically has recognized that faculty retention is an important part of the School's overall student-centered focus and success. As such, Blair had maintained an unwritten practice of gifting faculty members who have served the School for a minimum of 15 years and who retired in good standing, a "retirement gift" in the form of a payment totaling \$1,000 per year of their employment, in recognition of their commitment to Blair and its community.

The *All In* Recognition Plan has supplanted the above-referenced unwritten practice of \$1,000/year upon retirement. But, there may currently be a gap in the accrual rates and payouts to some faculty members, who have served for years prior to the implementation of the *All In* Recognition Plan but, because of the prospective application of the *All In* Recognition Plan, could stand to receive less than a faculty member who has been at Blair for a shorter time but who has enjoyed the benefit of the *All In* Recognition Plan's larger accrual rates.

Thus, the purpose of these guidelines is to bridge the gap between the *All In* Recognition Plan and the former unwritten practice such that long-tenured faculty members who are retiring in good standing from Blair may receive a retirement gift. This gift would be added to what they have already received under the *All In* Recognition Plan over the entirety of their career and total an amount not less than what they might have received as a retirement gift before the *All In* Recognition Plan was established.

Guidelines:

Blair will pay those faculty members the difference between what they have already been awarded by the *All In* Faculty Recognition Plan since its inception and what they would have received in total if paid per \$1,000 per year of service at the point of retirement. Once the *All In* Plan total payouts have exceeded the years of service amount an employee would receive, no such additional retirement payout would take place.

For clarity's sake, to receive this additional discretionary retirement gift, faculty must have worked at Blair for a minimum of 15 years and must be retiring in good standing, not leaving Blair for another professional opportunity. This will apply only to full-time faculty members, not adjunct faculty who work fewer than 1,000 hours a year annually (and excludes the Head of School and other highly paid administrators). The Head of School will inform you if you qualify for it, which will occur in the last pay cycle of the fiscal year in June via payroll; faculty members receiving this must be employed at the time of payment. This discretionary retirement gift is not a vested gift and is subject to the annual approval of the Head of School and Blair Academy Board of Trustees.

APPENDIX B: HOUSING GUIDELINES

These Housing Guidelines (the “Housing Guidelines”) are designed to acquaint individuals residing on campus with rules governing the housing provided by Blair Academy (“Blair” or the “School”). The School owns and leases property in which it may house employees on a short-term or long-term basis in accordance with need and availability. Individuals wishing to reside in housing provided by the School (“School Housing”) and/or who are required to reside in School Housing as a condition of employment, are required to comply with the provisions set forth in these Housing Guidelines.

These Housing Guidelines apply to all individuals residing in School Housing (“Residents”). The information in the Housing Guidelines is only an overview of the School’s policies and practices, which the School may modify at any time. In addition, the School may modify the policies summarized here when it determines that particular circumstances warrant individualized consideration.

School Housing is a privilege afforded to certain employees, not a contractual right, and is contingent upon current and continued employment with the School. The policies and practices summarized in the Housing Guidelines have been adopted voluntarily by the School and do not provide Residents with any contractual rights.

The School values its employees and looks forward to continuing mutually satisfactory employment relationships. Nevertheless, it should be recognized that neither these Housing Guidelines nor any other associated housing documents constitute a contract of employment for a specific term, and that, unless otherwise provided in an express contract signed by an authorized representative of the School, the employment relationship between the School and an employee remains “at-will.” That is, either the employee or the School may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without notice, for any reason or no reason.

The School may make housing changes in an effort to ensure that all needs of the School are met. Blair strives to accommodate the needs of employees with minimal disruption, but, in some circumstances, school needs may require Residents to relocate. These Housing Guidelines generally summarize expectations for living on campus and are intended to supplement and not supersede other information in the School’s *Employee Handbook*.

I. GENERAL HOUSING POLICIES

Fair Housing

The School is committed to a policy of non-discrimination for all individuals seeking School Housing, without regard to race, creed, color, national origin, ancestry, nationality, marital or domestic partnership or civil union status, sex, gender identity or expression, disability, affectional or sexual orientation, family status, or any other status protected by applicable law.

This commitment is evident in all aspects of the School's employment practices, including its provision of School Housing.

School Housing

Blair Academy and its Trustees provide School Housing for full-time teaching and administrative faculty and their immediate families. Whether you reside in an on-campus dorm apartment, free-standing home or duplex, Blair faculty must be present and available to supervise students, as well as willing to open their homes to students and guests of the School. Given that supervising and mentoring students is one of the most important professional responsibilities within a boarding school, the general expectation of full-time faculty members is that they will spend a significant period of their career living in dormitory or campus housing (which Blair considers any housing owned by the School, even if not located on campus).

School Housing Assignments

School Housing is assigned to certain employees at the sole discretion of the Head of School upon hire and throughout employment at Blair with the goal of allowing the School to function most effectively; changes cannot be made without Head of School approval.

The School's decisions about School Housing assignments are based on a variety of factors by the Head of School in consultation with other administrators. Because School Housing serves the residential and administrative needs of the School, paramount among those factors will be the employee's job responsibilities pertaining to the School's residential program (i.e., supervision and services in support of student residential life), as well as the availability of School Housing units.

Blair expects all faculty to live in a dorm at some point in their tenure at the School, with new faculty being placed in dorms initially whenever possible. Should a dorm apartment not be available at the time of hire, Blair makes it clear to new faculty that they may be asked to relocate to a dorm to meet the needs of the School at any time. When possible, Blair does its best to accommodate faculty requests for changes to housing, which are submitted via Google Form to the Head of School annually in January. Housing decisions are generally made after considering tenure and role at Blair, family size and needs of the School.

In some cases, full-time faculty members have the option of providing their own housing, as long as it is within reasonable proximity of the School and does not limit their professional responsibilities. However, once a faculty member leaves School Housing or never begins in School Housing, there is no guarantee that future housing will be available, regardless of the faculty member's status.

Faculty should expect to know where they will be living the following school year by the end of the previous school year (in many cases, earlier), but, generally, assignments cannot be completed until hiring is finished. Faculty members will annually be given the opportunity to make housing requests

through the Head of School Office, and requests will be considered primarily on the basis of School need.

Faculty may be required to move or change housing—within a reasonable time frame—as community housing needs and family size/dependency evolve. Generally, if a faculty member's children are in college or no longer living at home, they may be required to move to avail a larger residence to a faculty family with younger children, although we will try not to move families while their children are still in college. Further, such housing changes will be made, not based on seniority, but rather on the basis of suitability (overall size, number of bedrooms, location, ability to house school guests, etc.). The School makes every effort to inform faculty who might be asked to move early in the school year, so that appropriate planning can take place.

In the event that an employee is placed on leave or takes a leave of absence from employment for an extended period (including sabbatical), the School may reassign the School Housing unit to ensure adequate coverage and to meet the School's needs.

Housing Agreements

All Residents must enter into a Housing Agreement with the School at the start of each school year and submit an updated agreement if pets or co-inhabitants are added to the residence. Among other things, the Housing Agreement specifies any cohabitants residing with the Resident ("Cohabitants"), as well as pets, and the Resident's acknowledgement of the Resident's understanding of, and agreement to, the School's housing policies, as outlined in these Housing Guidelines. Housing agreements are signed annually by faculty living on campus along with acknowledgement of the *Employee Handbook's* policies.

Renter's Insurance

All Blair employees who live in school-owned housing must obtain a renter's insurance policy.

Expectations for Occupancy

Only the Resident and the Cohabitants identified in the Housing Agreement may occupy School Housing. Cohabitants may include an employee's immediate family members, which for purposes of this policy, is defined to include the employee's spouse, domestic partner and dependent children. The School considers "dependent children" to include the employee's biological, adopted or foster child, or stepchild who is either (i) under 18 years of age or (ii) 18 years of age and older if the child is (a) a full-time student; or (b) mentally or physically disabled and incapable of independent living. If a faculty member has a request for a non-dependent child to live in campus housing for some specified period, they may request an exception be made by the Head of School.

No other individuals are allowed to occupy School Housing for an extended period of time without advance approval by the Head of School. Blair defines an extended period of time as seven or more consecutive days. Permission to have someone occupy housing in addition to the assigned Resident and their immediate family must be approved by the Head of School.

All adult members of the School community who live in School-owned housing, including Residents and Cohabitants, will be subject to criminal background checks, which may include fingerprint-based checks, criminal record offender information checks and sex offender registry information checks, and must provide all information reasonably necessary to permit the School to conduct such

background checks. This includes partners, spouses and adult children over the age of 18 living permanently in the campus residence.

The School expects that all Residents and Cohabitants will work together and assist the School in its efforts to maintain a safe community for everyone. Residents must ensure that all individuals residing in or visiting School Housing comply with all of the School's rules and policies. Failure to ensure compliance with the rules and regulations outlined in these Housing Guidelines and the Housing Agreement may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment and/or the School Housing privilege, as applicable.

Fixtures & Furnishings

Fixtures, appliances and furnishings and other School property in School Housing must not be removed without approval from the Director of Facilities.

Shades, Blinds & Shutters

The School provides shades, blinds or shutters in dormitory apartments; curtains are the responsibility of the occupant. The School does not supply window treatments for non-dormitory residences. The School supplies screens on all windows and some doors and residents are responsible for keeping the screens in good repair.

Exterior Structures

Exterior structures such as swing sets and fences may not be erected without prior approval from the Director of Facilities. Those who wish to have a trampoline outside of their residence on School property must ensure that their required renter's insurance policy provides trampoline coverage.

Garages

Some housing units include garage space. Residents may not install garage door openers without written permission from the Facilities Department. When residents vacate the unit, the garage door opener and any related parts/instructions must be given to the Facilities Department to be passed on to the next resident.

Personal Property

The School assumes no responsibility for the personal property of Residents or Cohabitants. The School does not provide Residents with insurance to protect against theft or damage to furniture or personal items. All Residents are required to have renter's insurance and may obtain additional personal property and liability insurance to cover the loss of property due to events such as fire, theft, flooding or vandalism.

Utilities & Services

For those living in dorms, Internet access is provided at no cost to the Resident; those living in freestanding campus homes must arrange for the installation of wi-fi at their own expense. All residents are responsible for setting up and paying for their own cable, if they are interested.

If the Residents would like to add specific units, including satellite dishes, prior written approval must be granted by the Business Office.

Heating & Air Conditioning

The School will maintain heating and centrally installed air conditioning units. The School will also provide periodic chimney cleaning and repairs. Electric space heaters are not allowed.

Access by Blair to School Housing

The School may enter School Housing with notice afforded prior to or at the time of entry. Such access may occur for a variety of reasons, including, but not limited to, making inspections, providing necessary services, allowing access to insurance adjusters, outside contractors, and showing the School Housing to prospective residents. The School also has the right to enter School Housing without prior notice if the School determines that such access is necessary or appropriate.

Cessation of Occupancy

The anticipated term of each Resident's occupancy of School Housing is set forth in the applicable Housing Agreement. At the end of the term of the Housing Agreement, the Resident must surrender the premises and all furnishings and appliances to the School in a neat, clean and orderly condition. The Resident must remove any and all personal property from School Housing. In the event that a Resident fails to remove personal property from School Housing, the Resident acknowledges and agrees that the School may remove it or cause it to be removed at the Resident's expense. Residents will be responsible for any damage caused to School Housing as a result of neglect, misuse or willful damage.

Campus Moves

Employees are responsible for moving their belongings to newly assigned housing on campus. While personal schedules are taken into account, all moves are at the convenience of the School. Faculty residents work closely with the Director of Facilities to plan any necessary preparatory work and to coordinate moving dates. The School will generally clean carpeting in housing units between occupants.

The Director of Facilities will inspect the unit to ensure that the residence is appropriately and adequately cleaned. Residents may be asked to clean further if necessary. These inspections must be scheduled prior to your scheduled departure date. The School reserves the right to charge the employee resident for any cleaning or repairs (beyond normal wear and tear) to the unit if it is not left in good condition. Residents are expected to leave their units in good repair with only normal wear and tear.

Cessation of Employment

Occupancy of School Housing is contingent upon the Resident's continued employment with the School. If employment ceases during the academic year, the Resident must leave School Housing within one week following the termination of the Resident's employment for any reason, unless the Resident's occupancy is otherwise extended with written approval from the Head of School. Blair employees are generally expected to vacate School housing by June 30.

Assignability/Subletting

Residents are not permitted to assign, sublet, rent or "house-swap" School Housing (including through "Airbnb," "VRBO" or similar services).

Locks & Keys

The School will maintain all locks in School Housing. Residents may not change, replace or add any new lock to School Housing. When a Resident moves out of School Housing, that Resident must return all keys to the School. To maintain security and privacy, keys may not be copied by Residents under any circumstances. If a Resident misplaces a key or needs additional keys, the Resident should immediately contact the Director of Facilities.

Vehicles & Parking

Residents will be issued reserved parking spaces for each residential unit. Residents may park an additional vehicle in a non-resident parking spot. Any Resident who will be away for a period of time during school breaks must inform the Director of Facilities of where they can find the car keys in case a vehicle needs to be moved.

Extended Time Away

Residents who will be away from campus should notify Blair security of the length of their absence and provide emergency contact information. Employees should make reasonable efforts to safeguard the residence from electrical fire hazards and/or plumbing leaks. Any concerns should be reported to security in advance of your departure.

During the winter months, residents who have the ability should turn their thermostats back or down. Thermostats should not be set below 50 degrees when away from campus. During the summer months, residents should turn off their air conditioners when away from campus. In the event that a pet is being left behind, please adjust the temperature accordingly to conserve energy.

II. THE SCHOOL HOUSING ENVIRONMENT

School Housing Conduct

The School expects all Residents to adhere to all policies in the *Employee Handbook* and standards of conduct that will protect the interests and safety of the School, its employees, its students, the School community and other Residents. All Residents are expected to be a positive reflection of the School by being courteous to other Residents, students and visitors and by complying with the Housing Guidelines, the School's other policies and practices, and federal, state and local laws.

If a Resident is removed from School Housing, as determined by the School based on violations of this or of any other School policies or rules, that Resident may be subject to additional disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Drug-Free Environment

Drug activity while in School Housing or on other School property threatens the entire School environment and will not be tolerated. Residents must not manufacture, distribute, dispense, possess, sell, purchase or use a controlled substance (including marijuana) anywhere in School Housing or on other School property.

Residents are further prohibited from being present in School Housing while under the influence of any illegal controlled substance. An illegal controlled substance is any drug that is unlawful under federal, state or local law, as well as any drug that, although available legally, has been obtained illegally.

This policy applies to every Resident and Cohabitant. If a Resident or Cohabitant violates this policy, the Resident and/or the Cohabitant(s) may be immediately barred from School Housing and the employee may be subject to additional disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Visitors/Overnight Guests

Residents may not have overnight guests in School Housing for a period of time longer than seven consecutive days without the prior written approval of the Head of School.

Any adult who will be staying on campus in School Housing for longer than seven consecutive days must undergo criminal background checks and any additional background checks as determined by the School at their own expense. Such individuals are required to provide all information reasonably necessary to permit the School to conduct such background checks.

Sexual & Other Harassment

The School prohibits all discrimination and harassment based on a person's protected class in School Housing and on School property in accordance with the policies contained in the School's *Employee Handbook*.

Anyone who experiences or witnesses sexual or other unlawful harassment in School Housing or otherwise on School property, is encouraged to report it to the Director of Human Resources Operations, Associate Head of School or other member of the administrative team. Any administrator receiving such a report is required to notify the Director of Human Resources Operations. Residents should not allow an inappropriate situation to continue by not reporting it.

Any Resident who is found to have harassed another Resident or Cohabitant, or to have retaliated against another Resident or Cohabitant for complaining of harassment, may be immediately barred from School Housing. The School will also take appropriate corrective action to address harassment by non-Residents.

The School recognizes that false accusations, especially of sexual harassment, may have serious effects on innocent persons. Residents found to have knowingly made false accusations of sexual harassment may be immediately barred from School Housing.

Violence Prevention

Acts or threats of physical violence, including intimidation, harassment and/or coercion, will not be tolerated in School Housing or elsewhere on School property. The School's prohibition against threats and acts of violence applies to all persons on School property, including, but not limited to, Residents, Cohabitants, visitors, and anyone else in School Housing or otherwise on School property. Residents who violate this policy may be immediately barred from School Housing and may be subject to other disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

The School will make the determination of whether, and to what extent, threats or acts of violence in School Housing will be acted upon by the School.

Residents should report any acts or threats of violence, including intimidation, harassment and/or coercion which involve or affect School Housing, or which occur in School Housing, to the Head of School or Associate Head of School.

Weapons & Dangerous Materials

Per Blair's *Employee Handbook*, Blair prohibits employees from having weapons on campus without approval from the Head of School.

Employees shall not keep, or have on School Housing property, any article or object of a dangerous, inflammable or explosive character that might increase the risk of fire on School Housing property.

Space heaters are not allowed on campus, unless approved by the Director of Facilities in writing.

Outdoor grill supplies such as charcoal, starter fluid or propane must be properly stored. Propane tanks must be kept at least three feet away from any building. Gas and/or charcoal grills may only be used outside and must be kept a minimum of three feet away from all buildings and combustible materials.

Pets On Campus

Pets are generally welcome in School-owned housing, as long as they are approved before arrival on campus and registered with the Business Office through the housing agreement. Faculty who sign a housing agreement and subsequently get a pet must alert the business office that a new agreement needs to be completed and signed.

Any animal residing on campus that is required to be licensed by Blairstown Township must be appropriately licensed. Pet owners must submit proof of licensing to the Business Office annually, follow leash laws in public places set forth by the town and must pick-up after their pets.

Owners will be responsible for the cost of any required repairs or cleaning, including replacement of floors, carpets, lawns and grounds attributed to pet damage.

The School may require that a pet be removed from campus immediately and permanently if considered a hazard or nuisance to the community or otherwise at the discretion of the School. Any animal that attacks, bites or otherwise engages in aggressive behavior toward any member of the community may be removed at the discretion of the Head of School, at the owner's expense.

III. TAKING CARE OF SCHOOL HOUSING

School Housing Inspections

The School will conduct an annual inspection of the residence to determine maintenance and repair needs due to normal wear and tear. Before a Resident vacates School Housing, they should ensure that the residence is broom-clean, empty of all personal property and trash, and free of damage other than reasonable wear and tear.

General Housekeeping

Campus residences are assigned “as is.” Residents may request repairs, repainting or redecorating by contacting the Director of Facilities. Residents should submit a detailed description of the work/repair to be done or of the request for paint. The Facilities Department reviews and prioritizes all requests.

School Housing units are scheduled for partial or full repainting and/or renovation on a rotating basis. If rooms are in good condition, they will not be repainted or re-carpeted by the School. Due to time and budget constraints, however, occasional repainting and redecorating may be undertaken after the employee has moved in.

The School uses neutral paint colors on interior residential walls. Employees who wish to undertake painting on their own may do so only after securing permission from the Director of Facilities. If the painting request falls within the approved rotational painting schedule for that residence, the School will provide all necessary materials and supplies, including paint. Employees are not permitted to paint using colors that are not approved.

In School buildings, items may not be stored in entrances, stairwells and corridors. This is a violation of fire code and is a safety hazard. Inappropriately stored items may be removed.

Outdoor spaces are to be kept neat, well-tended and maintained. Children’s toys and equipment must be kept in an orderly manner. Public grounds and gardens are maintained by the building and grounds department. Residents who want to plant their own gardens near their residence may do so and are expected to maintain them in a manner consistent with campus gardens. Residents who have a fence are responsible for their outdoor spaces within the fenced-in area; this includes mowing, snow removal and raking. Shrubs, trees and plants are considered permanent fixtures of campus housing and may not be dug up or removed by residents without permission. For more information, contact the Director of Facilities or Grounds Supervisor.

For Residents living in School Housing units with a yard, the School will arrange to have the yard mowed/maintained by the School.

Residents are required to follow all health, safety and sanitation procedures for School Housing and to be in compliance with federal, state and local laws.

Alterations or Structural Improvements

Residents are prohibited from making alterations or improvements to School Housing without obtaining prior written consent from the Director of Facilities. Any rewiring, appliance hook-up, change of utility service, etc., must be approved in writing by the Director of Facilities in order to prevent safety problems or utility differences.

School Maintenance

Repairs, alterations and periodic inspections are understood to be the obligation and responsibility of the Business Office. All requests for repairs, improvements or upgrades to the living space should be submitted in writing to SchoolDude.

Emergency maintenance requests take priority. The Director of Facilities should be contacted during off hours and weekends. Examples of emergencies include, but are not limited to:

- Burning odors of smoke or fire.
- No heat.
- Water leaks.
- Overflowing toilets, sinks, showers, etc.
- Broken windows or doors.

Trash Removal/Recycling

Residents are responsible for getting their personal trash to the dumpsters located nearest their residence or an alternate location as assigned by the Director of Facilities. All trash (including diapers) should be placed in a plastic trash bag and tied to help prevent spillage.

Recycling is an important educational initiative within the Blair community, and all community members are expected to participate fully. Garbage should be kept in proper containers to avoid animal infestation and/or public health hazards and deposited in the several dumpsters located on campus. Faculty living in the dormitories should not use the dormitory garbage or recycling containers for their household garbage and recycling. Recycling should be taken to the recycling center. Never leave any type of food outdoors where it may attract wild animals.

Fire & Emergency

Fire extinguishers are located in the kitchen area of residences. These may not be moved for any reason other than the extinguishing of a fire. If a Resident discovers one to be missing or needing service, that Resident should report it immediately. Any fire, no matter how small, must be reported to the Director of Facilities. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action, up to and including removal from School Housing. If a Resident finds that a fire extinguisher has been used, that Resident should notify the School immediately so it can be refilled.

School Housing has smoke and carbon monoxide detectors. When the smoke or carbon monoxide detectors are activated, all individuals present should immediately leave the building in the safest manner possible. DO NOT stop to gather personal possessions and DO NOT assume there is no emergency. Failure to leave School Housing and/or failing to obey a police officer, firefighter or a School employee during an evacuation may result in disciplinary action, including removal from School Housing.

Residents who willfully or repeatedly cause false alarms will be responsible for paying the fee for such alarms, if applicable. Residents may also be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including removal from School Housing. Tampering with the smoke or carbon monoxide detectors may be cause for removal from School Housing and possible legal action.

Emergency response information is located in each campus residence. Residents are strongly encouraged to review this information and follow it in case of an emergency evacuation.

APPENDIX C: STUDENT LIFE

The mission of the Student Life Office is to assist and support students and faculty as they study, work and live together at Blair Academy and to do so in a manner that allows those students and faculty to get maximum benefit from the opportunities available. Its business and concerns include the daily life of the School, residential life program, attendance and discipline systems, Romano Dining Hall and all aspects of campus life that are not specifically academic in nature.

This section of the *Employee Handbook* describes policies, procedures and philosophies that relate to various aspects of School life for faculty members. It is not comprehensive, but includes the policies and procedures for matters that classroom teachers face frequently. For a complete understanding of guidelines and expectations for students, faculty members are expected to read the *Blair Academy Student Handbook*. Faculty with questions or concerns about the topics included in what follows are urged to confer with a student-life representative.

DORMITORY RESPONSIBILITIES

Dormitory Duty

In a boarding school, faculty members “on duty” in the dormitory have an extremely important responsibility. On one hand, they will be ultimately responsible for the well-being of each dormitory student, as well as for the smooth and efficient operation of the dormitory’s study hours, bedtime, etc. At the same time, it is in the dormitory that the faculty member has the opportunity to participate in the essence of the boarding-school experience—the care and concern for young people beyond the confines of the classroom or athletic field.

The ideal duty person will run the dormitory in the fashion designed by the dorm head and will be sure that the time spent in the dorm is of a quality that benefits both students and faculty members. Time spent ensuring proper study conditions should be balanced by time spent meaningfully interacting with students.

Role of Dorm Head

At any boarding school, the quality of dormitory life is very important. At Blair, because of our relatively small size and remote location, the health of the entire School depends, to an even greater extent, upon high-quality dormitory life. The responsibility for ensuring this quality falls squarely on the shoulders of the dorm head. The following description of the dorm head’s role is meant to be as complete as possible. If the duties seem almost overwhelming, remember that it is not the dorm heads’ goal to fulfill all these responsibilities themselves, but rather to see that everyone in the dorm—students and faculty alike—fulfill their own responsibilities. The main objective that many dorm heads at Blair set for themselves is to get the dormitory to run itself.

I. Basic Responsibilities & Duties

a. Personnel:

- i. See that each member of dormitory staff carries out duties properly, including: following established dormitory policies, arriving on time for duty,

- keeping records on each advisee, counseling students, etc. Be clear with your expectations and be sure to hold staff members accountable.
 - ii. Maintain consistency in reaction to violations of School rules and other matters in the dormitory.
 - iii. Organize and lead regular dorm staff meetings—discuss how duty is going, problem situations or students—be open to suggestions/criticisms from dorm staff.
 - iv. Be available as a resource for dorm staff—get to know each personally. Mentoring young faculty as they begin their careers is extremely important; your influence will be long lasting.
 - v. Evaluate dorm staff (both faculty and prefects) each year—be prepared to share this evaluation with the Dean of Students and Associate Head of School.
 - vi. Be prepared to do an annual self-evaluation and evaluation of your dorm as a whole.
- b. Determine Tone of Dormitory Life:
- i. Establish clearly where “the line” is to be drawn in general dormitory behavior—teach why in certain cases.
 - ii. Be aware of those causing problems in the dormitory who don’t come to your attention officially (major school rule violators, water fights, up after lights out, etc.). Use prefects and other students in the dorm to gather this information.
 - iii. See that dorm duty is done in the manner you want it to be.
 - iv. Ensure evening/weekend dorm reports are written and sent to the appropriate distribution list.
- c. Prefects:
- i. Establish a clear understanding of your expectations as to their role in the dormitory.
 - ii. See that they carry out their duties properly.
 - iii. Counsel and support in their role as prefect.
 - iv. Count on them—if you do, they’ll be a big help. If you don’t, both you and they will be frustrated. Remember that it is a learning experience for them—they will make mistakes, so help them learn from them. Remember the importance of not undercutting them; when they make mistakes, take time to talk with them after the fact.
 - v. Hold weekly meetings.
- d. Record Keeping:
- i. Know how to access records for your residents through REACH and through OC/OR (specifically, parent cell phone numbers, guardian or emergency contacts, disciplinary status and general academic performance). Review concerns and commendations and follow-up with students directly or pass the information along to a dorm staff member to do so on their duty night.
 - ii. With restricted weekend leave policy for underclass students, keep careful records by term.
 - iii. Keep track of riding permission updates (via email/Google docs).
 - iv. Maintain all electronic weekend forms for one year.

II. Miscellaneous Duties

- a. Dormitory Meetings:
 - i. Determine agenda for opening-of-school meeting.
 - ii. Determine timing and agenda of all meetings.
 - iii. Lead all meetings (unless exceptional circumstances).
 - iv. Use to establish the tone of the dorm, as a teaching opportunity in some areas.
 - v. Weekend permissions: Oversee and maintain the system for ensuring submission of weekend forms by Friday evening, coordinating weekend permission notes/calls and providing accurate information for the weekend duty person in your dorm.
- b. Condition of Dormitory:
 - i. Inside common room area: **Inspect daily.**
 - ii. Individual rooms: See that rooms are inspected daily or at least frequently. Impose restrictions on those who repeatedly fail to keep rooms in order. Make this an expectation of all dorm staff (and note that regular Student Life Office inspections will occur).
 - iii. Help ensure the areas immediately outside of the dormitory (grounds, porches and patios) remain presentable and clutter-free.
 - iv. Make all dorm members responsible for the physical condition of the dorm; try to imbue a sense of pride in how the place looks.
 - v. Ensure inappropriate wall hangings are out of public view.
- c. **Personal Relationships:** Establish a personal relationship with each student, not just advisees. Make an effort early in the year to do this by learning background, interests, goals, hobbies, etc. Encourage your assistants to do the same.
- d. **Establish Communication Lines:** Get to know the heads of maintenance, housekeeping and the dining hall. Establish personal relationships with the regular cleaning service staffers in your dorm.
- e. **Communication with Associate Head of School & Dean of Students:** Make the Associate Head and Dean of Students acutely aware of how your dormitory is running—communicate problems regarding students, dorm staff difficulties and decision problems from the beginning of the school year.
- f. **Communication with Parents:**
 - i. At the opening of the academic year: Try to meet as many as possible.
 - ii. Vacations: When they pick up or drop off students.
 - iii. Call if problems arise: Don't hesitate.
 - iv. Attempt to see over the course of Family Weekend.
- g. **Miscellaneous Items:**
 - i. Prepare duty rosters for dorm staff.
 - ii. Attend dorm head meetings or send a representative from your dorm staff.
 - iii. Coordinate all room changes; report to the Student Life Office.
 - iv. Ensure that all weekend and vacation forms are completed through REACH by the appropriate deadline by all residents and be sure to check riding permission.
 - v. Coordinate dorm parties and supervise spending of money in the dormitory fund (your dorm fund is figured at \$15/student in your dorm). Encourage other faculty in the dorm to use these funds, as well to support small

get-togethers or trips off campus. If you deplete funds, the Student Life Office will subsidize them further.

- vi. Thoroughly inspect student rooms at the conclusion of each term and at the end of the year. Students who leave their rooms a mess will be held accountable.
- vii. At the end of the year, oversee room inspection and key collection. In terms of responsibility and liability, make sure that there is never a night with students in residence when there is no faculty member in the dorm between the end of duty and the next morning. Emergencies tend to occur from midnight to 7 a.m.
- viii. The expectation will be for all dorm heads to remain on campus until all students have left their dorm and to return to campus at least 24 hours before students return from various breaks.

DORM LEADERSHIP IS ONE OF THE MOST DEMANDING AND MOST IMPORTANT JOBS AT BLAIR.

The effect that you will have on a group of young people by virtue of the type of dorm you run is enormous. A well-run dorm is the one real constant in students' lives at Blair, and the interaction among students and faculty in the dorm is oftentimes the most important aspect of students' lives on the hilltop. For a dorm to be well-run, it must set for residents clear expectations and standards, while also supporting the needs of its students and being attuned to the many personal issues that arise for adolescents in dorm living. Dorm heads and their assistants who understand that and are committed to doing everything within their power to ensure the best possible situation in their dorms become the real backbone of the School.

Weeknight Duty

1. Present in the dorm by 7:30 p.m.
2. By 8 p.m., be able to account for all students.
3. Be sure that study hall begins at 8 p.m. and does not end until 10 p.m.
2. From 8 p.m. on, be sure that the dormitory remains quiet enough for study. At the conclusion of study hour, the dorm should be quiet enough to allow students to go to bed early.
3. Expect to be in each student's room at least once per duty night.
4. Do not have students scheduled to come to you for extra help while on dorm duty or bring large amounts of grading to do—your focus is to be on the needs of the dorm.
5. Do your best to take complete responsibility for all dorm matters that night. Passing the buck to the dorm head devalues your role.
6. Be sure that all students are accounted for at "lights-out" time; in the event that a student is not accounted for, contact the dorm head or, if not available, the Associate Head of School.
7. If you are a non-resident dorm staff member, remain in the dorm at least 30 minutes (or more, depending on the dorm) after "lights-out" time. Do not leave until the dorm is settled, whatever the hour.
8. **If you are a resident dorm staff member**, remain in the dorm overnight; on your duty night, you are the point/emergency person all night.

Weekend Duty

Weekend duty places ultimate responsibility for the smooth running of the dorm and for the well-being of students on the duty person for an extended period of time—from Saturday lunch through Sunday night. The faculty member on duty should receive a complete and accurate list of those on campus from the REACH system.

Schedule for weekend faculty member on duty:

- **Saturday lunch:** Be present for 30 minutes unless you have a School conflict.
- **Saturday afternoon:** Although constant presence in the dorm is not absolutely necessary for the full period, the faculty member on duty must be easily accessible and available. Those on weekend duty are expected to post signs in the dormitory with sign-in times, the faculty member's cell phone and any necessary information. Please post the Weekend Highlights sheet at this time as well. Students should not sense that the dorms are uncovered; nor should resident faculty not on duty have to meet students' needs. If you must be away from campus on school business (coaching), you must identify a substitute for you during that time. If you do so, you must post a notice in the dorm indicating the substitute's name and contact information. That person should follow the procedure described above.
- **Saturday dinner:** Take dorm attendance or follow-up with the person taking attendance for your dorm; be sure to follow up on any unaccounted-for students.
- **Saturday night** (7 p.m. to bedtime): Remain in the dorm or at your scheduled activity and be visible; oversee visitation check-in as needed; maintain general awareness, etc. Remain in the dorm for a half an hour (minimally) after "lights-out." Do not leave until the dorm is completely settled.
- **Sunday brunch:** Be present for at least 30 minutes and visit the dormitory.
- **Sunday afternoon:** Present in dorm for sign-in and visitation or at your designated activity while another weekend staff member manages sign-in.
- **Sunday early evening/dinner:** Visit dormitory and dining room between 5:30-6:30 p.m.

Guidelines:

1. As far as the Romano Dining Hall is concerned, the responsibility of the weekend dormitory duty person is two-fold:
 - a. To be present at Saturday dinner for the duration of the meal and to **insist that students sign-in (no signing in friends, etc.) face-to-face**. Please don't compromise on this (no sign-in is required at the other meals, but faculty who are on duty should be present for at least half an hour).
 - b. To help oversee the Romano Dining Hall or picnic area.
2. **In case of emergency or a discipline situation requiring immediate attention**, the faculty member on duty should contact the dorm head. If the dorm head is not available, the faculty member should contact the Administrator on Duty.
3. **In the case of a missing student**, the faculty member on duty should:
 - a. Check with the prefect on duty if it is a weeknight.
 - b. Look in all of the obvious places (bathroom, common room, etc.).
 - c. Call the Health Center to see if the student is there.
 - d. Look in every room in the dormitory, regardless of the time.
 - e. Call the dorm head.
 - f. Call the Administrator on Duty, regardless of the time (on weekdays, the Associate Head of School should be contacted).

4. At the conclusion of the weekend, the duty person should report any weekend problems to the dorm head.
5. **Administrator on Duty:** In addition to the faculty member on duty in each dormitory, there is another faculty member who is “at large” and available to give help or assistance as needed in any area during the weekend. Administrators on Duty are accessible by their cell phone numbers.

Miscellaneous Dormitory Matters

1. **Dorm heads are the people directly responsible for all matters in the dorm.** Keep them informed of any problems, concerns or suggestions you have. The more closely the entire dorm staff works together, the better the dorm will be.
2. **Requests for room changes** should be discouraged, for there is real value in the adolescent learning to live with another person, even if the two are not ideally matched. In general, roommate changes will not be considered until after Thanksgiving vacation unless authorized by the Dean of Students or Associate Head of School
3. **Student rooms should be checked on a daily basis** by the faculty member on duty. Those students whose rooms do not meet the minimum daily requirement should be restricted to their rooms between 10-10:30 p.m. Continued violation of this expectation should result in a tally or the loss of weekend privileges. The dorm head has the right and responsibility to search student rooms (with the student present) when and if there is substantial suspicion of the presence of illegal substances or wrong-doing. The Student Life Office must authorize any such search.
4. **Any items confiscated from rooms** (unauthorized appliances, etc.) should be given to the dorm head. Any illegal substances (alcohol, drugs or any other items which violate major school rules) should be given to the Student Life Office.
5. **When it is necessary to notify parents about conduct problems,** please try, whenever possible, to talk with a student about a discipline issue prior to consulting the parents. The purpose of this guideline is to avoid miscommunication. Ideally, you should give students the opportunity to call home before you do and/or have them present when you call. Always keep the dorm head, monitor and advisor informed.
6. **Files for your advisees,** which include all relevant letters, grades and comments, are located in OC/OR, the School’s student information system. You are expected to have the most accurate overview on your advisees; queries from fellow faculty members, from parents and so on will necessitate your staying well organized. Information gathered will also be helpful to pass on to the advisor in subsequent years.
7. **When a student is missing** from a late-night check-in or unaccounted for after a weekend or vacation, the faculty member should contact the dorm head. If the dorm head has no additional information, the faculty member should call the Associate Head of School (or, on weekends, the Administrator on Duty), who will decide if and when the parents and/or police should be contacted.

8. **When students wish to take advantage of a special off-campus trip** that is not required during the academic week, they should complete the “green-sheet” form available in the Student Life Office which, in turn, is to be signed/approved by all teachers whose classes will be missed. Teachers may object to such proposed absences. Monitors and the Associate Head of School will make ultimate decisions about allowing the absence(s).

SERVING AS ADVISORS

Central to the advisor system at Blair is the fact that students choose their advisors. The goal is for students to select that person on the faculty to whom they can turn for advice or counsel on either School or personal matters. Particularly (but not only) in the cases of boarding students, the advisor is the one adult in the community who, on a day-in-day-out basis, keeps tabs on students, communicates with them and serves as a non-judgmental advocate. In this role more than any other, faculty members live out the “*in-loco parentis*” concept that is essential to boarding-school education.

Advisors also serve as a key link between the School and parents in the communication process. Advisors write home twice each year, but the most effective advisors are in regular touch with parents. **Serving as a good advisor is one of the most important responsibilities a faculty member carries out at Blair.**

While faculty members are not legally bound by confidentiality in the way that the Director of Counseling and Director of Health Services are, trust is a concept key to the advisor/advisee relationship. Students need to be able to trust faculty not to divulge information that is personal and private. Faculty members are expected to protect confidentiality, except in cases where a student’s actions or intentions may be harmful to themselves or others.

Advisor Letters

Advisor letters are written for all students in November and at the end of the year. Reminders will be sent out by the Student Life Office. These letters are an important link in our communications with parents, students and class monitors, and it is important that they be done with care and sensitivity.

Generally, as parents receive regular feedback from teachers, and—when problems exist—from class monitors about academic progress, it is important that advisors speak in more detail about other aspects of a student’s participation and development in these letters. These letters should focus on such things as social adjustment within the dormitory and the community, relationships with peers, athletic and extracurricular participation, and other important aspects of School life of which parents should be aware. Certainly, academic development should not be forgotten, as the advisor has a perspective that teachers and monitors do not. These letters should be both summary and analytical in nature.

Advisor letters represent the most direct and comprehensive communication with parents about the performance of their child. It is essential that they be well thought out, accurate and well written (*please be mindful of the AI policy in the Employee Handbook*). The quality of the letters depends in large part on how well the advisor knows the advisee. Accordingly, advisors should meet regularly with their advisees and keep careful records regarding the student’s performance and well-being and maintain notes from the various meetings.

TRIPS WITH STUDENTS

Guidelines for Blair Faculty Leading Student Trips

Faculty who are planning an off-campus trip with students are expected to obtain a copy of the Student Travel Procedures and Emergency Protocols booklet with guidelines and emergency procedures and review prior to planning your trip.

DISCIPLINE

Defining expectations, setting limits and helping students acquire self-discipline is very much a part of the School's mission. All faculty members play an integral role in this process, day-in and day-out. Faculty are expected to know and to uphold the School's rules, regulations and expectations.

Note that some rule violations (level II and III) call for automatic responses, while level I matters may be heard by the Rules & Discipline Committee (R & D), which is responsible for making a recommendation to the Head of School.

No rule violation—or series of violations—**automatically** dismisses a student from Blair. When a student becomes **liable** for dismissal, they have a right to a process that will consider the nature of the violation, the student's previous disciplinary record and their general citizenship in the community.

When making recommendations to the Head of School regarding cases that make a student liable for dismissal, the Rules & Discipline Committee considers what it views as being in the best interest of the individual student and the School community as a whole. Precedent set by cases in previous years or earlier in the year is considered, but does not dictate outcome.

Though faculty are not expected to agree necessarily with every disciplinary decision made, they are expected to respect the fairness of the process. Individual faculty members who have concerns about a particular disciplinary decision should take them to the Associate Head of School or Head of School in private, rather than airing them publicly in the community.

Disciplinary Confrontations: Guidelines & Suggestions

Having to confront students about disciplinary infractions is a task no one enjoys. Often, we feel that if only we didn't have to worry about such things, we could concentrate on those aspects of independent school teaching that we cherish and consider "important." Yet, having been there ourselves, we know that adolescence is a time of stumbling and growing; our students will test the system and break rules.

The reality, of course, is that much growth occurs through the process of making mistakes and learning from them. Thus, while such confrontations will never be cherished, they are extremely important. The skill and sensitivity with which we handle the task of confronting students has as much to do with their growth and development—their true learning—as it does our efforts in the classroom and on the athletic fields.

Because all situations are different and involve different personalities, the guidelines presented below are, at best, general. Hopefully, however, they will be of help to you in striving to make the matter of confrontation as meaningful and productive as possible.

Immediate confrontation should take place when a faculty member comes across an actual rule violation or when the suspicion of the same is based on very strong evidence (in short, when the

faculty member is either certain or at least almost certain that a violation has occurred). This confrontation should not wait until later. In such cases, the evidence should be strong enough to warrant the question, “Why have you been...?” or “How much have you been...?” rather than the question, “Have you been...?” Such an approach often eliminates the temptation for students to lie. In the relatively rare case where there is such strong evidence and the student continues to deny it, the faculty member should call the dorm head or the Student Life Office.

Sharing of concern in a situation where there is some suspicion that a student might have been involved in a rule violation (but where the evidence is not strong enough to warrant an immediate confrontation) or in a case where word of a student’s possible involvement comes up well after a particular disciplinary case has been “closed,” the faculty member should talk with the student to share their concern, but should do so in a way that accomplishes that goal without forcing the student to lie or to be faced with a disciplinary response. Such conversations are designed to let the student know of the concern and to have them understand that if there has been wrongdoing, it is not only a matter of the student’s integrity in terms of being enrolled at Blair, but also an infringement on the relationship between the student and the faculty member. Such a conversation can often begin with:

“I may be wrong (and I am not going to ask you to answer ‘yes’ or ‘no’), but I suspect that...”

Hopefully, such a confrontation will serve to put the student on notice and, more importantly, to give them some different perspective on the matter of rule-breaking in general. Also, it will leave the faculty member the option of being in touch with the parents to let them know that, while there is no proof, the concern has been shared with the student.

While the previous two situations will be initiated by faculty members, **confidential conversations** will often be initiated by the student. As with all confidential conversations, this should remain between the faculty member and the student until/unless the situation necessitates sharing that information with others (parents/other faculty) because a student’s actions or intentions may be seriously harmful to themselves or others.

Respective Roles in the Disciplinary Process

Advisor

The faculty advisor is to be informed as soon as possible regarding disciplinary matters. The advisor’s role is to help the student through the disciplinary process—to be a sounding board, explain the process and talk with parents, if appropriate. In short, it is advisors’ task to ensure students do not feel that they are going through the process alone.

In the case of a student appearing before the Rules & Discipline Committee, the advisor should spend time with the student, both before and after the meeting. During the meeting, the advisor should be sure that the student gets the opportunity to raise any relevant points. Also, the advisor should be prepared to provide the committee with an overview of the student’s record (academic and extracurricular) at Blair. It is **not** the advisor’s obligation to recommend a course of action to the committee.

Monitor

Class monitors may be asked to coordinate follow-up about certain student situations that do not warrant Student Life Office attention.

At the direction of the Associate Head of School, the monitor may, in certain cases, be asked to contact parents to inform them of a pending disciplinary issue.

In certain cases of suspected cheating/plagiarism, the monitor will be part of the Academic Honor Committee convened to determine direction for the case.

Monitors of a particular class and a student's faculty advisor may be asked to meet in an advisory capacity with the Associate Head of School to determine direction for unclear disciplinary cases.

Dorm Head

The dorm head will often be involved in any major disciplinary situations. Also, it shall be the dorm head's responsibility to disseminate appropriate disciplinary information to dorm staff members. Further, the dorm head will be arbiter (with the help of the dorm staff) of dormitory discipline matters that fall short of Student Life Office involvement and will keep the advisor, monitor and Associate Head of School informed.

Student Life Office

The Student Life Office handles disciplinary violations, as well as attendance violations. The Associate Head of School is responsible for determining the appropriate point person for managing each discipline situation. In unclear cases, the Associate Head of School shall create an ad hoc meeting of a student's advisor and the monitors of their class to determine processing direction. In cases wherein disagreement about direction exists, the Head of School will be brought into the deliberation.

The Associate Head of School shall keep the Head of School informed regarding disciplinary situations.

The Associate Head of School shall, prior to any Rules & Discipline Committee meeting, coordinate official contact of a student's parents. The advisor shall talk with parents in a less-official way—as a voice of concern for and about the student, not as the official administrative voice of the School. Prior to any conversations with parents in such situations, advisors should confer with the Associate Head of School to ensure they understand the parameters.

Head of School

Generally, the Head of School will remain apart from the disciplinary proceedings in preliminary stages, reserving involvement for later as potentially the ultimate arbiter.

Prior to the resolution of any disciplinary situation, the Head of School generally does not initiate conversations with students or parents. In discussions initiated by students or parents, the Head of School takes care to defer to the established disciplinary process and not to comment on the situation in any way that could be perceived as prejudging or prejudicing the case.

The Head of School need not be involved in discipline cases short of the R & D level.

In cases that do appear before the R & D Committee, it is the Head of School's (or a designee's) responsibility to meet with the student to inform them of the School's decision and to contact/meet with the parents as well.

DINING HALL

In recent years, the School has altered its tradition of frequent required sit-down family-style meals to an approach that combines some required sit-down meals with some less formal. Lunch, breakfast and Sunday brunch are always buffet-style. We typically have two family-style dinners weekly on Tuesday and Thursday until the Thanksgiving holiday, which are required for all boarders. Seats are assigned (with seating changing every three weeks or so). Permission to miss family-style dinner must be obtained from the Student Life Office.

Family-style dinner is a community event and expectation. The only exceptions to this requirement are when students are invited out to dinner with their parents or when their after-school program has a required practice. We ask parents to refrain from taking students out of family-style meals. Absences detract from the sense of community and result in wasted food. Absences will be tracked and recorded by the Student Life Office. Unexcused absences will count just as any other non-class absences.

Family-Style Dinner Procedures

It is not only important, but a responsibility of ours, to initiate, promote, and encourage good table manners and eating habits among our students.

Our goals and objectives in this area would be difficult to reach and perhaps unattainable if we, as their counselors and advisors, did not set the example that we want our students to follow. With this in mind, the following suggestions are made:

1. **Dress:** Be uniform and consistent about this. Class-day attire is the dress code for family-style dinners, except for those periodic dinners which call for formal attire. For buffet dinners and for Sunday brunch, the dress requirement is looser. As long as they are clean and within bounds of the School's dress code, jeans, shorts, T-shirts, etc., are acceptable.
2. The Romano Dining Hall can be a more pleasant place to eat if we **minimize traffic during family-style meals**.
 - Do not allow students to interact with peers at other tables unless convinced it is necessary.
 - Delegate the waiting-on and dispensing of liquids only to those whose turn it is to do so. We strive to keep students at tables as it is disruptive when many people are walking around the dining room.
 - Refrain from walking around the dining room ourselves.
3. **Procedures for Handling Dinner Tardiness & Absence**
 - a. **When a student is late to dinner**, be sure to question them and report patterns of tardiness to the Student Life Office and/or the student's advisor.

b. When a student is absent from dinner without permission, you must submit the student's name on the attendance form at your table. Head wait staff will pick the form up during the meal.

The tone set in the Romano Dining Hall is exceedingly important. Our collective efforts to support the structure and philosophy of the space will help to make mealtimes enjoyable for all.

APPENDIX D: ACADEMICS

While this section presents the academic program and its daily implementation, it can at best anticipate only some faculty questions and—in the end—will never apply to all circumstances. Faculty, then, should turn to department heads for departmental procedures and policies and to the Assistant Head of School for Academics, Dean of Faculty Life or the Student Life Office for clarification of any general information.

THE CLASSROOM

Meeting My Class/My Classroom

Faculty should meet classes promptly and for the full period. Classes are not to be dismissed early and are not to be moved without notifying the department chair or Assistant Head of School for Academics. **Please be aware that there is no rule at Blair Academy—nor has there ever been—that students need to wait only five (or 10 or any number of) minutes for a teacher to arrive at class before leaving. The rule is that they are to send someone to the Academic Office (or inquire of an adult) to determine your whereabouts.**

Virtually none of us has their “own classroom;” we all visit...or have visitors. Thus, it is our departmental and professional responsibility to keep any room we teach in neat and uncluttered for the next “visitor.” If you feel a room needs more shelving, more posters, another drawer or the removal of something, see your department head, the Assistant Head of School for Academics or Dean of Faculty Life.

Faculty are responsible for keeping their rooms in good order: Attractively and appropriately decorated, picked up at the end of each class, desks or tables or tables straightened at the end of the day. Please remember that food and drinks should not be brought into the classroom by faculty or students.

Teachers who have first-period classes should plan to be in their classrooms at least five minutes before the 8:30 a.m. bell to assure an orderly and prompt opening of the day. Please remember that Saturday classes are prone to interruption because of a variety of conflicts. It is extremely important that the integrity of Saturday classes be guarded carefully by all faculty. Students should not be given permission to miss Saturday classes (or any other class, for that matter) by anyone other than the Associate Head of School.

If I Am Absent

If you are ill and cannot meet classes, or if you must miss class for any reason at all, you must notify your department head and the Dean of Faculty Life. Only current Blair faculty may substitute for a teacher who needs to be absent. Faculty should first seek coverage within their department and then outside their department if needed. Whenever you have reason to miss one or more classes, consult your department head and make satisfactory arrangements for coverage. Faculty are expected to provide the substitute with a plan for the class so that our students’ learning experience is interrupted as little as possible.

It is not acceptable to reschedule classes into the evening or weekend to try to accommodate your absence. This practice disrupts students’ study time and impacts their ability to prepare for their

other classes.

If you must be absent and a test/quiz is to be administered to the class, your substitute must be able to be present in the classroom throughout the testing period. These arrangements should be reported to the Academic Office and made clear to students by reminding them during the class before the missed class.

If Students Are Absent

All student absences should be recorded daily into OC/OR and, should you choose, a separate gradebook.

Whenever students are absent from class (regardless of the reason), **it is their responsibility to make up missed academic work and to be prepared for the next class.** Younger and new students will need help with this, especially as they first confront any inevitable absences.

When students know in advance that they will miss a class, it is their responsibility to inform teachers and to get assignments for the next class.

When a student misses a class unexpectedly (for example, a student is sick, either at home or in the Health Center), it is the teacher's responsibility to communicate assignments to the student, usually via email. In the case of lengthy absences, the monitor and Academic Office will coordinate the workload.

If you question an "excused" absence, see someone in the Student Life Office immediately.

If Students Are Late to Class

A prompt and consistent response to lateness is as important as the response to absence, for without a speedy response, tardiness can develop into a serious problem. Faculty should expect students to be on time. With 10 minutes of passing time between blocks, students have enough flexibility to arrive on time for all commitments. **Any student arriving without a note or explanation provided by another faculty member in the School should be marked tardy in OC/OR.** Once a student has earned three tardies, this counts the equivalence of one absence.

Assigning Homework

In addition to articulating the meaning and purpose behind any assignment students are meant to complete outside of class time, faculty are expected to follow specific procedures to support student understanding of what has been assigned and when it will be due.

In order to support students spending their time on the learning tasks associated with our disciplines, instead of the organizational skills we are not directly teaching, all classes are expected to utilize Google Classroom to organize and assign class materials. The minimum expectations for Google Classroom use are as follows.

By 8 p.m. every Sunday night (or by 8 p.m. on the first night of the week for non-standard weeks), all faculty members must share with their students a "Weekly Plan" which outlines the learning to be done that week, including the meeting times for class, the proposed assignments and any assessments which are coming up.

Any assignments for the class must be assigned through Google Classroom with a set due date. You can select how students submit assignments (on paper, by email, through Google Classroom, etc.), but the assigned due date allows students to organize all of their work in a single screen in Google Classroom.

Homework assignments which are assigned in response to the topics covered in class, such as practice exercises, must be posted by the end of the academic day so students have time to schedule this work into their available times for completing work.

As always, the amount of homework assigned varies considerably among teachers and, while some teachers may expect students to spend approximately 45 minutes (more for advanced courses) in preparation for a class, **it is important to recognize that younger students and those new to the School will usually need specific and continued guidance in ordering and completing of daily assignments.** At the beginning of the year, and probably throughout the first semester, teachers must work to provide daily help with study and time management skills.

What teachers may not do, however, is assign homework by the night.. That is, if there are two nights between the second and third classes, a teacher may not require 100 minutes of homework for the third class.

Faculty must recall that they cannot assume much about basic study skills without the danger of great frustration. Time spent at the beginning of the year on developing and reinforcing good study skills will reward both student and teacher throughout the year.

Returning Homework

Assignments are to be checked or collected the day they are due. **Tests and papers should be returned to students within four classes and quizzes should be returned within two.** The value of an assessment is seriously reduced if students and teachers do not evaluate the results soon after students are tested. Papers and tests must be assessed in such a way that students learn from their mistakes and their successes. **Further tests and papers may not be assigned until previous papers or tests have been returned.**

If you are falling behind in grading, see your department head or the Assistant Head of School for Academics for support.

Can I Give Assignments Over Vacations?

The answer is yes, but only when the dormitories are closed (no students on campus) and by adhering to the following guidelines:

- No teacher is required to make an assignment over a break.
- Assigned work is due on the first class meeting. Work may not be due on a day when a class does not meet.
- Since teachers and students will be apart during the break, and not able to communicate easily, any assignment must be made available in two ways: Hardcopy before leaving and electronically, either by emailing the students or by posting it on your personal/class webpage.
- For the Thanksgiving break, advanced courses may assign up to three hours of work.

Non-advanced classes may assign up to two hours of work. There may be no testing on the first class back.

- For the winter break, advanced courses may assign up to five hours of work. Non-advanced classes may assign up to three hours of work. There may be no testing on the first class back.
- For the spring break, advanced classes may assign up to five hours of work. Non-advanced classes may assign up to three hours. There may be no testing on the first class back.

What to Do About Late or Overdue Work?

First, if a student does not submit homework twice in a week, or seems wholly unprepared for discussion as often, you MUST send a concern via OC/OR. The monitor and advisor will need to know and respond.

Students are to learn to turn in their work on time and need to be aware that completing work late is not appropriate and will eventually be penalized according to department guidelines. **All major assignments, regardless of the extent of the lateness, will be required—students may not “take the failure” and not submit an assignment.** However, teachers must also encourage responsibility by dealing individually with students who are responsible in informing teachers in advance of occasional problems; those students should not be penalized as if they had been irresponsible and thoughtless.

In general, Blair recommends minimizing extrinsic motivators, such as late penalties, as a consequence for overdue work and focusing on helping students build intrinsic motivation and successful study skills in response to difficulties which arise.

If you plan to have an established late policy for student work which assigns penalties for missing deadlines, it is essential that students have written record of this policy in your course syllabus and that you regularly remind them of the expectations and consequences.

Flexibility and understanding with students on the front end is a key aspect of building the supportive relationships which underpin quality student learning. To that end, when students struggle to meet deadlines, it is an important time to discuss with the student, as well as their support team potentially, what issues are preventing them from completing the assigned work. Reinforcing that meeting deadlines is a learned skill that must be practiced goes a long way; expressing that we all miss the target now and then and responding with leniency at the start is our recommended approach.

In rare cases, where student work is substantially overdue and you are not able to get the student to complete the assignment(s), please reach out to the Assistant Head of School for Academics for help. Together, we can determine what type of boundaries the student needs in the class and who needs to be in the conversation about what our expectations will be.

What If a Student Has Multiple Tests on a Given Day?

Students shall not be expected to take more than two full-period tests on any day of the semester. The best students will spot this at a distance and ask you what to do. The answer is simple: You take the one that was first assigned. **To help in this, students should see their advisors or monitor as soon as they realize that they have more than two tests scheduled for a day. With their help, a resolution should be negotiated, following the rule that the events first assigned shall**

receive priority. The Assistant Head of School for Academics may be consulted as well. If the student has come to you at the last minute, you will have to make a quick call. Try to be helpful. If this is the first time something like this has happened with this student, flexibility will be the best response. However, if it appears to be part of a pattern of poor preparation/time management on the student's part, it may be time for flexibility, *followed by a concern notice via OC/OR, and a talk with the student and monitor/advisor.*

Instructional Use of AI (Classroom Teaching Faculty)

All faculty must understand the role that AI could play in the teaching and learning within their discipline and adjust accordingly. Whenever possible, teachers should seek to leverage AI as a tool to help their students reach the intended learning outcomes.

Use cases might include: Brainstorming for lesson planning, assessment or rubric design, unit design or self-guided instructional coaching.

DO	DO NOT
Help students understand how AI might be able to be leveraged as a tool for their learning in your discipline by modeling that use and creating activities in Flint K-12 to help them practice. Model transparent and responsible AI use by helping students understand when AI is being used, how it is being used, and why that use is appropriate. Be consistent with the use of AI across multi-section courses (e.g., English 1). Create and maintain an ongoing dialogue about academic integrity and the role that AI plays in academic integrity. Experiment with the ways in which AI might create new opportunities for deeper learning in your classroom (e.g. Socratic dialogue in Flint K-12 prior to discussion).	Give tests, assessments, or projects which are meant to be AI-free but involve the use of devices with Internet access. Use AI to grade student work and give feedback on major summative assessments on first pass. Use AI detection software to identify AI writing or use.

Student-Specific Professional Use (Faculty)

Generally, it is the explicit job of the writer to make meaning when completing the task, whether with the support of AI or not. AI tools can help with constructing the narrative which ties together descriptive pieces provided by the author but it falls short of making relevant, authentic meaning about what these descriptive pieces mean about or for the student given its lack of specific relationship to any of our students.

Use cases might include: Emails, comments, advisor letters and recommendation letters.

DO	DO NOT
Provide any licensed AI tool that you are using with appropriate context, such as an outline, that helps eliminate the risk of generic prose.	Submit AI-generated writing without having reviewed thoroughly for authentic voice and accuracy.
Avoid inputting any sensitive information into any AI tools due to the risk of future data breaches and leaks.	Submit AI-generated writing that is generic in nature and does not reflect a deep knowledge of Blair students.
Take full responsibility for any AI-assisted writing that you submit as a Blair faculty member.	Use AI-powered listening devices or wearables to record one-on-one conversations with students.
	Use AI-generated text when the focus of the task at hand is on the faculty member's individual voice.

Giving Students Extra Help

Being available to students during the academic day and, as possible and reasonable in the evenings, is an essential and expected part of your teaching responsibility and central to the mission of the School. Please remember that one of the driving forces behind the weekly schedule is to make faculty generally available for extra help. During the conference blocks in the daily schedule, all faculty should be available to meet with students for help unless required to attend a different Blair commitment.

Two important practices will help your students extend their learning during these conference blocks. First, make it clear how students can access you during that time either by picking a standard location or having a standardized way to request help. Additionally, some students benefit from being directly invited to meet with you, especially when they are new to the School and aren't used to our culture.

Dismissing a Student from Class

Dismissal from class should be a last resort, but it should not be seen as unavoidable or a sign of poor classroom management. If all else fails and you have no alternative to maintain order but to require a student to leave the classroom, **you must send the student to the Academic Office to explain why they were dismissed. The student may not simply be sent away, unsupervised.** There should be an attendance response to this as well, recording either a tardy or an unexcused absence. You have the option of handling things yourself without disciplinary action or treating the situation as a disciplinary matter that calls for involvement of the Associate Head of School (and the student's class monitor and advisor when possible) in conjunction with yourself. However, a second instance of being dismissed from class must be reported to the department head, the student's monitor and the student's advisor.

Giving Grades: The Grading System

Grade	Description	Letter Comparable	4.0 Scale Conversion
6.0	This indicates that a student's performance exceeds the learning goals of the class for the entire semester. Less than two percent of marking period grades are 6.0s.	A+	4.3
5.5	Strong and sustained conceptual understanding. Consistent mastery of all learning goals for the course. Students looking to move up tracks (from standard to honors/advanced) need to earn this grade in the standard course to do so.	A	4.0
5.0	Mastery of most learning goals in the course. Good conceptual understanding. Students improve to the next level by identifying specific areas for growth that are currently short of mastery. Students are able to enter new honors or advanced tracks with this level of performance.	A-	3.7
4.5	Proficient in course skills and content. Students should focus on deepening understanding and/or extending learning in key areas to make progress to the next level. Students can comfortably proceed to the next level of a sequence/track with this grade.	B+	3.3
4.0	Proficient in some course skills and content. Key foundational areas need improvement. Blair recommends summer work for students who earn this grade in sequential courses.	B	3.0
3.5	Inconsistent understanding of course skills and content. Challenges with meeting expectations in the course. Students performing at this level raise concerns about their ability to proceed to the next level of the sequence. Required summer remediation to progress.	B-/C+	2.5
3.0	Major gaps in course skills and content. Student learning behaviors and core understanding of concepts are likely in need of significant support and attention. At this level and below, the student should change levels if possible during the year or consider repeating the course in the summer or subsequent year.	C	2.0
2.5/2.0	Limited/no evidence of student learning of course skills and content. While credit is offered for grades at this level, this grade suggests students should not be in the course and would not be able to continue along a sequence.	D	1.0
1.0	This grade shows a failure to demonstrate an understanding	F	1.0

	of the course at a passing level. No credit is given.		
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Beyond the numerical grades recorded at each grading period, students receive effort marks in their classes. While effort marks do not go on official transcripts for external viewing, we believe that the effort marks a student receives are the greatest indicator, especially early in the year, of a student's awareness of and engagement with the best practices for learning in our community. To that end, our effort mark system provides scores in three areas:

- 1) Responsibility:** This area refers to the effort a student makes outside of class, including meeting deadlines, arriving at class in a timely manner, following instructions and communicating effectively with a teacher as needed via email.
- 2) Engagement:** This area refers to the effort a student makes inside of class, including participation in class activities, note-taking, attentiveness and appropriate technology use.
- 3) Resourcefulness:** This area refers to the effort a student makes to improve their performance with the support available in the class, including meeting with their teacher as needed, responding to feedback on returned work and demonstrating agency in their learning.

Students will receive one of four "marks" in these areas:

- Consistently
- Often
- Occasionally
- Rarely

These qualifiers record the frequency with which a student demonstrates the behaviors associated in the area. Our goal is to provide transparency about what effort marks mean and a strong roadmap for students on how to make improvements here at Blair.

Turning In Grades & Reports/Comments

Memos regarding exact due dates and times for grades and comments are made available two to three weeks beforehand. It is important that comments be turned in, via OC/OR, when they are due. If circumstances are extreme, and you will be late with some of your grades, please inform the Assistant Head of School for Academics and your department head as soon as possible.

What to Do When You Suspect Cheating or Plagiarism?

In any competitive, rigorous academic environment, the temptation for students to cheat or to present another's work as their own may well arise. Faculty must act in a uniform manner (described below) when responding to all forms of cheating, including plagiarism.

Issues involving plagiarism, which are often confusing to younger students, are serious and the School has responded strongly to students who represent another's work as their own, **up to and including dismissal for repeat offenders**. Therefore, students must understand what plagiarism is and how to avoid it.

It is a faculty responsibility to assure and confirm that all students understand clearly what plagiarism entails at the beginning of each school year, no matter the age of the student in the class. These issues should be addressed throughout the year and before and during any research project.

Cheating/Plagiarism: Details of the Process

A teacher who suspects a student of cheating should discuss the matter with the student promptly and privately. If, as a result of this discussion, the teacher is satisfied beyond reasonable doubt that there has been intent to cheat and/or cheating, the teacher will inform the department head and, if in agreement, they will inform the Assistant Head of School for Academics. The Assistant Head of School for Academics, the teacher, and the student's monitor and advisor will partner with Academic Honor Committee (AHC) representatives (three students, three faculty) to form an ad hoc sub-committee that will confirm intent to cheat and/or cheating. If that is established, the sub-committee will proceed to counsel the student and bring the situation to the attention of the Head of School, with a recommendation for action as described below. That recommendation will be voted on by the AHC members and the Assistant Head of School for Academics. In accordance with the School's policy, the Head of School will confirm the response.

In a case where cheating is strongly suspected but cannot be proven and is not admitted to, the class monitor and/or advisor will contact the student's parents to let them know of the situation and concern.

Method for Processing Academic Dishonesty Cases

Mission:

To separate the handling of academic honor violations from social violations; to develop and nurture a system whereby student representatives participate in hearing those cases as a means of instilling broader community awareness of, and responsibility for, academic honesty.

School Rules/ Guidelines:

Cases of alleged and admitted academic dishonesty will be reviewed by an ad hoc committee comprising the teacher, advisor, monitor, three voting student members of the Academic Honor Committee (AHC), three voting faculty members of the AHC and the Assistant Head of School for Academics (voting to prevent a tie). The group will be chaired by the Assistant Head of School for Academics or a designated representative. This group will review cases of academic dishonesty in a manner reflecting the operation of the Rules & Discipline Committee. The voting members of the committee will make recommendations to the Head of School. The Assistant Head of School for Academics shall communicate decisions to the student and parent(s).

In reporting to the Head of School, the committee may recommend:

Level III: Reprimand. Reprimand is reserved for acts of academic irresponsibility, including poor/inadequate/sloppy scholarship, or the like (a list of examples is below). Students remain on Level III Reprimand for 12 months; any act of academic irresponsibility or the like within that 12 months' time will automatically require Level II Warning.

Level II: Warning. Warning is reserved for acts of conscious, deliberate academic dishonesty (a list of examples is below), or for a repeated act or acts of academic irresponsibility while the student is on Level III Reprimand; or, for repeated acts of academic irresponsibility over the student's career at the school. Level II Warning lasts for a student's career at the School, through graduation, and any act of academic irresponsibility or academic dishonesty during that time will automatically place the student on Level I Probation. Such an act or acts while on Level II Warning may, depending on the nature and

severity of the incident, include a recommendation for dismissal.

Level I: Probation. Repeated, deliberate academic dishonesty—or any single and particularly egregious act of deliberate academic dishonesty—may result in an immediate recommendation for dismissal from School. If not dismissed, the student will be placed on Level I Probation, which continues through the student's graduation.

A student on Level I Probation may expect to be dismissed immediately for any subsequent act of academic irresponsibility or dishonesty.

If the student is in the 11th or 12th grades, they may be required by colleges to report this conduct/probation during the admission process.

Examples of academic irresponsibility usually resulting in Level III Reprimand include, but are not limited to:

- Carelessness with talk or materials during testing situations (including SAT/PSAT testing situations).
- A first instance of plagiarism where there was no intent to deceive (primarily younger students).
- A first instance of providing or accepting inappropriate help on homework.
- A first instance of presenting a lab partner's write-up as one's own.
- Sloppy or inadequate scholarship of any kind.
- A first instance of dishonesty regarding the preparation/submission of homework.

Examples of conscious, deliberate academic dishonesty usually resulting in Level II

Warning include, but are not limited to:

- Any conscious, deliberate act of plagiarism, of presenting another's work as one's own and attempting to deceive the reader to that end.
- Any conscious and deliberate act of cheating, of taking another's answers and presenting them as one's own or of bringing inappropriate materials to a testing situation and using them or clearly intending to use them.
- Any conscious and deliberate act designed to facilitate cheating or plagiarism on the part of oneself or another student or students.
- Consistent, documented acts of dishonesty regarding the preparation/submission of homework.

Field Trips

Field trips are a traditional and valuable part of the School's academic and educational experience. However, given both the weekly schedule and the crowded nature of the Blair day, field trips must be scheduled well in advance and with attention to the many and varying commitments of students and faculty. Proposed trips must be cleared with the department head and the Assistant Head of School for Academics at least one term in advance and are not to take place near the end of a grading period. All faculty need to be aware that students are missing classes to go on field trips. These absences create significant challenges for students and colleagues and must be weighed against the value of the field trip for your course and the student's education.

Students who go on trips are responsible for making up for all missed material and should come to

the next class fully prepared for that class.

Using Timken Library

The library is a vital part of the academic life of the School. It is open to faculty and students for study and research purposes. Faculty are encouraged to work closely with library staff in creating reading lists, reserved lists and class visits for projects.

Teachers may not use the library to give extra help in the evenings, except with the approval of the library associates. Please use a classroom.

Communication

For the School to function effectively, we must communicate with one another effectively. This is especially true in the classroom, where we must be careful not to try to “go it alone.” Community members communicate about student academics in many ways and venues: department offices, the dining hall (be very, very careful!), social events, and via office/online forms. In the end, the function of communication here is to spread the word about student achievement and behavior across as many faculty as possible (monitor, advisor and dorm head) and get feedback just as quickly.

Concerns & Commendations

These are essential forms of communication and are submitted via OC/OR and sent to the student, monitor, dorm head, advisor, and members of the administrative team and counseling office. They are not sent home, but recall that the student will get a copy; adjust your tone and focus accordingly. Faculty are **required** to issue a **concern** for any reason that the faculty member feels is a danger signal: missing homework or a change in attitude or change in behavior. Declining grades are only the most obvious issue. Most important, faculty are to discuss with students the issues involved in a concern note; simply sending off the notice is not enough. Ideally, the concern will not be a surprise to a student.

Please remember, though, that **commendations** can do much to let students know that their efforts and achievement are worthy of notice. The past years show many instances where an extra few minutes spent doing commendations did more to help achievement than all the concern notices in the world. Please do not neglect commendations, especially for the struggling student who has shown a recent or occasional improvement. Blair students take pride in their classroom achievement, and your commendation notice is an appreciated and essential part of that developing pride.

Returning Parent Phone Calls & Emails

Faculty are required to check email at least twice each day during the school year. Unless you are out of town or otherwise away from campus on School business, you must respond to all email and phone messages in 24 hours. If you feel that the student’s monitor or advisor will more appropriately handle the matter, you must nonetheless respond to the parent promptly, indicating that you have received the message and are referring the matter to the monitor/advisor.

New and less-experienced faculty should seek guidance from their department head, Dean of Faculty Life or Assistant Head of School for Academics before replying to parent emails or phone calls. There is no reason to rush into a new situation without first reviewing the matters at hand with a more experienced colleague.

During longer breaks, faculty who run programs, trips or other student-related events that require

enrollment and scheduling must be sure that their email and voicemail greetings are up-to-date and make clear when they will be checking for and responding to messages.

Educational Assessments

Many students new to Blair will have to adjust to new and substantially increased academic demands. At the outset, there can be confusion, frustration and, in some cases, low grades. We all work hard with students to help them become effective learners, and often we will share their frustrations. In the end, most students show substantial improvement and become progressively more independent in their learning. However, there will be cases that simply seem beyond us—and they may be. A battery of assessments, administered and interpreted by a professional to faculty, parents and students, may be helpful in deciding what routes to follow.

Thus, educational assessments can be very helpful to students, teachers, parents and the School. However, assessments must be handled carefully and thoughtfully. Words and phrases such as “dyslexic,” “A.D.H.D.” and “learning disability” are powerful terms, ones not to be bandied about. It is entirely inappropriate for you to offer such “diagnoses” to parents or students. They are diagnoses that are to be arrived at by professionals. Such concerns, insights and suggestions, based on your experience, are invariably helpful, but they may be shared with the School staff only. The results of any assessments, as they are pertinent to classroom/study issues, are shared with teachers by the Director of Academic Support. Teachers must treat this information in a confidential, professional manner.

Assessments may be undertaken only with the specific permission of the parent. Assessments that are on file with the School may be viewed with either the Assistant Head of School for Academics or the Director of Academic Support.

When parents, faculty, students or staff have raised the question of an assessment, the Director of Academic Support will review the student’s file to see if testing has been done within the past three years and—if so—review that earlier testing. If no such testing is immediately found, the parents may be questioned if this seems appropriate. This communication is to be done by the Director of Academic Support or the Assistant Head of School for Academics.

Finally, students will come to Blair with assessments already in place. Again, the Director of Academic Support is the contact point for these, and will communicate appropriately with students’ teachers.

GENERAL ACADEMIC MATTERS

Some Details on Responding to Late & Overdue Work

Faculty may:

1. Use a deduction system for late work. However, even if the value falls to zero, the work is still required.
2. Give late papers a substantially reduced grade if not turned in on time and a “1.0” if the lateness is deemed excessive. Again, the work is still required.

Faculty must:

1. Utilize the recommended system (*see above*) or a plan uniform within their department.
2. Not accept work of any sort after the last class of the marking period without consultation

with the department head and the Assistant Head of School for Academics regarding the obvious (illness, family tragedy, etc.) and sometimes not-so-obvious exceptions.

School responses:

1. Students not assigned to a supervised day or evening study period but who fall into a pattern of turning in incomplete or late homework may be assigned to structured evening study by the advisor or class monitor in conjunction with the classroom teacher.
2. The Assistant Head of School for Academics, through monitors and advisors, pays close attention to late or missing work in making Scholastic Warning and Scholastic Probation decisions.

Fourth-Year Exams: Second Semester

Students in their fourth year who do not meet particular grade expectations in the final quarter of the year (after the return from March break) are required to take exams to demonstrate their competency in these classes. The standard has been set at a minimum grade/effort mark of 4.0 with Responsibility and Engagement effort marks of “Sometimes” or 3.5 with effort marks of “Often.” These exams are administered beginning immediately on the Tuesday before graduation. A fourth-year student may not take more than two exams in a day and there must be a minimum of one hour between exams. *Please note the first paragraph in “Exam Failures,” immediately below.*

Exam Failures

A student achieving a troublingly low failure (“catastrophic failure”) on a major cumulative assessment in a full-year course may receive a failing grade for the year if the teacher, department head and Assistant Head of School for Academics feel that circumstances merit. Such a failure is defined as performance so low as to call into question a student’s overall understanding of the course and to suggest strongly that the “sum of the parts” (mids and semester grades) does not approximate or justify “the whole” (year grade), despite what the standard calculations might suggest; or, if such a failing performance clearly indicates a lack of respect for the teacher, School or educational process.

If students would otherwise have passed the course, they will be given the option to receive credit for the course by preparing for another assessment, to be taken no earlier than the third week of June and no later than the last week of August (a passing grade on the exam will result in a “P” for “pass,” to be recorded under summer work for that year on the transcript).

Such failures must be reported immediately to the department head. Should they agree, they will present the case as soon as possible to the advisor, monitor and Assistant Head of School for Academics.

Illness During or Immediately Preceding Exams

On occasions, a student has become seriously ill immediately before or during the end of a marking period. In some cases, the teacher and Assistant Head of School for Academics may decide to waive classroom work and/or assessments. The School will **consider** the following points in determining (in individual cases) if assessment(s) may be waived:

- 1) The student has been absent for an extended period during the end-of-year exam period and is at a considerable distance from the School; (2) the student has displayed a pattern of competency in the course for the year; (3) the student is doing very well overall; and (4) the

assessment(s) (in the teacher's opinion) is unlikely to have any effect on either the year grade or the student's understanding of the material presented in the course.

An assessment waiver for illness is neither a "given," nor even a primary option. In almost all cases, the exam is appropriate and necessary to complete the course, and students may have it administered in their home area if they live so far from the School to make returning for the assessment inconvenient.

Student Year Failure of a Course

All Students

In brief, a year failure caused by a second-semester signature assessment failure may be remedied by a re-exam; all other cases of failure must be remedied by classroom or tutorial work with re-examination.

A student receiving a failing course grade who does not qualify for a re-exam (i.e., the failure was not caused by the second-semester exam):

First- and second-year students: Ninth and tenth graders are required to make it up by repeating the course at Blair unless credit problems necessitate that the course be made up during the summer. A course that is not required for graduation need not be made up, although it is strongly advised that students do so.

Methods:

- a) Through private tutoring, or classes in a similar-but-not-comparable course at another school, a student may request and take a comprehensive Blair examination in the failed course. This examination must occur between August 1 and August 31. The student must clearly pass the exam.
- b) The School will accept the credit earned through enrollment in a comparable, approved and accredited summer school course, if the student earns a "C" or its accepted equivalent. If the failed course is part of a sequence, and the final exam in the summer school course is not submitted to the School, Blair may require that its own exam be administered to confirm level of achievement.

Fourth-year students only: Twelfth graders who fail to meet academic requirements for graduation and who are in otherwise good standing at the time of graduation are given until August 31 following graduation to satisfy these requirements, in the manners described above. Otherwise, no further opportunity will be given to fulfill these requirements for the Blair diploma unless an exception is granted through a vote of the full faculty.

In all cases (senior and underclass) that a student earns a passing year grade by passing an examination during the summer, the transcript will present a "P" and note as follows:

" * Received credit by passing an examination on (the date of the exam should be noted)."

Standardized Testing

The College Counseling Office Manager & Director of Testing is in charge of standardized testing for other than educational assessments, and addresses all issues involving APs, ACTs, PSATs and SATs.

Supervised Study/Honor & Unlimited Status

Study privileges in the evening hours are determined by the dorm staff and monitor and are based on the student's GPA, effort marks and demonstrated level of responsibility.

Fourth-Year Projects

Fourth-year projects are non-credit projects developed and undertaken by 12th graders, almost always at the end of their fourth year. In some cases, students have used the March break for a fourth-year project. During the time of the project, the student is away from School and does not return to campus. Students may NOT do projects under the supervision of a parent or close relative.

While students may be away from campus during the project, they may find they have required assignments for their classes. Fourth-year students in danger of failure or poor performance in a course may need special permission (including the administration of a final exam) to be able to do a project.

Twelfth-grade students interested in this should approach the Assistant Head of School for Academics during the winter months (certainly no later than the end of February) to review the process and proposals.

Advanced & Remedial Work During Summer Months

Students or parents may come to faculty with requests for the approval of summer study designed to make up credit or allow an advanced placement of some kind. **Faculty should not render any opinions on the need or desirability of such requests. All such requests must pass immediately to the department head and the Assistant Head of School for Academics for review.**

The general policy of the School is that students may not use summer work to advance themselves in sequential courses except in very rare cases. The most common situation is for students who begin in Algebra 1 at Blair and opt to take Geometry in the summer following their 9th-grade year.

Students who fail courses, or perform at such a level in a sequence as to prevent advancement, may remediate this during the summer. The course must be approved by the department and by the Assistant Head of School for Academics and credit will only be accepted after a Blair exam has been passed. If the student has passed the course and is simply strengthening skills to ease advancing in the sequence (Spanish 1 to Spanish 2, for example), no note will be made on the transcript. However, if the student wishes, the transcript from the summer school may be attached to the Blair record.

For more information, see the Assistant Head of School for Academics.

Independent Study

Candidates for independent study must be in good academic standing and have demonstrated the motivation and self-discipline to successfully complete an ambitious project without close faculty

supervision. Independent study opportunities may be available to students (with faculty sponsors) who cannot take a formal course at Blair in the area that they wish to study and who can demonstrate that student and faculty sponsor have sufficient time and preparation to undertake the specific project successfully. However, students may not assume/presume that faculty are readily available for such an undertaking. It requires effort on everyone's part.

The independent study is offered by the semester only and must be endorsed by the faculty sponsor, approved by the department head, the student's advisor, the class monitor and, lastly, the Assistant Head of School for Academics, ideally no later than three weeks prior to the beginning of the semester in which the project will be completed. The approval of a college counselor may be required of older students. Students may undertake only one independent study per semester. Forms outlining criteria for an application are available from individual departments.

When a Student is Suspended from School

In order that suspension remains supportive and productive, a student should be held accountable for information covered in class. Thus, the absence will be treated as a legitimate excused absence. Whenever possible, students should see all of their teachers prior to departure for suspension. When this is impossible, the teacher will be asked to submit assignments to the Academic Office so that they may be communicated to the student; it is very important that teachers respond promptly to such requests.

Student Dismissal or Withdrawal: Completing Work *In Absentia*

All Students

A student dismissed or withdrawn within eight weeks of the School's graduation date for that year may appeal to receive the remaining assignments and take final exams for *any full-year course(s) other than those in laboratory science or the performing arts*. In the latter case(s), unless all obligations other than the final exam have been met at the time of dismissal/withdrawal, final grades of WP (withdrawn/pass) or WF (withdrawn/failure) will be awarded, depending on the student's status at the time of dismissal/withdrawal. No credit (partial or otherwise) will be earned for full-year courses not completed. Teachers will supply major assignments and will correct and grade major course requirements only.

Students enrolled in *term courses* may appeal to finish the classwork and (if required) take exams in those courses only if the following three conditions are **all** met: (1) The dismissal/withdrawal occurred after April 30; (2) The work can be shown to be necessary for promotion to the following year; and (3) The course does not require the use of equipment specific to Blair's campus. If these criteria are met, teachers will supply major assignments and will correct and grade major course requirements only. Otherwise, final grades of WP (withdrawn/pass) or WF (withdrawn/failure) will be awarded, depending on the student's status at the time of dismissal/withdrawal.

All such arrangements shall be coordinated by the Assistant Head of School for Academics, and all require that a student's financial obligations to the School or its approved tutors/programs, be full and complete as indicated by the Business Office.

Fourth-Year Students

In the case of a fourth-year student who is dismissed late in the year, credit may be earned as indicated above (see "Completing Work *In Absentia*"), and the student may be legally graduated, but

it is possible, given the circumstances of the dismissal, that the Blair diploma will not be awarded. A high school diploma in the form of a Certificate of Attendance, will be granted in its place.

A “spring out” is sometimes offered to those who, in the opinion of the School, are unlikely to reach graduation because of their problematic disciplinary/attendance status. The spring out allows the student to complete work as indicated above, *but the student can not return to campus and cannot participate in graduation ceremonies.*

Blair Academy Diplomas

The Blair Academy diploma is granted to currently enrolled students whom the faculty and Head of School judge to be members of good standing in the School community and who complete in a timely fashion Blair’s graduation requirements.

A delayed Blair Academy diploma can be granted later than usual to a student who, for one reason or another, was unable to complete required academic work in time for graduation and who was otherwise in good standing with the School. This option is usually required of students who have not completed work required both for graduation from Blair and for a high school diploma. The work to be completed must be made up through Blair and, unless special circumstances (extended illness, for instance) demand otherwise, must be completed before the end of August of the graduation year.

A Certificate of Attendance (certifying graduation from high school) is awarded to students who have completed their studies at Blair in a timely fashion, but who do not qualify for a Blair Academy diploma as described above. Students receiving a Certificate of Attendance may graduate from Blair in good standing otherwise (often, this will be postgraduate students whose previous high school course of study was such that they simply could not meet Blair’s diploma requirement and who entered the School with this understanding).

An honorary diploma may be awarded.

- a. An honorary diploma can be awarded to and recognize individuals (usually faculty members) who have been particularly important to, and appreciated by, a particular class. This can happen by vote of a class at graduation or by vote of a class celebrating its reunion. No academic/curricular criteria are required. This must be authorized by the Head of School.
- b. An honorary diploma may be awarded to and recognize individuals whose relationship with the School has had special significance in furthering its mission and values. This must be authorized by the Head of School.
- c. An honorary diploma may be awarded to students who did not finish their Blair career, but left the School in good standing and went on to complete high school and college in a manner that reflects the academic and social values of Blair. This may be authorized by the Head of School after consultation with administrative staff. Students who left Blair early to attend college may avail themselves of this method upon graduation from college through a letter to the Head of School.

- d. An honorary diploma can recognize former Blair students who never finished their careers at the School but who, in the intervening years, have gone on to distinguish themselves in ways that reflect credit on themselves and the values of the School. While no academic/curricular criteria are required, the completion of high school and college will be strong considerations, among others. This may be authorized by the Head of School after consultation with administrative staff. In general, former Blair students should expect to see a minimum of 15 years pass (following the date of their class's graduation from Blair) before availing themselves of this option through a letter to the Head of School.
- e. An honorary diploma may be awarded to a student who entered the School as a postgraduate and who, because of the limits of time, could not fulfill the academic and curricular requirements for the Blair Academy diploma and graduated, instead, as a student in good standing with the Certificate of Attendance. The student must have gone on to complete college in a manner that reflects the academic and social values of Blair. This may be authorized by the Head of School after consultation with administrative staff. These students may avail themselves of this method upon graduation from college through a letter to the Head of School.

APPENDIX E: ATHLETICS

ATHLETIC FACILITIES & GUIDELINES

The **golf course** has nine holes and is open for play for all of our students, faculty and staff. Please remember, however, that residents of Blairstown are members of the course and will be playing on it during the fall and spring terms. Some general rules to follow when playing on the golf course:

Every player must have their own bag, wear presentable clothes on the golf course (collared shirts are required) and, at all times, follow all rules and etiquette of golf. If you have any questions about the use of the golf course, please see the Athletic Director or one of the golf coaches.

Tennis Courts: As is the case with the golf course, the tennis courts are primarily for the use of the School, but are also used by fee-paying members of the Golf/Tennis Club. Proper attire is required at all times (tennis shoes and shirts always). Please do not use the courts for any other purposes (skateboarding, biking, etc.). Be conscious of your language and of not distracting players on adjacent courts.

Hardwick Hall: Our athletics and activities center includes a varsity-competition performance gym, two multi-purpose courts (tennis, volleyball or basketball), a wrestling room, Fitness Center, locker rooms, training room, squash courts and the Athletic Office.

The Fitness Center is located on the second floor of Hardwick Hall (adjacent to the building's clock-tower entrance). At certain times, it will be reserved for groups and teams; at other times, the room will be open for general use. A complete statement about procedures to follow while using the room is posted in the Fitness Center; please adhere to these expectations and keep this room clean so all can take advantage of the facility. Equipment should not be taken out of the Fitness Center.

Playing Fields: Thanks to the care of our grounds crew, Blair has some of the best playing fields in the state, including two turf fields. Please help us to care for the fields by staying off them when they are wet or thawing and keep dogs off both turf and playing fields.

The Wallace Pool is occasionally open during the weekends for recreational swimming, in addition to its regular use by the swim team. Please remember and observe the following rules when using the pool with your activities or team:

- There must be a faculty member in the pool area and two certified lifeguards.
- Please wear proper bathing attire, and always shower before entering the pool. No street shoes on the deck. No food or drink on the deck of the pool.
- Be careful and courteous.
- Never enter the pool area unless you have permission.

Tracy Hall includes the Golf Pro Shop and seven international squash courts, as well as the Citation Room that is used for Board of Trustees meetings. These courts are for squash only. Players must always wear protective eyewear and athletic shoes with non-marking soles.

TRAINING RULES

Beyond the matter of School rules, abstinence from the use of tobacco or any harmful substances is essential to one's health and physical development. From the time of the first team meeting to the

conclusion of the season, any indication that an athlete has used tobacco, alcohol or illegal drugs (including marijuana and anabolic steroids), whether or not that use has occurred on or away from campus, will subject the athlete to discipline from the coach, including the possibility of dismissal from the team. In addition, other consequences would be imposed by the Student Life Office.

Coaching Requirements & Certifications

All coaches are required to have a current CPR/first aid certification. Each year, all coaches will complete an online concussion awareness course through Heads Up or the National Federation of State High School Associations (NFHS), as well as a heat illness prevention course (NFHS). All coaches **MUST** have or obtain a commercial driver's license (CDL) license. Please contact the Associate Director of Athletics or Assistant Director of Athletics for Sports Information & Facilities for help in obtaining one.

Daily practice

Times:

- 3:30 p.m. to approximately 5:30 p.m. (Monday, Tuesday, Thursday or Friday).
- No earlier than 2:15 p.m. on Wednesday.
- Saturday after classes.
- All athletes must have at least one day off per week. Blair does not encourage any more than one.
- Sunday practice only if there is a game on Monday (in this case, Saturday or Tuesday must be a day off with pre-season being an exception).

Attendance

1. All student-athletes are expected to be at every session.
2. Accepted excuses:
 - a. Note from Health Center (student must be in the Health Center or present but not active at practice).
 - b. Note from Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer (must be in rehab or present at practice).
 - c. The head coach gives permission.
 - d. Special circumstances.
3. Take attendance every day.
4. Submit absences on OC/OR.
5. Varsity coaches use their own discretion concerning missed practices.
6. If a student-athlete logs continued absences, notify the Athletic Director.
7. Demand that your athletes be on time and hold them accountable.
8. Students who are ill or do not feel well enough to leave the Health Center by the lunch period may not participate in after-school activities. It stands to reason that, if a student was not able to participate in the academic day, they should continue to rest through the after-school activities.

Equipment

- All equipment is handed out at the beginning of the season by the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations.
- If you have special needs or need more of something, please contact the Athletic Director.
- Coaches are responsible for all gear during the season.

- Please clean up the field or court area after practice or games. Make sure all gear is put away at the end of practice sessions. Outside teams should use sheds for storage; inside teams should use closets and locker rooms.
- If any equipment breaks, please notify the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations so it can be fixed or replaced.
- Coaches are responsible for turning in all equipment no later than one week after the season ends.

Uniforms

- Blair orders top-of-the-line uniforms; please make sure athletes take care of them.
- All uniforms are issued by the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations.
- All uniforms must be turned in to be washed immediately following games or upon return from away contests.
- If the equipment room is not open, there is a laundry chute or bin outside of the room for collection of uniforms.
- Please do not allow day students to take uniforms home to wash themselves.
- We expect all athletes to have clean uniforms for every game.
- If athletes do not return their uniforms, they may not be able to dress for the next contest until the uniforms are returned.
- The Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations may set up a specific time with coaches to turn-in uniforms and warm-ups. The complete collection of uniforms is the coaches' responsibility.
- All uniforms and warm-ups must be turned in no later than five days after the season ends.

Dress Code

- All athletes travel in uniform and warm-ups for fall and spring seasons. All athletes must wear apparel that says "Blair Academy."
- Winter athletes travel in class-day attire team warm-ups.
- All managers must dress appropriately (same as athletes in winter).

Coaches Attire

- Coaches receive coaching gear from the Athletic Office.
- Travel attire is the same as for athletes.
- Game-day attire depends on the sport (either Blair coaches' gear or formal).

Athletes should not wear their uniforms to class unless there is a special circumstance of early departure during the class day. Athletes should not be in uniform all day, but should change just before leaving.

Injuries & the Training Room

1. All injuries must be reported to the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer on the day they occur, whether at home or an away contest via phone, email or in person.
2. All head injuries will be dealt with by both the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer and the Health Center team.
3. All decisions on return to play will be determined by the school physician and school physician and Head/Assistant Athletic Trainer.
 - a. The only exception is a physician's note from one of the School's affiliated physicians.

- b. An athlete is not permitted to return to full play or practice without the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer's clearance or a physician's note giving them clearance.
 - c. Athletes should be able to complete a full practice before returning to game play following an injury.
- 4. The Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer will make every attempt to keep coaches up-to-date with the progress of their athletes via phone, email or in person.
 - a. This includes rehab and when an athlete is safe to return to play.
 - b. If coaches have any questions about the availability of athletes, they must contact the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer before allowing them to participate.
 - c. The Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer will have a sign-in sheet for athletes who come to the athletic training room, so if coaches have questions about whether a specific athlete was seen on a specific date and time, that information is readily available.
- 5. During away games, please follow the stated injury protocol:
 - a. If ever a player sustains a head injury or another significant injury, the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer or coach will remain with the player until they are in the care of a parent.
 - b. If a player with a head injury or another significant injury returns to campus with the team, the coach should walk the player to the Health Center immediately upon arriving back at Blair.
 - c. If a player has experienced a significant injury on the field, coaches must first notify both the Health Center and the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer and then call or text the parent.
 - d. Before departing from any game, coaches should seek a trainer (either the trainers at Blair or those of the opponent) for any needs related to a player's injury.
 - e. If Blair's trainers are not at an away event, please inform them of any injuries. Again, if they are significant, immediately bring the athlete to the Health Center upon your return.

Rehabilitation, Treatment & Taping

- 1. Will be done in the athletic training room at appropriate times.
- 2. Athletes should make an attempt to have rehab/treatment done during free periods whenever possible.
 - a. Rehab appointments should be made with the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer.
 - b. Rehab can be done after teams are out at practice.
 - c. No rehab will be done in the 30-45 minutes following the end of classes as that is when the Head and Assistant Athletic Trainer will be getting athletes out to practice.
- 3. It is the responsibility of injured athletes to come to the athletic training room. The Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer will not chase down athletes.

In Case Of Emergency at Away Contests

- 1. Be sure to contact the Head Athletic Trainer at (908) 362-6121, ext. 5652, or (609) 529-2549.
- 2. If the athlete is in need of medical attention and needs to be seen by a doctor or go to the emergency room, contact the Health Center to inform the nursing team so they can send

- medical release forms to the hospital. The Health Center can be reached at (908) 362-2010.
3. The Head and Assistant Athletic Trainer cannot be at all fields at all times. If there is an injury:
 - a. Remain calm.
 - b. If there is blood or any other bodily fluids, put on gloves provided in the first-aid kit.
 - c. Have someone contact the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer by phone, radio or send someone to find them.
 - d. The Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer will be there as soon as possible.
 4. It is the coach's responsibility to check the XX (excused from sports) and restricted-activity lists in the emailed *Daily Bulletin* on a daily basis to see if any of their athletes are on them and follow the recommendations. Any questions about why an athlete is on the list can be addressed to the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer or the Health Center team.
 5. First-aid and ice kits will be issued to each team by the Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer, and it is the coaches' responsibility to refill them for the remainder of the season. Each team should have the kits with them at all games and practices.

Fitness Center

- We are very proud to have a state-of-the-art facility—please help to keep it clean—be a presence and example (putting weights back on racks, wiping machines, etc.).
- Make sure students respect the equipment and help them understand proper use.
- See the Strength-and-Conditioning Coach if you have any questions about the use of equipment.
- If you are interested in setting up a time for your team to use the facility, please contact the Athletic Director for scheduling.
- Supervise your team when they are using the room; safety is our highest priority.
- **Please do not bring a team to the Fitness Center when our weight groups are in session.**
- The athletic facility will be closed by the Strength-and-Conditioning Coach at 9 p.m., but faculty and staff may still use the Fitness Center. Students are not allowed in the Fitness Center before 6:30 a.m. or past 9 p.m.

Pool

- If a team wants to use the pool, set-up a time with the Athletic Director.
- Two certified lifeguards must be on duty any time there are swimmers in the pool.
- All swimmers should rinse off in the showers before entering the pool.
- Swimmers must wear proper swim attire (bathing suits or shorts).
- Listen to and follow all of the lifeguards' instructions.
- **Even with two lifeguards on duty, another set of eyes is always helpful. Please pay attention to what is happening in the pool.**
- All swimmers should rinse off in the shower after using the pool.
- Make sure all students are out of the pool and have left the facility before you depart.

Locker Rooms

Coaches should make every effort to ensure locker rooms and team storage areas are safe, secure and clean. Student-athletes should lock up belongings when not in use and are discouraged from bringing any valuable items to the athletic facility.

Transportation

Blair vehicles

- All coaches **MUST** have or obtain a CDL license unless an exemption is made. Please contact the Safety & Security Consultant for help in obtaining one.
- Blair's buses will be ready and assigned in the Annie Hall parking lot. Take only the bus you have been assigned.
- If needed, directions to competitions will be supplied by the Athletic Office.
- Drive responsibly.
- Announce to students to put on seat belts.
- Fill-up gas tank upon return from all contests at the Phillips 66 gas station. Use your school code. Contact the Athletic Office if you returned late from a contest and were unable to fill up the gas tank. If you do not remember your school code, use the code 5648.
- **Clean the inside of the vehicle upon return.** Work with student-athletes to do it.
- Return buses or vans to Annie Hall parking lot.
- Return keys to the Keycafe cabinet in the front of Annie Hall parking lot immediately upon your return.
- Students not going back with the team must have parental permission.
- **Students may not drive their own cars to games. The only exception to this rule is if they've cleared it with the Student Life Office. In that case, no passengers are allowed.**

Before allowing any player who plans to depart with their parents or school-approved ride from an away event from leaving the premises, coaches must connect (face-to-face) with the parent or ride.

Chartered buses

- Meet buses at the main entrance of Hardwick Hall (by the clocktower).
- Coaches must be on board.
- Pick up directions from the Athletic Director and give them to the bus driver.
- Upon return, make sure the bus is clean.
- Students must have parental permission in order to not return with the team on the bus.

Meals

Home games:

- Late dinner will be served at 7-7:15 p.m. if the game extends past regular dinner hours.
- The Athletic Office will notify the coach ahead of time if the team will be attending late dinner.
- Make sure athletes go directly to the dining hall after late contests. Uniform attire is fine.
- Winter practices are another instance when late dinner may be required.
- If your team has not been assigned to late dinner, do not let them attend.

Away games:

- If the team does not return for dinner on time, they will receive bag dinners or meal money.
- This may also be the case for early departures missing breakfast or lunch.

- Bag dinners are to be picked up by the coach in the back of the dining hall's kitchen. Always remember to pick-up bag meals.
- **Make sure that all trash from bag meals is thrown out in a dumpster on campus upon return.**
- If you have special requests for food items, contact the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations.
- Meal money will be distributed by the Athletic Office before departure.
- Return extra money to the Athletic Office the following day.

Coaching

Big 3 (Organization, Discipline & Enthusiasm)

Organization:

- Be prepared for practice; all head coaches should have a practice plan.
- Be on time.
- Dress accordingly.
- Hold good, productive practices.
- Be the last to leave the practice area (make sure everyone is okay).
- Set guidelines and expectations on the first day.
- Explain training rules and consequences if rules are broken. Leave no doubt about your expectations.
- Learn as much as possible about your sport (clinics, materials, etc.).
- Work with other coaches to be organized on daily preparation of practice.
- Make sure the safety of your athletes is the highest priority in all practices and games.

Discipline:

- Hold students accountable.
- Student-athletes should never look sloppy in uniform.
- Coaches and athletes represent Blair in competition. Good sportsmanship is very important. Demand it!
- It is mandatory that all Blair athletes and coaches shake hands at the end of every contest. This should never be an issue.
- Coaches and teams must act with class always—home or away—representing Blair in fine fashion.
- Do your best—what you do for student-athletes on the field is just as important as what you do in the classroom.

Enthusiasm:

- Students will follow the coach's lead—be enthusiastic.
- Enthusiasm goes a long way.
- Be positive, but also push your athletes to excel or to improve. There are times when it is necessary to address poor effort or lack of concentration.
- Give positive feedback, which always leads to a better response.
- Challenge kids (being satisfied is being mediocre).
- The Athletic Office staff is always open to discuss any coaching issues.
- Have fun—it's contagious.
- Have your own style and work at it.

Coaching Details

1. Terminology:
 - a. We refer to our teams as boys' and girls' soccer teams, etc. This is universal among NJISAA Athletic Directors, as well as NFHS member schools.
 - b. Make sure your athletes refer to you as Coach -----, or by Mrs. -----, Ms. ----- or Mr. -----.
3. NJISAA disqualification rule:
 - a. Any athlete or coach ejected from a game will be suspended for the next two (one for football because that team plays half the number of games).
 - b. A person ejected cannot be onsite of the next two contests.
 - c. There is **NO** appeal.
 - d. Always notify the Athletic Director of disqualifications ASAP after a contest.
2. Discipline problems or parental interaction:
 - a. If you have any major discipline issues that come up during practice or games, notify the Athletic Director. Always try to have an assistant present when dealing with any of these types of issues.
 - b. If you have any confrontational interactions with a parent (whether in person or by phone), it is important to keep the Athletic Director informed.
3. Please do not bring young children or pets to practices or games.

Coaching Ideas

- Basic fundamentals are critical! All successful teams are always fundamentally sound.
- Be as detailed as possible (technique, systems, etc.). Make it simple. Use terminology that's easy to understand.
- Develop systems for every aspect of your game.
- Use as many drills as you can that incorporate game-like situations.
- Develop competition among your own players. They will be more prepared for actual game competition. This will also challenge your athletes to improve.
- Break down specific game situations in practice.
- Create a game-like atmosphere as best as you can.
- Do your best to be prepared for every situation you may encounter in a game.
- Shorter periods are better in a scrimmage (intrasquad during practice).
- Use film sessions to educate athletes.
- Always coach—give continuous feedback (if you are standing around watching, you're not helping).
- Be consistent in all areas.
- Head coaches should delegate responsibilities to assistant coaches and encourage them to push athletes, as well as help them to understand the team's philosophies and make sure they are consistent with other coaching staff.
- Work hard every day! Always come to practice excited.
- Do all the little things well—this is the key to success.
- **Be positive!**

Varsity Letter Requirements

- Hold a high standard.

- An impact athlete.
- Letters should not be given for practice participation and perfect attendance. This is a given, as in the classroom; the student is expected to be in class every day, but does not receive an “A” for perfect attendance.
- Qualifications should be geared around an athlete who competes in at least 75 percent of scheduled games and participates half or more of the time in each game.
- We also award seniors a varsity letter when they have been with the program and have been a positive member of the team, regardless of playing time.
- Head coaches should use their own discretion when determining varsity letter winners.
- Managers do not receive letters.
- Any questions or complications, consult the Athletic Director.
- At the end-of-season athletic assembly, team captains should be prepared to speak in front of the other coaches and athletes on behalf of their team. Coaches only present their team award winners. Further details will be announced at a later date.

Captains

- Coaches will decide on when and how captains will be selected and set the criteria for the position. The criteria for selection and the expected responsibilities will be shared with the team. Having the right captains that align with the team’s culture will lead to long-term success for the program. Captains should work closely with the coach and their teammates to ensure a positive and inclusive environment.

Athletic Schedules

- All coaches are encouraged to meet with the Athletic Office regarding scheduling and any questions or concerns.
- The schedules posted on the athletic and team web pages are always subject to change.
- The weekly athletic schedule will be emailed every week to faculty and staff by the Assistant Athletic Director for Operations and is available as a Google calendar feed through Blair’s website. Through both the emailed PDF and the Google calendar maintained by the Athletic Office, coaches will have access to all contest information for the coming week, including opponents, locations, game and departure times. Meals and transportation will be provided.
- Any changes made to the athletic schedule will be immediately updated on the website. The Athletic Office will notify specific coaches of any changes made.
- Coaches will receive a “game day” sheet by way of email the day before the contest, giving them information and all of the details concerning the game (opponent, location, officials, game time, transportation, departure time, class dismissal, meal plan, etc.).

Game Day Checklist (Head Coaches)

Home Games:

1. Notify players of game details the day before the contest.
2. Make sure players pick-up uniforms.
3. The Head or Assistant Athletic Trainer will make sure there is water on the field (cooler and cups or bottles.) Use managers to help with this process.
4. Get to the field early.
5. Make sure all equipment is ready for the game (gear, balls, med kits, etc.).
6. Greet the opponent’s coaching staff.
7. Ask opponents if they need anything—be great hosts.

8. Locker rooms for visitors will be assigned during winter contests and some over the course of the fall. The Athletic Office will assign a room and guide the team upon arrival.
9. Greet officials before the game.
10. Compete.
11. Shake hands with opponents after the contest. If the event is against a Mid-Atlantic Prep League (MAPL) team, shake hands before the contest.
12. Meet with your team at the conclusion of the event.
13. Breakdown field or gym and put equipment away.
14. Have all athletes turn in uniforms following the contest.
15. Varsity head coaches, please email the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities a recap and score of the game. This should be one-to-two paragraphs that include notable performances and key statistics.

Away Games:

1. Notify players of departure time the day before the contest (this information will come from the Athletic Office).
2. Remind athletes of the dress code.
3. Make sure players pick up their uniforms.
4. Pick up equipment and med kit.
5. Pick up directions from the Athletic Office.
6. Make sure athletes have their uniforms and equipment for the contest.
7. Take attendance before departing.
8. Pick up bag meals from behind the kitchen if they've been assigned.
11. Leave on time as best you can.
12. If driving, drive responsibly.
13. Arrive and meet the opponent's coach if possible.
14. Compete.
15. Shake hands with opponents.
16. Pick up gear to return to Blair.
17. Take attendance before you leave—parents may give permission to bring their child back to Blair, but you should have a face-to-face meeting with any parent or ride before athletes depart.
18. If a student-athlete returns with a parent, make sure to get their uniform.
19. Stop on your way home for dinner, depending on the meal plan. Take attendance again before leaving the restaurant.
20. Fill up School vehicles with gas upon return at the Phillips 66 gas station on Route 94. Use your access code for the charge (subject to change).
21. Return the vehicle to the Annie Hall parking lot.
22. **Always clean vehicles with the help of athletes (same for chartered buses).**
23. Athletes turn in uniforms to the equipment room.
24. Put away equipment.
25. Coaches should leave bus or SUV keys in the Keycafe cabinet in the front of the Annie Hall parking lot.
26. Varsity head coaches should email the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities a recap of the game. This should be one-to-two paragraphs that include notable performances and key statistics.

Athletic Overnight Trips

Checklist:

1. Submit a list of those going on your trip to the Athletic Office, Student Life Office and Health Center at least 72 hours in advance.
2. Complete the overnight template shared by the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations with details of your trip.
 - a. Daily itinerary.
 - b. Roster and rooming list.
 - c. Hotel information.
 - d. Transportation.
 - e. Head coach contact information.
3. Must have an accurate cell phone number of each student. Students must have all coaches' cell numbers as well.
4. Prior to the trip, meet with your team to discuss trip expectations. They are representing you and the team, but most importantly—Blair Academy.
5. Explain and enforce safety rules while on your trip:
 - a. Where students can go.
 - b. Checking in and out with coaches when going somewhere.
 - c. Curfew/face-to-face check-in is required.
 - d. Can only get into a car of a parent/guardian and must get permission from the coach.
 - e. No co-ed visitation in rooms.
6. All major school rules are in effect. Communicate clearly and in detail with students before going on a trip.
7. For equipment needs, see the Assistant Director of Athletics for Operations at least a week before.
8. Medical needs:
 - a. See the Head Athletic Trainer for a med kit.
 - b. Health Center for student medications. Please share a list of students participating on the trip at least 72 hours prior to the trip.
9. A lifeguard must always be present if students will be swimming (and please keep in mind that pool size may dictate that you need more than one).
10. Consumption of alcohol, illegal drugs (including marijuana) and tobacco are strictly prohibited during the trip.

You should adhere to other protocols stated in the Student Travel Procedures and Emergency Protocol.

Coaching Checklist (Daily Practice)

1. Have an organized practice plan broken down by times and sessions.
 - a. Keep sessions to shorter time periods, which helps keep focus.
2. Be on time; be accountable.
3. Bring high energy every day; enthusiasm goes a long way.
4. Make sure athletes understand the nature of leadership. You are their coach, not their buddy.
5. Dress like a professional/act like a professional to earn respect from athletes.
 - a. Give plenty of positive reinforcement when warranted.
 - b. Address lack of focus or effort.
 - c. Ask athletes why we do things to help them understand the process.

6. Be consistent with your structure, discipline and organization.
7. Use terminology that is easy to understand and put into action.
 - a. Encourage students/team to do better every day in keeping with high expectations for athletes/team.
 - b. Less talk is better; get players in motion.
 - c. Use game-like situations as much as possible in practice.
8. Be on the same page with fellow coaches, delegate responsibility and communicate.
9. Communicate with athletes to let them know where they stand.
10. Know your athletes and remember that everyone is different and responds in their own ways to challenges and opportunities.

Coaching Standards

Head Coach:

1. Set high expectations and appropriate goals for your team.
2. Have an organized detailed practice plan.
3. Have timely communication with team members, assistant coaches and administrators.
4. Consistently foster a positive team concept with the team and the larger Blair community. Always bring enthusiasm and positive energy on a daily basis.
5. Support athletes with positive reinforcement.
6. Demand discipline of your team, on and off the field/court.
7. Be responsible for the well-being of each individual team member.
8. Demand sportsmanship of oneself, team members and assistant coaches in representing Blair Academy.
9. Strive to help team members improve their skills and achieve beyond their potential, while emphasizing that they each are an integral part of the team.
10. Continue to enhance your own and your assistants' professional development in your particular sport.
11. Establish an open line of communication with parents, athletes, faculty, staff and administrators.

Assistant Coach:

1. Adopt and support the coaching philosophy. Adhere to head coaching standards as well.
2. Give feedback to the head coach at appropriate times and professionally.
3. Adapt to stated needs of the head coach.
4. Continue to seek professional development.
5. Serve as an advocate for the athletes to the head coach.
6. Actively promote the head coach's practice plan.
7. Look to be proactive and receptive in executing administrative details.

JV Coach:

1. Head varsity coaching standards apply to JV coaches; however, expectations need to be adjusted based on level of competition and player experience.
2. Provide a positive and fun learning experience.
3. Coaches with little or no experience should seek advice from the head of the program, members of the coaching staff and the Athletic Director.

Harassment & Bullying

All members of the Blair community have the basic right not to be harassed or bullied. The state of New Jersey has defined “harassment, intimidation or bullying” to mean any gesture or any written, verbal, or physical act or electronic communication, whether it is a single incident or a series of incidents that is:

- Reasonably perceived as being motivated by either any actual or perceived characteristic, such as race, color, religion, ancestry, national origin, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, or a mental, physical or sensory disability; or
- By any other distinguishing characteristic; and that
- Takes place on school property, at any school-sponsored function, on a school bus, or off school grounds, that substantially disrupts or interferes with the orderly operation of the school or the rights of other students; and that
- A reasonable person should know under the circumstances will have the effect of physically or emotionally harming a pupil or damaging the student’s property, or placing a student in reasonable fear of physical or emotional harm to their person or damage to their property; or
- Has the effect of insulting or demeaning any student or group of students; or
- Creates a hostile educational environment for the student by interfering with a student’s education or by severely or pervasively causing physical or emotional harm to the student.

Any student who feels victimized by harassment, bullied, or who is concerned about such behavior is encouraged to consult with any trusted adult, such as a classroom teacher, advisor, school counselor or a member of the administration.

Given the wide range of behavior that constitutes harassment and bullying, cases will be considered on an individual basis by the Head of School, Associate Head of School or the appropriate authority in consultation with all involved parties. Disciplinary responses, when called for, will be determined at the discretion of the Head of School. Suspension or dismissal may be warranted particularly when behaviors demonstrate a serious disregard for the welfare of other individuals or the community as a whole.

It is critically important that the School supports and protects any individual who raises a complaint. Retaliation against someone making a complaint about harassment or bullying is unacceptable and will be subject to a disciplinary response if found to be a valid claim of retaliation by the Head of School or designees.

Sportsmanship

Coaches:

- Treat own players and opponents with respect.
- Inspire in the athletes a love for the game and a desire to compete fairly.
- Are the type of people they want athletes to be.
- Discipline those on the team who display unsportsmanlike behavior.
- Respect the judgment and interpretation of the rules by the officials.
- Always remember that it is a privilege to represent the School and community.

Players:

- Treat your teammates and opponents with respect.

- Play hard within the rules.
- Exercise self-control at all times, setting the example for others to follow.
- Respect officials and accept their decisions without gesture or argument.
- Win without boasting; lose without excuses and never quit.
- Always remember that it is a privilege to represent the School and community.

Spectators:

- Attempt to understand and be informed of the playing rules.
- Appreciate a good play no matter who makes it.
- Show compassion for an injured player, applaud positive performances, do not heckle, jeer or distract players, and avoid use of profane and obnoxious language and behavior.
- Respect the judgment and strategy of the coach, and do not criticize players or coaches for the loss of a game.
- Respect property of others, and authority of those who administer the competition, and censure those whose behavior is unbecoming.

Guidelines for Varsity Coaches Supporting Admission & College Guidance

The expectations of head coaches have expanded at all college prep boarding schools to include responsibilities beyond the obvious. No longer is it acceptable to simply plan practices, provide instruction when needed, build a sense of team spirit and camaraderie and so on. There are responsibilities at both ends of the secondary-school spectrum: admission and college placement. Given that two central objectives of a selective boarding school are to attract mission-appropriate students to the school and to prepare those students for admission to the best college possible, head coaches play a critical role in supporting the School in its pursuit of both of these objectives. Below are expectations for all head coaches:

In support of the admission office:

- Coaches are expected to follow up with prospective students by email or by phone in a timely manner and maintain contact with those that the admission office deems highly desirable, particularly surrounding application deadlines, decision notifications and Revisit Days.
- Coaches may be encouraged to attend summer camps to help establish name recognition for both the School and a respective sport.

In between:

- Coaches should communicate well with potentially recruitable athletes about their college hopes and liaise with the College Counseling Office (and with parents) in support of student-athletes. Coaches should do their best to provide context, perspective and support while offering clear communication regarding a student's abilities, goals and areas for growth.

In support of college guidance:

- Coaches are expected to return emails or phone calls to college coaches or admission officers within 48 hours and to offer support for student-athletes who are actively seeking the opportunity to play a given sport in college.

- Coaches are expected to assist student-athletes in creating athletic resumes/portfolios to present to colleges, including any necessary videotaping.
- Coaches should be well informed on the measures by which student-athletes are evaluated at the college level and prepare promising athletes for meeting such measures.
- Coaches should establish relationships with the head coaches at schools to which student-athletes consistently wish to apply.

Sports-Information Responsibilities

Recaps:

- Coaches must email/text results to the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities immediately after the end of the contest.
- Team managers must submit results and statistics to njschoolsports.com and add the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities email on the distribution list, along with info@njadvancemedia.com.
- Login information for njschoolsports.com is as follows:
 - User ID: blairathletics
 - Password: gobucs
 - The *Star Ledger* number: (800) 285-1960 (*for any coaches who want to call in scores*)

Cameras:

- Coaches or managers must contact the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities in order to sign out camera equipment before athletic events. Coaches are responsible for returning any camera equipment immediately after every game.

National Letter of Intent (NLI) or Celebratory Letter:

- If student-athletes would like to participate in a National Letter of Intent or Celebratory Letter signing day, they or their coach should contact the Associate Athletic Director in order to schedule a date for the event. The Associate Athletic Director must approve all NLI/Celebratory Letter paperwork before the date is scheduled.
- If a student-athlete receives a celebratory signing document, please send it to the Associate Athletic Director for approval and scheduling.
- Students offered a National Letter of Intent or Celebratory Letter for a specific sport will be given the opportunity to participate in our “College Signing” ceremonies if they compete for a Blair Academy interscholastic team during their senior year in that specific sport.

Hudl:

- Contact the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities if you would like to use Hudl for your season. Game film will be uploaded the next day after the event and shared with the entire team.

Notable news/social media:

- Any notable news, such as news articles, student-athlete rankings and invitations to national events, should be shared with the Assistant Director of Athletics for Sports Information & Facilities to promote.
- Blair athletics an Instagram account (@blair_athletics).
- If any coach is interested in starting a team account for any social media platform, please reach out to the Assistant Director of Athletics for Sports Information & Facilities, who will coordinate with the communications team and appropriate other school offices for approval and login information.

Team Web Pages:

- If you have any suggestions for adding to or editing your team pages, please contact the Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities, who will coordinate with the communications office as needed to make such updates.

Media Inquiry Policy:

- If any program is approached by a media company (video production company, news outlet, photographer, blog, local website, etc.), please notify the Associate Athletic Director or Assistant Athletic Director for Sports Information & Facilities, who will partner with the communications office to get such requests approved and help with any logistics. Please note that no interviews should be granted without the knowledge and approval of the athletic office and Blair's communications office (*please see the "media access to Blair programs, teams or facilities" policy on page 19*).

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIPT OF *EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK* 2026-2027

This Form acknowledges that I have received access to Blair Academy's (the "School")'s *Employee Handbook*, which includes, among other things, policies with respect to the following topics: Sexual and Other Harassment; Equal Employment Opportunity; and Time Off and Benefits. I understand that I am responsible for familiarizing myself with the contents of the *Employee Handbook* and any supplemental information provided to me. This *Employee Handbook* supersedes all prior employee handbooks, policies, practices and understandings regarding the policies set forth herein.

I understand that the information contained in the *Employee Handbook* is intended only to provide me with a summary of the School's current programs, policies and procedures. I also understand that the School may interpret, amend, supplement or rescind any program, policy or procedure contained in the *Employee Handbook* without prior notice to employees.

I understand that during the course of my employment with the School, I may have access to information about the School's students that is confidential or proprietary in nature, and I agree that I will keep such information confidential and not disclose such information without the express consent of the School, both during my employment and after the separation of my employment. I understand that if I violate the terms of the confidentiality policies in *Blair's Employee Handbook*, I may be subject to legal action in addition to disciplinary consequences, up to and including termination of my employment.

I understand that this *Employee Handbook* is not a contract and that the programs, policies and procedures summarized in the *Employee Handbook*, and any supplemental information provided by the School, are not intended to create and do not create any contractual rights, promises or obligations of any kind with respect to the terms or conditions of employment. I recognize that, except as otherwise may be set forth expressly in a written, signed agreement between the Head of School and me, neither the School nor I has entered into any contract of employment, express or implied, and my employment relationship with the School is "at-will." That is, either the School or I may terminate the relationship at any time, with or without notice, for any reason or for no reason at all.

Print name of employee

Employee's signature

Date